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The Tribune

VOICE OF THE PEOPLE

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KAGAN, SOAI WIN NOBEL
IN CHEMISTRY [BACK PAGE](#)

THURSDAY | 8 OCTOBER 2026

RBI removes Paytm Payments Bank from scheduled banks' list

NEW DELHI: The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has formally delisted Paytm Payments Bank from the roster of approved scheduled banks. In April, the RBI revoked its banking licence due to non-compliance with regulations, stating that the bank's operations were managed in a way harmful to the interests of its depositors. — TNS

Acted on over 5 mn child abuse content pieces in India: Meta

NEW DELHI: Meta on Wednesday disclosed that it acted on 5.3 million pieces of child sexual exploitation content in India in the first half of 2026. The company said it had deployed new AI tools to check ads that led users to child abuse material. More than 98 per cent of the content on Facebook and Instagram in India was found and addressed before anyone reported it, Meta said. — PTI

3 killed, 8 injured as building collapses in Delhi's Seemapuri

NEW DELHI: Three persons, including two children and a 21-year-old pregnant woman, were killed and at least eight persons, including a three-year-old child, were injured after a four-storey building collapsed in Delhi's Seemapuri area on Wednesday. Authorities are suspecting that cracks that appeared in the building following an earthquake on Tuesday may have led to the incident. **INSIDE**

Rahul, Priyanka detained again on 2nd day of street showdown for CEC ouster

Oppn MPs try to reach Jantar Mantar after 'unity' lunch

SHEKHAR SINGH
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7

A second straight day of Opposition protest over alleged "vote chori" and the demand for CEC Gyanesh Kumar's resignation turned central Delhi into political battleground on Wednesday, with Rahul Gandhi, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and several INDIA bloc MPs detained as the police stopped their buses from reaching Jantar Mantar.

As a prolonged standoff unfolded near Janpath, MPs climbed atop buses waving the Tricolour, leaders sat on the road and Priyanka lay down at the Shangri-La-Meridian roundabout clutching a copy of the Constitution before being forcibly removed by women police personnel.

The protest began after Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge hosted INDIA bloc leaders for lunch at an eatery on Janpath. The leaders then boarded buses for Jantar Mantar, where they had planned a sit-in.

Before leaving, Rahul said around 300 Opposition MPs had sought to meet the Election Commissioners a day earlier but were prevented from doing so. He then said the Opposition would now go

CONTINUED ON PAGE 8



Congress MPs Rahul Gandhi, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, Deepender Hooda and Amrinder Singh Raja Warring, and others at a protest in New Delhi. **PH**

Gandhi siblings face FIR for forcibly entering Akashvani

RAHUL GAHLAWAT
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7

The Delhi Police on Wednesday registered an FIR against Congress leaders Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, and their supporters for allegedly forcibly entering Akashvani Bhawan during the Opposition's march against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar

FIRs LIKE MEDALS

“I have 45 FIRs against me. My target is 100... Every FIR against me is a medal for me. Rahul Gandhi, **LOP**

NO VOTE THEFT, OPPN HAS LOST WISDOM: BJP [BACK PAGE](#)

on Tuesday. The case was registered at the Parliament

Today's issue is of 18 pages, including four-page Delhi Tribune.

RBI's 1st rate hike since 2023 to push up EMIs

Inflation, crude prices behind decision

ADITYA RANGROO
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7

The Reserve Bank of India on Wednesday raised the repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.50 per cent, its first increase since February 2023, a move that is set to push up loan EMIs, and shifted its policy stance from "neutral" to "calibrated tightening". This signals that rate cuts are unlikely in the near term and further hikes may be considered amid mounting inflationary pressures, a weak rupee and elevated crude oil prices.

The six-member Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) of the RBI voted unanimously to raise the repo rate. The decision to change the policy stance was taken with a 4:2 majority.

The hike in the repo rate, the first in the tenure of Gov-

KEY POLICY SIGNALS

- Rate cuts are unlikely in the near term and further hikes may be considered
- Length of the rate increase cycle to depend on real growth inflation trends
- Governor says MDR small fee, won't have major impact on UPI volumes

ernor Sanjay Malhotra, who assumed office in December 2024, comes as key global central banks raise rates due to pressure from high oil prices following the West Asia crisis, weak currencies and the impact of El Nino.

Malhotra said additional rate reductions were not being considered in the short term. "The length and scope of the rate increase cycle will depend on the real growth inflation

CONTINUED ON PAGE 8



PM Narendra Modi offers prayers at the Sree Vinayaka Mandir at Sarojini Nagar in New Delhi on completion of 25 years in public office. **PH**

Modi's 'we will do it' call marks 25-yr milestone

ADITI TANDON
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7

At a time of massive Opposition-led offensive over the allegations of irregularities in the Election Commission's voter roll revision process, Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Wednesday declared his resolve to pursue the goal of Viksit

Bharat by 2047, saying no amount of "distraction or obstruction" would deter him or 140 crore Indians from achieving the target.

Addressing a public event in Delhi to mark 25 years in office, first as Gujarat Chief Minister (2001 to 2014) and then as PM (2014 to now), Modi issued a "We will do it!"

CONTINUED ON PAGE 8

'No summons received': Mann's OSD Ghuman fails to show up before CBI

RUCHIKA M KHANNA & RAMKRISHAN UPADHYAY
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

CHANDIGARH, OCTOBER 7

A day after the CBI searched the camp office of Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann and registered a case against his OSD, Rajbir Singh Ghuman, the latter did not appear before the agency today, with officials in

Moves special CBI court after FIR 'made public'

the Chief Minister's Office (CMO) saying no summons were received.

"He did not get any summons," a senior functionary in the CMO told *The Tribune*. Ghuman and five others

have been booked by the CBI in connection with a case relating to allegations of corruption and influence-peddling. Sources in the CBI, however, said Ghuman was summoned at the CBI office here at 2.30 pm today.

The CBI has not announced any arrest in the case so far. Meanwhile, a second search

CONTINUED ON PAGE 8

Jailed MP Amritpal allowed video call with grandmother

PAWAN K JAISWAR
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

AMRITSAR, OCTOBER 7

An Additional Sessions Judge has allowed Khadoor Sahib MP Amritpal Singh to speak to his ailing grandmother through a 10-minute video call.

Additional Sessions Judge Barinder Singh passed the order while hearing a petition

CONTINUED ON PAGE 8

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Shah flags off Seva Jyoti Yatra, urges youth to contribute to nation-building

SUMEDHA SHARMA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

GURUGRAM, OCTOBER 7 Union Home Minister Amit Shah today said Prime Minister Narendra Modi's 25 years in public life — first as Chief Minister and later as Prime Minister — would be written in golden letters when the history of India was recorded.

Shah was speaking at the state-level launch of the Viksit Bharat Sankalp Jyoti Yatra under the Seva Sankalp Abhiyan in Gurugram. He handed over the yatra torch to Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini, who later passed it on to youth at the programme.

Shah, Saini, BJP leaders and thousands of youths listened live to Modi's address to the nation on completing 25 years in public life. Modi called for greater public participation in achieving the goal of a Viksit Bharat, with a focus on service, good governance and nation-building.

Addressing the Viksit

Says Prime Minister Narendra Modi's 25-year journey will be written in golden letters



Union Home Minister Amit Shah and Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini in Gurugram on Wednesday. PTI

Saini later walked through prominent routes in Gurugram and installed the yatra torch near Signature Tower. He handed over the torch to

real meaning only when better facilities reached every person and people's lives became happier, more prosperous and free from problems.

The programme also marked the first appearance in Haryana of Smriti Irani after her appointment as the BJP's state incharge on September 23. She had been expected to attend a party conference in Bhiwani on September 27 but did not turn up. She was later reported to be joining the Seva Jyoti Yatra in Jind but attended the Gurugram programme instead.

Haryana BJP co-incharge Bhola Singh accompanied Irani. She was also seen interacting with Shah during the event. The Seva Jyoti Yatra is part of the BJP's outreach programme marking Modi's 25 years in public life. Party workers from across south Haryana were mobilised for the Gurugram leg.

In Singapore, Saini woos Punjab, Haryana diaspora

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

CHANDIGARH, OCTOBER 7 Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini has urged industrialists and business representatives of Punjab and Haryana origin based in Singapore to explore investment opportunities in Haryana and become partners in the state's development journey under the 'Viksit Bharat' vision.

Addressing prominent members of the diaspora during his visit to Singapore, Saini said the global experience, expertise and entrepreneurial capabilities acquired by Indians abroad could make a significant contribution to India's development.

Appreciating the contribution of the Indian diaspora through their hard work, talent and entrepreneurship, he invited the industrialists to visit Haryana and assured them of the state government's support.

Saini said Singapore,

Highlights infrastructure, governance, investment opportunities in state

despite its limited geographical area and resources, had emerged as one of the world's leading business and economic centres through visionary economic policies, modern infrastructure, good governance and effective law and order.

He said Haryana was also working towards creating a conducive environment for industries by strengthening law and order, developing modern infrastructure and ensuring good governance.

"The policies of the Central Government have created new opportunities for investment, infrastructure, employment and entrepreneurship in the country. On the same lines, Haryana is also continuously working towards providing investors with better law and order,

modern infrastructure, good governance and a conducive environment for industries and progress," he said.

Saini invited the industrialists and business representatives to visit Haryana and also extended an invitation to them to visit his official residence in Chandigarh. He said the state government was committed to maintaining continuous dialogue and cooperation with the Indian diaspora.

Meanwhile, a delegation of senior Haryana Government officials held a separate meeting with senior officials of Singapore Corporation Enterprise, Government of Singapore.

The meeting focused on exchanging best practices and experiences related to mixed land-use policy and land pricing. The discussions are expected to provide policy inputs for upcoming government projects in Haryana.

Slow pace of procurement forces Karnal farmers into distress sales



PARVEEN ARORA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

KARNAL, OCTOBER 7 Paddy procurement in grain markets across Karnal district continues at a slow pace, leaving scores of farmers waiting for days with their produce even a week after the state government began official procurement on September 29.

Farmers alleged that they were being forced to sit with their crop in the open as procurement agencies and rice millers had failed to turn up. They claimed many farmers were being compelled to sell paddy at rates well below the minimum support price (MSP). Rice millers attributed the delay to lengthy paperwork, multiple formalities and the newly introduced requirement of geo-fencing rice mills. They said the process of linking mills with procurement agencies was taking longer than expected due to documentation and verification requirements.

"The new geo-fencing formalities and the long chain of paperwork have made the entire process very complicated. Linking mills with procurement agencies is taking far more time than expected," a rice miller said on condition of anonymity.

Farmers said they had been waiting at the markets

Farmers lock grain market gates over paddy lifting



Farmers lock the gate of grain market in Vyaspur town.

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

YAMUNANAGAR, OCTOBER 7 Farmers under the banner of the Bharatiya Kisan Union (Charuni) today locked both gates of the grain market at Vyaspur in Yamunanagar district to protest against the delay in lifting procured paddy.

The farmers said they had come to meet officials and raise their concerns but no official arrived for nearly two hours. They then staged a sit-in at the market gate. The protest ended after about two-and-a-half hours when officials assured them that their concerns would be addressed.

BKU district vice-president Gurmej Singh Kapuri said more than a week had passed since procurement began, but not a single grain of paddy had been lifted from the market.

2.57 lakh MT paddy procured in state

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

CHANDIGARH, OCTOBER 7 Around 7.35 lakh metric tonnes of paddy has arrived in mandis and 2.57 lakh metric tonnes has been procured so far.

The procurement process will continue till November 15.

A government spokesperson said MSP is Rs 2,441 per quintal for common paddy and Rs 2,461 per quintal for Grade-A paddy.

To facilitate farmers and ensure transparency in procurement, all mandis and procurement centres have been equipped with geo-fencing facilities.

The Centre has set a target of procuring 58 lakh metric tonnes of paddy for Haryana. In addition, a target has been set for the

Centre has set a target of procuring 58 lakh metric tonnes for Haryana

delivery of 32.5 lakh metric tonnes as custom-milled rice, with 10 per cent broken rice, to the Food Corporation of India.

To ensure that farmers do not face any inconvenience, the Haryana State Agricultural Marketing Board has made adequate arrangements for basic facilities at mandis and procurement centres.

Keeping the issue of moisture in view, the district administrations have already issued prohibitory orders under Section 163 regarding the harvesting of paddy.

Govt to purchase every single grain, says Panwar

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

KAITHAL, OCTOBER 7 Haryana Development and Panchayati Raj Minister Krishan Lal Panwar on Wednesday visited the grain market in Kaithal and took stock of the paddy procurement arrangements. He interacted with farmers who had brought their produce to the grain market and sought details of the procurement process from officials.

Panwar made it clear that during the procurement season, farmers should not face any kind of difficulty and that every single grain of the

farmers would be purchased at the prescribed Minimum Support Price (MSP).

The minister also got the moisture content assessed with a moisture meter. Farmers shared their problems with the minister, stating that their crop was not being purchased at MSP; they were forced to move between 2-3 mandis; and were facing hardship. The minister then checked the moisture level of another heap of paddy with the moisture meter and directed the officials and agencies present on the spot to commence procurement. He instructed

the three agencies to procure paddy equally.

He said that Kaithal has 270 arhtiyas' shops. Warehouses will procure paddy from No. 1 to 90 shops, the Food Civil Supplies and Consumer Affairs Department from No. 91 to 180, and Hafed from No. 181 to 270.

HSGMC meeting cancelled again over lack of quorum

NITISH SHARMA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

KURUKSHETRA, OCTOBER 7 The Executive Committee meeting of the Haryana Sikh Gurdwara Management Committee (HSGMC) was cancelled again on Wednesday after four members stayed away, resulting in a lack of quorum.



HSGMC president Jagdish Singh Jhinda along with other committee members in Kurukshetra on Wednesday.

The meeting had been convened to discuss the committee's budget. However, the budgets for 2025-26 and 2026-27 are yet to be passed amid an ongoing tussle between two groups within the committee.

Of the 11-member Executive Committee, eight members are required for the quorum. Seven members attended today's meeting, while four members — senior vice-president Gurmeet Singh, junior vice-president Gurbir Singh, TP Singh and Jagtar Singh — remained absent.

The four members had opposed the meeting being

restricted to a single agenda of the budget, seeking the inclusion of other financial, administrative and development-related issues.

HSGMC president Jagdish Singh Jhinda said the Haryana Sikh Gurdwara Act required a two-thirds majority for the quorum of both the Executive Committee and the General House. He alleged that the provision was being "misused" by dissenting members to hamper the functioning of the committee.

Jhinda also alleged that the budget was being blocked at the behest of the government.

He said the committee had met Union Minister Manohar Lal Khattar and sought his intervention for passage of the budget and amendment of the Act to replace the two-thirds requirement with a simple majority. He said the absence of an approved budget had restricted the committee to routine expenditure, while no new development projects could be started.

Appealing to the Sikh Sangat to press the dissenting members to cooperate or resign, Jhinda said the committee needed funds to function effectively.

Sikh panel's admn impasse stalls projects, welfare work

GS PAUL
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

CHANDIGARH, OCTOBER 7 The Haryana Sikh Gurdwara Management Committee (HSGMC), established after a prolonged campaign for an independent Sikh gurdwara body in Haryana, remains mired in a governance crisis, with factional infighting, repeated boycotts and litigation disrupting its functioning and stalling development and welfare initiatives.

The deadlock resurfaced on Wednesday when a meeting of the executive body could not be held for want of quorum.

Dissenting members have repeatedly boycotted General House meetings, resulting in failure to meet the mandatory two-thirds attendance requirement under the Haryana Sikh Gurdwara Act, 2014.

The impasse has also paralysed the committee's financial decision-making. Though the HSGMC had approved a

Rs 104.5-crore budget for 2025-26, the Haryana Sikh Gurdwara Judicial Commission later annulled it following challenges by Opposition members, citing lack of a valid quorum. The proposed Rs 110-crore budget for 2026-27 was subsequently not taken up.

With fresh funds difficult to legally sanction, several religious, educational and welfare activities, including dharam prachar and healthcare initiatives, have been affected.

Several flagship projects remain uncertain. A proposed 350-room sarai with underground parking facilities for pilgrims in Amritsar is stalled for want of fresh funding. Plans to expand gurdwara infrastructure, establish a hospital and set up two music schools in Haryana have also made little progress.

The Mirt Piri Institute of Medical Sciences and Research, one of the HSGMC's key institutions,

has faced financial strain. Delayed salaries had triggered protests by doctors and staff before the dues were eventually released. The foundation stone of the HSGMC headquarters at Kurukshetra has also been laid, but the project remains in limbo.

In contrast, the Shiromani Gurdwara Parbandhak Committee (SGPC) in Punjab has continued to function through a regular General House mechanism, approving and implementing sizeable annual budgets.

The SGPC passed a Rs 1,386.47-crore budget for 2025-26, up 9.95%, followed by a Rs 1,487.41-crore budget for 2026-27, an increase of 7.28%.

Its allocations include Rs 127.34 crore for gurdwaras, Rs 120 crore for dharam prachar, Rs 12.50 crore for free education of deserving Gursikh children and Rs 33 crore for construction and expansion of pilgrim accommodation at the Golden Temple, Amritsar.

The Postal and RMS Employees Co-operative Bank Ltd. Ambala
6070/10, 14 Idgah Road Ambala Cantt., - 133001, Haryana
Website: postalrms.bank.in; Email: hrd@postalrms.bank.in
A Multi State Co-Operative Society registered under the MSCS, Act 2002

NOTICE OF CANCEL

With reference to the Bank recruitment advertisement dated 22.07.2026 whereby applications for different cadre regular posts were invited, it is being brought to the notice of all, that said advertisement stands cancelled by the decision of the Board, with immediate effect. Consequently, the recruitment process for the said posts stand as cancelled.

All the applicants against the post advertised vide advertisement dated 22.07.2026 may take note. No separate or individual communication in this regard shall be made by the Bank.

08.10.2026

Chief Executing Officer

Registered Office: HDFC Bank House, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai - 400013 • HDFC Bank Ltd. Harmony Towers Branch, GT Road, Panipat-132103

POSSESSION NOTICE APPENDIX IV RULE 8(1)

Whereas, the undersigned being the authorized officer of the HDFC BANK LTD. under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002(54 of 2002) and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, issued demand notice dated 09.06.2026 calling upon the borrower(s) 1. LUXMI TRADING CO THROUGH ITS PROPRIETOR AJAY KUMAR (BORROWER), 2. AJAY KUMAR S/O SHIV KUMAR (CO-BORROWER & GUARANTOR), 3. RAJINI BANSAL ALIAS RAJINI RANI BANSAL W/O SHIV KUMAR ALIAS SHIV KUMAR BANSAL (CO-BORROWER, MORTGAGOR & GUARANTOR) to pay the amount mentioned in the notice Rs.19,79,572/- + Rs. 11,59,165/- = Rs. 31,38,737/- (RUPEES THIRTY ONE LAKHS THIRTY EIGHT THOUSAND SEVEN HUNDRED AND THIRTY SEVEN ONLY) within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.

The borrower(s) having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower(s) and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under sub-section (4) of section 13 of Act read with rule 8 of the Security Interest Enforcement Rules 2002 on this **06th October, 2026 (Tuesday)**.

The borrower in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to charge of HDFC BANK LTD. for an amount of Rs.19,79,572/- + Rs. 11,59,165/- = Rs. 31,38,737/- (RUPEES THIRTY ONE LAKHS THIRTY EIGHT THOUSAND SEVEN HUNDRED AND THIRTY SEVEN ONLY) and interest thereon together with expenses and charges etc, less amount paid if any.

The borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

SCHEDULE OF PROPERTY

Address of the Property/Assets Details: One House Measuring 203 Sq. Yards Which Is Measured And Bounded As Under: North: 63° - Property of Sh. Pyare Lal, South: 63° - Property of Raman Kumar, East: 29° - Gali Shareang, West: 29° - Property of Ratan Lal Kapoor Situated At Abadi Bilaspur, Tehsil Bilaspur, District Yamunanagar, Purchased Vide Sale Deed No. 4388 Dated 25/3/2013 Registered With Sub-registrar Jagadhri, (house At Galicha Centre Wail Gali, Near Old Patwari Khana, Tehsil Bilaspur, District Yamunanagar, Haryana, Landmark: Near Chotta Bus Stand) **Owner Name:** Rajni Rani Bansal Alias Rajni Bansal W/o Shiv Kumar Alias Shiv Kumar Bansal **Property Type:** Residential

Date : 06/October/2026
Place : Panipat (Haryana)

Authorised Officer
HDFC Bank Ltd.

Debris falls on woman at PGIMS ward amid repairs

RAVINDER SAINI
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

ROHTAK, OCTOBER 7
A woman patient sustained minor injuries after a portion of the ceiling plaster fell on her at Ward No. 4 of PGIMS, Rohtak, on Tuesday.

The incident occurred when the woman was lying on a bed in the ward. Pieces of plaster fell on her, causing injuries. She was subsequently shifted to a safer place in the ward.

The incident took place amid ongoing repair work at the hospital. It was the second such incident reported at the PGIMS in the past month. Earlier, a portion of the ceiling at ward no. 2 had collapsed onto a bed. No one was injured in that incident, as the bed was vacant at the time.

A PGIMS official said the ward building was more than 50 years old, and its repair and maintenance were undertaken by the Public Works Department (B&R), which functions under the state government. “The repair work is carried out by the PWD (B&R),



Debris from a damaged ceiling lies on the floor of Ward 4 at PGIMS in Rohtak. TRIBUNE PHOTO

rather than PGIMS’s internal wing. So, we are dependent on the depart-

ment. Therefore, requests for repairs are sent to the department,” the official

said. Meanwhile, Dr HK Aggarwal, Vice-Chancellor, University of Health Sciences, said a technical audit of the building had already been conducted and PWD officials had been asked to undertake repairs wherever required.

“The state government has also approved a ground plus 6-storey, 500-bed private ward complex, including general wards, at an estimated cost of Rs 160 crore. Work on the project will begin soon, as the tender process is underway. Besides, a new emergency block, estimated to cost Rs 155 crore, is also planned near the trauma centre,” Dr Aggarwal added.

The VC maintained that the PGIMS was committed to ensuring the safety of patients and their attendants. The officials concerned had once again been directed to personally inspect the building and undertake the necessary repairs to prevent any such incident in the future, he added.

Contractor murder: Family seeks arrests, alleges police inaction

OUR CORRESPONDENT

SIRSA, OCTOBER 7
The murder of solar plant contractor Subhash Beniwal in Jamal village triggered a protest outside the Civil Hospital here today, with his family and villagers initially refusing to allow the post-mortem until the accused were arrested.

Subhash, 45, was shot dead at the solar plant on Tuesday. His family alleged that he had faced firing at the plant on October 3 and had approached the DSP seeking action, but no effective steps were taken.

His father, Bahadur Singh, said Subhash and accused Rakesh had been friends since childhood but had developed differences over work and their partnership at the plant. He alleged that Rakesh had repeatedly warned him of a possible “incident”. Subhash had also told the family about a dispute over alleged theft of material from the plant and his decision to separate their business interests.

Police have booked Rakesh and nine others for murder. CIA and Nathusari Chopta police teams are conducting raids in Haryana, Rajasthan and elsewhere to arrest the accused.

The family alleged political influence was delaying action. ASP Adarshdeep Singh assured them of a fair probe into both incidents, following which they agreed to the post-mortem.

SP Deepak Saharan rejected allegations of political pressure, saying police had vital clues and would arrest all accused soon. He said both the deceased and accused had significant criminal records.

Paper mill burning garbage, kids hit, allege Nuh villagers

SUMEDHA SHARMA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

TAURU (NUH), OCTOBER 7
A paper mill on the Tauru-Nuh road is allegedly doubling as a garbage incinerator, say villagers, who claim its toxic black smoke is endangering the health of children and the elderly across six villages in Nuh district.

Sarpanchs of three gram panchayats, Bhajlaka, Chharora and Gwarka, have submitted a written complaint to the SDM, Tauru, demanding strict action against Gurugram Paper Mill. The unit operates within the limits of Bawla village, directly opposite Bhajlaka.

The most serious allegation is that waste from the market is being burnt inside the mill. Villagers claim the resulting smoke is harming their health and damaging standing crops, a direct blow to farmers in an area that depends on agriculture. The allegation has not been independently verified.

The complaint says the mill has been running for a long time, very close to the village.



Garbage being burnt at a paper mill on the Tauru-Nuh road. TRIBUNE PHOTO

Pollution from the unit, it alleged, spreads through the villages all day, putting the elderly and small children at risk of illness. Residents say the soot is so heavy that a layer collects inside their kitchens.

“Nearly all” surrounding villages are suffering, the sarpanches say. Bhajlaka, Bawla, Chila, Gwarka, Chilawali and Buraka are named as affect-

ed, and the complaint says the government school at Bhajlaka is among the places hit.

The sarpanches have urged the administration to act firmly so that the villages are freed from pollution and the threat of disease. Burning mixed market waste is prohibited under solid waste management and air pollution rules.

Cong submits memo to Guv demanding caste census

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

CHANDIGARH, OCTOBER 7
The Congress has submitted a memorandum to the President through the Governor, demanding a caste census, as the current census lacks a clearly defined mechanism for caste counting.

A party delegation, led by former Chief Minister and Leader of Opposition Bhupinder Singh Hooda, party incharge Sanjay Dutt, state president Rao Narender

Singh, national president of the Congress OBC department Dr Anil Jaihind, former MP Raj Babbar and state OBC president Chandra Prakash, met the Governor and handed over the memorandum.

Subsequently, all the leaders participated in the state-level ‘OBC Rights Rally’ (OBC Haq Hunkar) organised at the HPCC here. Hooda said a caste census is crucial to ensure the representation of all castes and sections of society in the country.

He noted that their leader, Rahul Gandhi, had spearheaded a nationwide campaign on this issue and vowed to compel the ruling BJP to conduct such a census. Ultimately, under pressure from the Congress and public sentiment, the BJP was forced to announce a caste census in Parliament. However, it now appears that this was merely a deception, as the census currently underway lacks any column for caste.

A crucial meeting was held on Wednesday at the Congress office in Chandigarh regarding ‘Loktantra Bachao Saptah’ (Save Democracy Week) and the Congress’ nationwide ‘Vote Bachao-Desh Bachao’ (Save the Vote-Save the Country) campaign. It was decided that on October 8, Congress workers will stage protests at all district headquarters across Haryana. In Panchkula, Sanjay Dutt and Narender Singh will lead the campaign.



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Reply to GMADA plea against ED: HC to Centre

SAURABH MALIK
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

CHANDIGARH, OCTOBER 7
The Punjab and Haryana High Court on Wednesday sought the Centre’s response to a petition filed by the Greater Mohali Area Development Authority (GMADA) and the state government challenging the Enforcement Directorate’s (ED) survey and search at PUDA Bhawan, Sector 62, Mohali, from September 22 to 24. A Division Bench comprising Chief Justice Ashwani Kumar Mishra and Senior Justice Kapoor fixed October 28 as the next date of hearing.

The petition has been filed against the Union of India, the Directorate of Enforcement and other respondents. The Union of India was represented by senior advocate and Additional Solicitor-General Satya Pal Jain, while senior advocate Vikram Chaudhary appeared for the state. The petitioners alleged that the operation continued for nearly 50 hours, during which floors of the premises

Fixes Oct 28 hearing over Sept operation at PUDA Bhawan

were sealed, more than 30 bags of records were taken away and mobile phones, computers and other electronic devices belonging to senior officers were copied or cloned. They further alleged that the Principal Secretary and other senior officers remained on the premises for two nights. According to the petition, the ED investigation was initiated on the basis of a CBI FIR concerning an alleged Rs 238-crore bank fraud involving promoters of Tirupati Infra Projects Pvt Ltd, who were accused of siphoning funds for personal benefit. The petitioners, however, contended that neither GMADA nor its officers were accused in the FIR. The petitioners have sought the complete records relating to the survey and search, including authorisa-

tions and reasons recorded for the action. They have also sought quashing of the search authorisations, return of records and electronic devices, and directions restraining the ED from accessing or using data allegedly copied from them. The petitioners alleged that the authorities had “abused their power” by occupying the offices, sealing floors and taking away records without lawful basis. They further claimed that officers were effectively kept in custody without authority of law and invoked Section 62 of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), alleging vexatious search and detention. They maintained that the search was illegal as no connection could be established between the petitioners and the alleged wrongdoing. Even if documents held by the authorities were relevant to the investigation, the petitioners argued, the records could have been summoned without conducting such an extensive search.

RAMKRISHAN UPADHYAY
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

CHANDIGARH, OCTOBER 7
The PMLA court in Chandigarh has issued a fresh production warrant for suspended DIG Harcharan Singh Bhullar in a money laundering case for October 9. Earlier, the court issued a production warrant for Bhullar for today on the application of the Enforcement Directorate (ED) with a direction to the Superintendent, Model Jail, Burail, Chandigarh, to physically produce the accused in the court. However, he could not be produced in the court due to the non-availability of the police force in view of the VVIP visit to the city. The ED had registered the ECIR on November 6, 2025, after accused Bhullar was arrested in a corruption case registered by the CBI on October 16, 2025, under Section 61(2) of the BNS and Sections 7 and 7A of the Prevention of Corruption Act. The FIR in the case was



registered by the CBI on the complaint of Akash Batta, alleging that Bhullar, who was then posted as DIG, Ropar Range, had demanded illegal gratification through a private intermediary, Krishanu Sharda, for securing favourable treatment in an FIR registered at the Sirhind police station. After receiving the complaint, a trap was laid and Krishanu Sharda was apprehended while allegedly accepting Rs 5,00,000 as part of the demanded bribe from the complainant on October 16, 2025. Bhullar was also arrested the same day.

2dieasSUVhits bike in Nangal

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

ROPAR, OCTOBER 7
Two persons were killed and a six-month-old girl had a miraculous escape after a speeding SUV rammed into a motorcycle carrying three persons on the Shivalik Avenue road in Naya Nangal on Tuesday evening. The accident took place around 8 pm. The SUV (PB 74C 7823) was allegedly being driven at a high speed towards Shivalik Avenue. It collided with a motorcycle (PB 16C 4058), leaving the two-wheeler badly damaged and trapped underneath the SUV. Critically injured Ragini (19), daughter of Ajay Kumar, succumbed to her injuries shortly after being taken to hospital. Vijay Kumar (26), alias Vicky, who was employed at the NFL guest house, also died during treatment. The third person travelling on the motorcycle was six-month-old Anayka, who escaped the accident without injuries. The incident sparked anger among residents and they staged a protest demanding the immediate arrest of the SUV driver.

SC orders repoll in 50 local body wards

SATYA PRAKASH
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7
The Supreme Court has set aside local body elections in 50 wards in Punjab — 28 in Patiala district and 22 in Moga district and directed that fresh elections be completed within six weeks. The order was passed by a Bench led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant after a one-member Fact-Finding Commission headed by former Punjab and Haryana High Court judge Justice Nirmaljit Kaur found that the elections in these wards were vitiated by serious instances of bogus and multiple voting and intimidation. To ensure that the fresh elections are conducted in a free, fair and transparent manner, the Bench requested the Chief Justice of the Punjab and Haryana High Court to constitute, within a week, a Monitoring Committee headed by a retired High Court judge. The re-election schedule will be notified only after the Monitoring Committee is constituted, the

Fresh elections to be held under judicial monitoring

Supreme Court said in its September 28 order. The petitions were filed by candidates and other persons associated with different national and state political parties. They alleged that members of the ruling Aam Aadmi Party, police officials and unidentified persons prevented them from filing nomination papers, physically assaulted them, tore their clothes and snatched their nomination forms. The state government has also been directed to provide the committee, before nomination filing begins, ward-wise details of officials deployed on election duty. The list of police officers of the rank of DSP and above deployed for the elections must also be furnished. After completion of the re-election process, a report on its conduct will be submitted to the Chief Justice.

Mega PTM in govt schools tomorrow

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

PATIALA, OCTOBER 7
The Punjab School Education Department will hold a state-wide mega parent-teacher meeting (PTM) in all government schools on October 9. The school heads and teachers have also been asked to inform parents about the government welfare and education-related initiatives, including the Mawan-Dhiyan Satkar Yojana and Mission

Samarth. They have also been asked to record video testimonials of women (parents) beneficiaries. However, the directions have drawn criticism from teacher organisations and objected to the use of teachers for the programme. Vikram Dev Singh, president of the Democratic Teachers Front, appealed to the teachers not to engage in the “publicity propaganda” of the AAP government.

2 youths shot dead in Tarn Taran

OUR CORRESPONDENT

TARN TARAN, OCTOBER 7
Two youths were shot dead at Pakhopur village under the Cholha Sahib police station on Wednesday. The deceased were identified as Palwinder Singh Pinda (23) and Gurjinder Singh Billa (26), both residents of Pakhopur village. SSP Surinder Lamba said the deceased had a rivalry with fellow villager Prabhjit Singh. Prabhjit and his four associates surrounded Palwinder and

Palwinder Singh Pinda

Gurjinder Singh Billa

Gurjinder. They first attacked them with sharp weapons and later shot them dead. The SSP said the accused had been identified and three teams formed to arrest them. Personal enmity seemed to be the main reason behind the incident, he added. Goindwal Sahib DSP Harinder Singh said the bodies had been sent for autopsy at the Civil Hospital, Tarn Taran.

Assaulted by stepmother, minor succumbs to injuries

OUR CORRESPONDENT

FAZILKA, OCTOBER 7
A five-year-old girl, who was allegedly beaten by her stepmother about a week ago, succumbed to her injuries at the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), Bathinda, on Tuesday night. The victim, Manpreet, alias Mannu, was living with her father, Gurditta Singh, and stepmother, Akko Bai, in the Pakka Seed Farm area of Abohar. The woman allegedly brutally beat the girl on September 30, following a domestic dispute. The girl sustained injuries to various parts of her body. She was initially admitted to the Civil Hospital, Abohar, and was later referred to AIIMS, Bathinda, where she succumbed to her injuries. The police had initially registered a case against Akko Bai. Following the girl’s death, the section pertaining to murder has now been added to the FIR.

Panchayat prohibits sale of energy drinks

BATHINDA:irate over the alleged drug menace in neighbouring Bir Talab village and thefts in their own village, the panchayat of Naruana village in Bathinda has passed a resolution banning the sale of energy drinks, boycotting sellers and imposing a penalty. The move follows concerns raised by villagers over the alleged use of energy drinks by drug addicts visiting Naruana and a series of thefts in the village. Police said Bir Talab was a drug hotspot and they regularly conduct raids. — TNS

OFFICE OF THE RECOVERY OFFICER - I/II
DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL CHANDIGARH (DRT 1)
2nd Floor SCO 33-34-35, Sector-17A, Chandigarh

DEMAND NOTICE

NOTICE UNDER SECTIONS 25 TO 28 OF THE RECOVERY OF DEBTS & BANKRUPTCY ACT, 1993 AND RULE 2 OF SECOND SCHEDULE TO THE INCOME TAX ACT, 1961.

RC/1137/2026

24.09.2026

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Versus
M/S AB INFRA INVESTMENT PVT. LTD.

To,

(CD 1) M/s AB Investment Pvt. Ltd., having its Registered Office at 53, Homeland Enclave, Gonia Road Bathinda, Punjab

(CD 2) Sh. Kamal Kumar S/o Sh. Parkash Chand (DIN No. 0063498) Director M/s AB Infra Investment Pvt. Ltd. having its Registered Office at 53 Homeland Enclave Gonia Road Bathinda (Punjab)

Also At: 2nd Address: R/o Ward No. 10 Near Old SBOP Raman Mandi Bathinda (Punjab)

(CD 3) Sh. Gaurav Goyal S/o Sh. Darshan Paul (DIN No. 07320785) Director M/s AB Infra Investment Pvt. Ltd. having its Registered Office at 53 Homeland Enclave Gonia Road Bathinda (Punjab)

Also At: 2nd Address: R/o House No. 60 Ward No. 06 Raman Mandi Bathinda (Punjab)

(CD 4) Sh. Bishnu Kumar @ Bishnu Goyal @ Bishnu Kumar S/o Sh. Prakash Chand R/o 54 Opposite Lake No. 2 Homeland Enclave Gonia Road Bathinda 151001 (Punjab)

(CD 5) M/s Apex Fiber India Pvt. Ltd. having its Registered Office at 18 Chanderlok Enclave Patimpura New Delhi-110034 through its Directors

(CD 6) M/s Home Land City Projects Pvt. Ltd. having Registered Office at 18, 1st Floor Chanderlok Enclave Patimpura New Delhi-110034

Also At: 2nd Address: Cabin No. 3, 3rd Floor, C-35, Madhu Vihar, Patparganj, New Delhi-110091

Also At: 3rd Address: 374 Room No. 05 DDA Flats Welcome Seelampur III Delhi-110053

Also At: 4th Address: Shop No. 82-83 Homeland City Suratgarh Road Sriganganagar Rajasthan 335001

(CD 7) M/s Isha Goyal Pvt. Ltd. (formerly Isha Land Base Pvt. Ltd.) having its Registered Office at Shop No. 03 Plot No. 6-7 Mayakunj Main Road Gaziabad-201002

(CD 8) M/s GH City Projects Pvt. Ltd. having Registered Office at 18, 1st Floor Chanderlok Enclave Patimpura New Delhi-110034

Also At: 2nd Address: Cabin No. 1 Second Floor, C-35, Madhu Vihar, Patparganj, New Delhi-East

(CD 9) M/s HA Estates Pvt. Ltd. having Registered Office at 18 1st Floor, Chanderlok Enclave Patimpura New Delhi-110034

Also At: 2nd Address: Cabin No. 3, 3rd Floor, C-35, Madhu Vihar, Patparganj, New Delhi-110091

Also At: 3rd Address: Site Address NH-15, Suratgarh Road Sri Ganganagar

Also At: 4th Address: Cabin No. 1, Second Floor, C-35, Madhu Vihar, Patparganj, New Delhi-East

Also At: 5th Address: 374 Room No. 03 DDA Flats Welcome Seelampur III Delhi 110053

Also At: 6th Address: Shop No 82-83 Homeland City Suratgarh Road Sriganganagar Rajasthan-335001

Also At: 7th Address: 805 Vikrant Tower 4 Rajindra Place Delhi

(CD 10) M/s GH Estates Pvt. Ltd. having Registered Office at 18 1st Floor Chanderlok Enclave Patimpura New Delhi-110034

Also At: 2nd Address: Cabin No. 3, 3rd Floor, C-35, Madhu Vihar, Patparganj, New Delhi-110091

Also At: 3rd Address: Site Address NH-15 Suratgarh Road Sri Ganganagar

Also At: 4th Address: Cabin No. 2, Second Floor, C-35, Madhu Vihar, Patparganj, New Delhi-East

Also At: 5th Address: 374 Room No. 02 DDA Flats Welcome Seelampur III Delhi 110053

Also At: 6th Address: Shop No 82-83 Homeland City Suratgarh Road Sriganganagar Rajasthan-335001

Also At: 7th Address: 905 Vikrant Tower 4 Rajindra Place Delhi

This is to notify that as per the Recovery Certificate issued in pursuance of orders of the Presiding Officer, DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL CHANDIGARH (DRT 1) in OA/1717/2022 of Rs. 48,83,59,370.20 (Rupees Forty Eight Crores Eighty Three Lakhs Fifty Nine Thousands Three Hundred Seventy And Paise Twenty only) along with pendente lite and future interest @ 10.25% Compound Interest Monthly w.e.f. 18/08/2022 till realization and costs of Rs. 1,50,005/- (Rupees One Lakh Fifty Thousands Five Only) has become due against you (Jointly and severally/Fully/Limited).

2. You are hereby directed to pay the above sum within 15 days of the receipt of the notice, failing which the recovery shall be made in accordance with the Recovery of Debts Due to Banks and Financial Institutions Act, 1993 and Rules there under.

3. You are hereby ordered to declare on an affidavit the particulars of your assets on or before the next date of hearing.

4. You are hereby ordered to appear before the undersigned on 13.10.2026 at 10:30 a.m. for further proceedings.

5. In addition to the sum aforesaid, you will also be liable to pay:

(a) Such interests as is payable for the period commencing immediately after this notice of the certificate / execution proceedings.

(b) All costs, charges and expenses incurred in respect of the service of this notice and warrants and other processes and all other proceedings taken for recovering the amount due.

Given under my hand and the seal of the Tribunal, on this date: 24.09.2026.

Recovery Officer
DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL CHANDIGARH (DRT 1)

Majithia alleges cops tapped ED officials' phones

CHANDIGARH, OCTOBER 7
Shiromani Akali Dal (SAD) leader Bikram Majithia on Wednesday alleged that the police were tapping the phones of Enforcement Directorate (ED) officials posted at its Jalandhar and Chandigarh offices. He also accused the police officials of facilitating the alleged escape of Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann’s OSD Rajbir Ghuman and his associates Nitin Gohal and Jatin Gohal, who have been booked by the CBI. Majithia alleged that the Chief Minister’s residence had become a hub of “wheeling and dealing”, with the Gohal brothers allegedly acting as liaisons in the cash-for-transfer case. He alleged that the police sat on the ED’s request for registration of an FIR for 67 days before the CBI intervened. He demanded a thorough probe into the alleged links between Nitin and Jatin Gohal and Krishanu Sharda, an alleged middleman who was arrested in a bribery case involving DIG Harcharan Singh Bhullar. — TNS

CBI files 251-page FIR against CM's OSD, aides

RUCHIKA M KHANNA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

CHANDIGARH, OCTOBER 7
The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) registered a 251-page FIR against Rajbir Singh Ghuman, Officer on Special Duty to Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann, and five of his aides around midnight on the same day the Punjab and Haryana High Court entrusted the case to the central agency. Following the registration of the case under Section 120-B of the IPC, Section 61(2) of the BNS and Sections 7, 7A, 8 and 12 of the Prevention of Corruption Act, the CBI conducted coordinated searches at eight places on Tuesday evening. The searches lasted for over six hours. According to the FIR, the crime took place between 2023 and 2026. It mentions that a letter written by the Enforcement Directorate (ED) to the Punjab DGP was sent to the agency on October 5. The letter revealed the involvement of OSD Rajbir Ghuman, Nitin Gohal, Jitin Gohal, Romi Raja Mahajan, Bir Devinder



Raid underway at the CM camp office in Chandigarh. FILE

and Rajdeep Singh Nagra, a rice sheller owner, besides unknown private persons and public servants, “who have acted in criminal conspiracy for taking bribes for matters relating to policy formulation, amendment to departmental rules, administrative approvals, tender conditions, licensing matters, land use conversion matters, property disputes, revenue and land-related issues in lieu of pecuniary benefits”. The FIR further states that “...in compliance with the orders of the Punjab and Haryana High Court, a regular case is hereby reg-

istered...” The investigation has been entrusted to KL Moses, ASP, CBI. The case, registered on the complaint of Akshay Kumar, Assistant Director, ED, Jalandhar Zonal Office, was registered around midnight on October 5. The FIR also contains the entire October 5 judgment of the Division Bench of the High Court, the chats mentioned by the ED in its letter to the Punjab DGP and the entire letter written by the ED to the DGP, describing how it unearthed the scam during an investigation into the money-laundering case registered against Nitin

Gohal. It also mentions documents and their descriptions, including chats of Rajdeep Singh Nagra, Jitin Gohal, Nitin Gohal, Krupan Sharma, Kaku Ahluwalia, Chuspinder Chahal, IPS officer Tushar Gupta and Amritpal Dhindsa; chats regarding the issuance of fake internship letters and courses; details of cash payments made for the maintenance of SUV; Jashneet Singh and hawala payments; besides payments made by an IFS officer. Further, orders for the transfer of officers in the Punjab Government, allegedly influenced by the accused, have also been annexed to the FIR. The questioning of Nitin Gohal by the ED following a raid at his residence in Kharar this year has also been attached. The documents also highlight a chat concerning the recommendation of an Additional Superintendent Engineer in Punjab State Power Corporation Limited for a key posting at Mohali, besides chats relating to demands for copies of papers connected with coal mining.

SHO suspended, two detained for showering petals on CBI's vehicle

PATIALA, OCTOBER 7
The Punjab Police have suspended an SHO and detained two people hours after some residents showered flower petals on the vehicle of the Central Bureau of Investigation team, which searched the residence of Rajbir Singh Ghuman, who is an Officer on Special Duty to Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann, at Gharachon village in Sangrur district on Tuesday evening. A senior official said SHO Yashpal Sharma had been suspended for negligence on duty. “We have detained some people from Gharachon in the wake of the CM’s Sangrur visit today,” added the official. Other than Ghuman’s residence at Gharachon village, the central agency also searched the CM’s camp office in Sector 2, Chandigarh, along with several locations in Mohali, Gurdaspur, Ludhiana, Patiala linked to the people named in its investigation. — TNS

Mann alleges BJP hand behind ED, CBI raids ahead of elections

AMAN SOOD
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

SANGRUR, OCTOBER 7
Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann on Wednesday attributed the recent Enforcement Directorate (ED) and Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) raids in the state to the BJP, alleging that such actions were politically motivated ahead of the 2027 Assembly elections. Mann, who was in Sangrur to attend official events, said his government had come to power to serve the people and not to make

money through transfers. “We have not come to make money from transfers, we have come to serve the people,” Mann said, alleging that the BJP was behind the ED and CBI raids. He claimed that after an eight-hour investigation, the agencies found nothing incriminating and asserted that such raids could not intimidate the people of the state. He alleged that similar raids had been conducted in other states, including Chhattisgarh, Bengal, Delhi and Haryana, which, like Punjab, are headed



CM Bhagwant Mann during an event in Sangrur on Wednesday.

people of the state. Mann said the state was being unfairly blamed for the

drug trade, alleging that the network operated through Gujarat, and maintained that

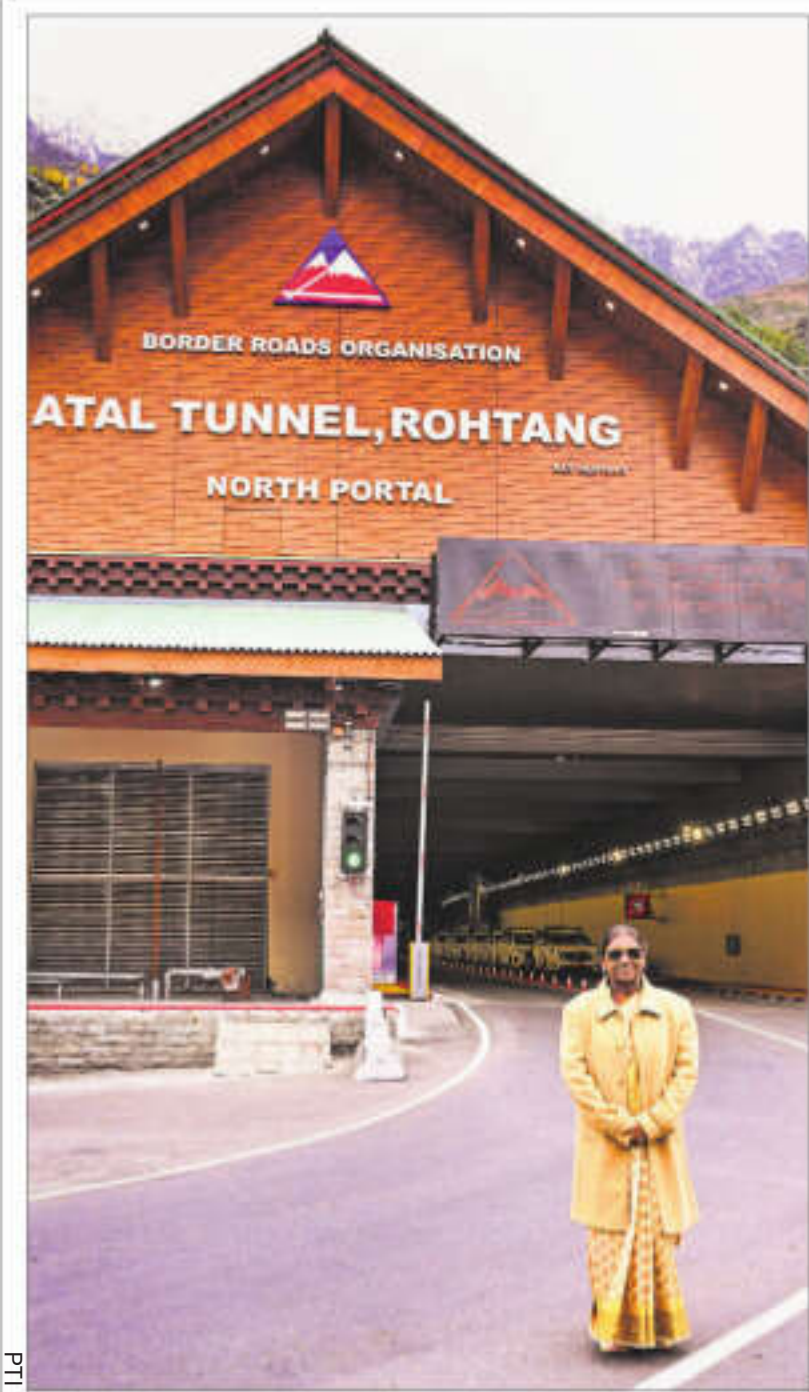
his government was working to make the state drug-free. At a separate event, Mann launched the ‘Mera Ghar Mere Naam’ campaign aimed at resolving ownership issues arising from the ‘Lal Lakir’ demarcation in villages. He handed over ownership certificates to beneficiaries from Balamgarh, Natt and Burj Sedha villages in the Dhuri area. Earlier, Mann inaugurated a water treatment plant at Bararwal village near Dhuri, constructed at a cost of Rs 47 crore.

Prez tours Atal Tunnel, connects with Lahaul

Murmu becomes second occupant of Rashtrapati Bhavan to travel through strategic tunnel

ABHINAV VASHISHT

KULLU, OCTOBER 7
President Droupadi Murmu on Wednesday visited the 9.02-km Atal Tunnel, the world's longest highway tunnel above 10,000 feet, becoming the second President to tour the strategic engineering marvel after Ram Nath Kovind, who visited on June 11, 2022. Her earlier scheduled visit on April 29 had been cancelled due to adverse weather. She reached Manali a day earlier for a three-day stay.
The tunnel was inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on October 3, 2020 and built at a cost of Rs 3,200 crore. President Murmu travelled through the entire tunnel to the North Portal, where local people welcomed her in traditional style. Minister Rajesh Dharmani presented her with a memento. Governor Kavinder Gupta and Lady Governor Bindu Gupta accompanied her. Lahaul MLA Anuradha Rana also welcomed the President and submitted the demands of the residents of Lahaul and Spiti. Manali MLA Bhuvneshwar Gaur was also present.
Officers of the Border Roads Organisation's Project Yojak briefed her in detail about the tunnel's construction and other important tunnels planned



President Droupadi Murmu at the Hadimba Temple in Manali; and (left) Murmu at the south portal of the Atal Tunnel on Wednesday.

MANALI MOMENTS

- The President strolled down Manali's Mall Road on Wednesday evening, dropping in at the Tibetan Emporium to shop
- The visit put Kullu's traditional food in the spotlight, with the administration serving special meals built around local, often overlooked grains and recipes
- Tuesday night's dinner brought
- The President strolled down Manali's Mall Road on Wednesday evening, dropping in at the Tibetan Emporium to shop
- The visit put Kullu's traditional food in the spotlight, with the administration serving special meals built around local, often overlooked grains and recipes
- Tuesday night's dinner brought

on the Manali-Leh road. The President took keen interest in the engineering and technical aspects of the tunnel and admired the scenic Himalayan landscape around it. President Murmu herself belongs to a

Scheduled Tribe community, which has created a deep connection with the tribal people of Lahaul. The district administration restricted tourism activities during her tour. She later visited the Hadimba Tem-

ple at Dhungri and offered prayers to Goddess Hadimba. Security was tightened across Manali, with special arrangements on the routes to the Atal Tunnel and the temple. In view of the VVIP move-

ment, the tunnel remained closed to tourists from 6 am to 12 noon. Press correspondents were not permitted to cover the event. Kullu SP Abishek Sekar said an advisory had been issued in advance so that peo-

ple could plan their journeys. Vehicles bound for Rohtang Pass were allowed to proceed and were stopped only briefly at the Vashisht barrier.

This is only the second presidential visit to the valleys of Lahaul since the tunnel became operational. Several other dignitaries have visited it earlier, including Union Health Minister Jagat Prakash Nadda and Union Commerce and Industry and Textiles Minister Piyush Goyal. Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar, former Chief of Defence Staff General Bipin Rawat, former Army Chief General MM Naravane, former Union Minister Anurag Thakur and former Chief Minister Jai Ram Thakur had attended the operational inauguration. Union Defence Minister Rajnath Singh and Union Road Transport and Highways Minister Nitin Gadkari visited the tunnel after its completion but before its inauguration.

The tunnel has transformed access to Lahaul, ensuring year-round connectivity to a region that was once cut off for about five months every winter when Rohtang Pass remained closed. President Murmu will leave Himachal on October 8, and security nakas will be set up at several places during her departure.

Pratibha asks ECI to block parties using Virbhadra's name

SHIMLA, OCTOBER 7
Former Himachal Pradesh Congress Committee president Pratibha Singh has urged the Election Commission of India (ECI) not to permit the registration of any political party using the name of her late husband and former Himachal Pradesh Chief Minister Virbhadra Singh.

In a letter to the poll panel, Pratibha also sought an opportunity to be heard before the commission takes any decision on applications for registration of political parties using his name or names closely associated with his legacy.

Her letter follows reports and social media posts about attempts to float political outfits in Virbhadra Singh's name. Names being circulated include "Rashtravadi Virbhadra Congress" and "Veer Congress". She also alleged that efforts were being made to facilitate the formation of parties using names such as "Raja", "Bushahar" and "Raja Bushahar", which are closely associated with the former CM. Pratibha Singh did not

name any individual or specify where the alleged attempts to register such political outfits were being made.

Virbhadra Singh, who served as Himachal CM for six terms and also held the position of Union Cabinet Minister, continues to enjoy considerable public recognition in the state, she said.

"We have no objection to the freedom of any person to form a new political party, but using or misusing the name and goodwill of my late husband is not acceptable. Neither I nor any member of my family has authorised or consented to it," she wrote.

She urged the ECI to take appropriate action and not approve the registration of any political party under the names mentioned in her letter, or under any similar name that, she alleged, could misuse Virbhadra Singh's name or legacy.

She also requested the commission to ensure that she is given an opportunity to present her views before deciding on any such application in the future. — TNS

Ritu Negi dropped from ₹1-cr kabaddi award list

No explanation for omission of gold medallist; Sports Minister promises to examine file

SUBHASH RAJTA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

SHIMLA, OCTOBER 7
In a sudden turn of events, Asian Games gold medallist and Arjuna awardee Ritu Negi has been dropped from the list of Himachal kabaddi players eligible for the state government's enhanced cash award, leaving the sports person and her family shocked. Negi's name figured in the list of four Himachal players along with Pushpa Rana,

Jyoti Thakur and Bhavna Thakur just about a week ago. Her name was also included in a congratulatory post shared by CM Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu on Facebook. However, her name was missing from a government press release issued two days ago announcing an increase in the cash award for the kabaddi players from Rs 33 lakh each to Rs 1 crore. Sports Minister Yadvinder Goma said he was unaware of

the reason for the omission. "I will see the file and check with the Chief Minister," he said when asked about Negi's exclusion. Negi, who hails from Sirmaur and is married in Haryana, said she was shocked and disappointed by the sudden decision. "I was Himachal's daughter until a week ago. The CM shared a congratulatory message on Facebook, while Leader of Opposition Jai Ram Thakur and Anurag Thakur

called to congratulate me. I fail to understand what happened two days ago," she said. She termed the omission insulting, pointing out that she had won several medals for both the country and the state. Her father, Bhawan Singh Negi, questioned whether her marital status could be a reason for excluding her. "Does marriage change the fact that she is Himachal's daughter?" he asked. He pointed out that Negi had received the state's

cash award for her 2023 Asian Games gold even though she was married at the time.

Negi acknowledged that she would receive an award from the Haryana government under its sports policy but said athletes had received awards from more than one state. She said she was employed with Railways and did not represent Haryana in domestic competitions, while having represented Himachal Pradesh several times.

Sukhu launches projects worth ₹108 cr in Shimla

Shimla: Himachal Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu on Wednesday inaugurated and laid the foundation stones of three development projects worth ₹108.16 crore in Shimla. — TNS

H.P. STATE CIVIL SUPPLIES CORPORATION LIMITED
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EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

Himachal Pradesh State Civil Supplies Corporation Limited, Shimla invites EOI (Expression of Interest) for the empanelment of Original Equipment Manufacturers (OEMs)/Authorized Dealers for the supply of all types of **Electric & Electronic Items, Energy Saving Equipment, Solar System & Appliances, CCTV, Central Heating & Cooling System, Public Address System, Smart Classroom Solutions and Vocational & Industrial Training Equipment, Annual Maintenance Contract (AMC)** etc. for a period of two years i.e. 2026-27 & 2027-28. The detailed EOI notice, EOI document and other instructions can be downloaded or viewed online from the portal <https://hptenders.gov.in>. The last date of submission of online EOI, Earnest Money Deposit, EOI document fee and processing fee shall be **upto 02.11.2026 by 04:00 PM**. The EOI shall be opened on **03.11.2026 at 11:00 AM**.

Managing Director

GOVERNMENT OF PUNJAB
PATIALA URBAN PLANNING & DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

PUDA Complex, Urban Estate Phase-II, Patiala
Tender Reference No. 184/PDA/DE(C)/2026/216738
Date: 07.10.2026

Divisional Engineer (Civil), PDA Patiala invites online bids for **"Repair of Park No. 33, 37, 38, 39, 65, 66, 67, 68, 69 and 64 in Urban Estate, Phase-2 at Patiala (DNIT Amount: Rs. 75.16 Lacs)."**

Closing Date & Time : **15.10.2026 at 01:00 p.m.**
For details login to : <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>

NOTE: Any corrigendum(s) to the Tender Notice shall be published on the above website only.

DPR/Pb/1319/12/2026-27/15950

ARMY PUBLIC SCHOOL TIBRI,
MIL STATION GURDASPUR, MOB NO. 8427093357

1. Sealed quotations/tenders form are invited for opening of Tuck Shop for the period from (01 Dec 2026 to 30 Nov 2027) during school hours at Army Public School, Tibri within 07 days of publication of this advertisement.

2. Contractors to bid for the maximum rebate offer with minimum payable is Rs 3000.00 per month. Rent, electricity and water charges as generated by MES be paid on actual.

3. Tender form can be downloaded from Army Public School, Tibri web site www.apstibri.in. Quotations/tender form should not be sent through e-mails.

4. Tender form will be dropped at the earmarked quotation box placed at gate No 1 of Army Public School, Tibri Mil Stn Gurdaspur will only be accepted.

Sd/- Principal

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PUDA Bhawan, Sector-62, S.A.S. Nagar
Tender Notice No. 1754-1759
Dated 06.10.2026

Divisional Engineer (H-1), GMADA, S.A.S. Nagar invites online bids for:-

1. Providing and fixing of playways and other landscape features with 1 year maintenance in Park (Near Smadh), Sector 77, S.A.S. Nagar.
2. Development of horticulture works in N-Choe along Sec 67 with 3 year maintenance at S.A.S. Nagar.
3. Plantation on internal roads of IT City. S.A.S. Nagar with 3 year maintenance.

Closing Date & Time: **21.10.2026 at 12:00 Noon**
For details login to: <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>

DPR/Pb/1324/12/2026-27/15924

ਟੈਕਸੀ ਹਾਇਰ ਕਰਨ ਲਈ ਕੁਟੇਸ਼ਨ ਨੋਟਿਸ
ਡਾਇਰੈਕਟੋਰੇਟ ਸ਼ਹਿਰੀਲਭ ਕਾਸਟਸ ਸਬ ਪਲਾਨ, ਐਸ.ਸੀ.ਓ. 6, ਫੇਜ਼-1, ਐਸ.ਏ.ਐਸ. ਨਗਰ
ਟੈਲੀਫੋਨ ਨੰ. 0172-2220801, 2220802

EOOffice File No. 1029949

ਡਾਇਰੈਕਟੋਰੇਟ ਸ਼ਹਿਰੀਲਭ ਕਾਸਟਸ ਸਬ ਪਲਾਨ, ਐਸ.ਸੀ.ਓ. 6, ਫੇਜ਼-1, ਐਸ.ਏ.ਐਸ. ਨਗਰ ਵਲੋਂ Monthly Basis 'ਤੇ ਇਕ ਸਾਲ ਲਈ SUV ਗੱਡੀ (Group-1 Rs. 5.00 Lac to Rs. 10.00 Lac) ਟੈਕਸੀ ਹਾਇਰ ਕਰਨ ਲਈ ਸੀਲਬੰਦ ਕੁਟੇਸ਼ਨਾਂ ਦੀ ਮੰਗ ਕੀਤੀ ਜਾਂਦੀ ਹੈ ਅਤੇ ਸਰਕਾਰੀ ਕੰਮਾਂ ਲਈ ਗੱਡੀ ਕਿਰਾਏ 'ਤੇ ਲੈਣ ਸਬੰਧੀ ਪੰਜਾਬ ਸਰਕਾਰ ਵਿੱਤ ਵਿਭਾਗ ਵਲੋਂ ਜਾਰੀ ਪੱਤਰ ਮਿਤੀ 13.02.2026 ਦੀਆਂ ਸ਼ਰਤਾਂ ਇੰਨ-ਬਿੰਨ ਲਾਗੂ ਹੋਣਗੀਆਂ ਅਤੇ ਜੇਕਰ ਕਿਸੇ ਨੇ ਕੋਈ ਸੂਚਨਾ ਲੈਣੀ ਹੋਵੇ ਤਾਂ ਇਸ ਦਫਤਰ ਨਾਲ ਦਫਤਰੀ ਸਮੇਂ ਦੌਰਾਨ ਸੰਪਰਕ ਕੀਤਾ ਜਾਵੇ। ਇਸ ਦਫਤਰ ਵਲੋਂ ਬਿਨਾਂ ਕੋਈ ਕਾਰਨ ਦੱਸੇ ਕਿਸੇ ਜਾਂ ਸਾਰੇ ਟੈਂਡਰਾਂ ਨੂੰ ਅਸਵੀਕਾਰ ਜਾਂ ਰੱਦ ਕਰਨ ਦਾ ਅਧਿਕਾਰ ਰਾਖਵਾਂ ਰੱਖਿਆ ਜਾਂਦਾ ਹੈ। ਕੁਟੇਸ਼ਨ ਭੇਜਣ ਦੀ ਆਖਰੀ ਮਿਤੀ 15.10.2026, ਸਮਾਂ ਸ਼ਾਮ 4.00 ਵਜੇ ਤੱਕ ਇਸ ਦਫਤਰ ਵਿਖੇ ਭੇਜੀਆਂ ਜਾਣ।

DPR/Pb/3678/12/2026-27/15927

WORLD Sight DAY
8 October, 2026

Let's Pledge to get our Eyes checked regularly on this World Sight Day

To keep your eyes healthy, eat a nutritious diet and exercise regularly.

Wear sunglasses / goggles when going out in bright sunlight.

Take 20 seconds break from screen after every 20 minutes and look at an object 20 feet away.

Children should play outside instead of playing games on mobile phones.

आँखें हूँ अनमोल

आँखों का ख्याल
जिंदगी खुशहाल

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The Tribune

ESTABLISHED IN 1881

Pak spy ring

Wake-up call for armed forces, intel agencies

A Pakistan-sponsored espionage network that was targeting the Indian Navy's Eastern Naval Command has been busted, but the audacity of its operations has set alarm bells ringing across the country. It is apparent that national security is at risk not only from sophisticated technology but also human frailty. Operation Firewall-2026, led by the Andhra Pradesh Counter Intelligence Cell in coordination with the Naval Intelligence, anti-terrorism squads and police forces of 10 states, has reportedly identified 18 suspects, including 13 naval personnel.

The modus operandi was tailor-made for the digital age. Pakistani intelligence operatives allegedly used fake identities, posing as women on Facebook and subsequently shifting conversations to WhatsApp. After gaining trust through personal conversations, romantic overtures, video calls and financial inducements, the handlers sought information about naval ships, submarines, commanders and sensitive installations. The reported use of Indian SIM cards, stolen or shared WhatsApp activation OTPs and cryptocurrency payments points to a well-oiled module.

In 2019, Operation Dolphin's Nose exposed a similar Pakistan-linked spy racket that had the Eastern Naval Command on its radar. The recurrence suggests that counter-intelligence cannot end with arrests. It must also address why trained personnel remain susceptible to honey-traps and financial allurements. Digital surveillance, intelligence-sharing, coordinated multi-state operations and forensic examination of seized devices appear to have helped investigators identify the network and reconstruct its communication and financial links. But technology alone cannot provide the final defence. The armed forces must strengthen cybersecurity discipline and mechanisms for reporting suspicious online approaches without fear or stigma. National security depends not only on guarding bases and networks, but also on recognising that the first breach may begin with a seemingly harmless conversation or a request for friendship.

Repo rate reset

Borrowers face higher costs ahead

THE Reserve Bank of India has raised the repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.5%, the first increase since February 2023. More significantly, it has shifted its monetary-policy stance from neutral to "calibrated tightening". The message is clear: containing inflation has once again become a priority. The immediate consequence will be higher borrowing costs. Banks are likely to pass on at least part of the increase to borrowers, pushing up interest rates on floating-rate home, vehicle and personal loans. For households already managing high living costs, higher EMIs could squeeze disposable incomes and moderate consumption. Businesses, too, will face costlier credit, potentially affecting investment decisions.

There will, however, be some beneficiaries. Higher interest rates can improve returns for savers, particularly those dependent on fixed deposits and other interest-bearing instruments. Banks may also offer better deposit rates as they compete for funds. The larger economic concern is the trade-off between inflation control and growth. The RBI has raised its FY27 GDP growth projection to 7.1%, indicating that it believes the economy has enough momentum to absorb tighter financial conditions. But higher rates act as a brake on demand. If tightening continues for too long, consumption and private investment could lose momentum.

Inflation has become broader; with food and fuel pressures strengthening, while expensive energy and geopolitical uncertainty threaten to feed into domestic prices. The central bank has projected average headline inflation of about 5.8% over the next three quarters. The hike, therefore, marks a change in direction after a prolonged easing phase. Further hikes should depend on evidence of persistent inflation, not temporary price shocks. For borrowers, the era of cheaper credit may be ending. For the RBI, the harder task begins now — containing inflation without unnecessarily weakening growth.

ON THIS DAY...100 YEARS AGO

The Tribune.

LAHORE, FRIDAY, OCTOBER 8, 1926

Congress and the elections

WE entirely agree with Lala Lajpat Rai when he says in the course of an article published in our last issue that it was a great mistake for the Congress to undertake to contest the elections. Equally do we agree with him in thinking that much of the present regrettable position in the country is due to this mistake. But when he goes farther and deplores the sight of Congressmen fighting Congressmen, we find it difficult to follow him. Why is it a mistake for the Congress to run the elections? Just because the elections have to be and in every country are run by political parties, and the Congress is not a political party but an organisation which, in theory, consists of all political parties in the country who believe in self-government as the goal and "legitimate and peaceful means" as the method for the attainment of that goal, and which, in practice, does contain several of those parties. In other words, it is India's unofficial parliament, just as the Assembly and the Councils are her official, if for the present, embryo parliament; and it aspires in the fullness of time to take the place of the latter. For such a body, it is both incongruous and derogatory to its position to run the elections to the official parliament on the basis of an ordinary political party. But if the Congress is not to run the elections, what is to be its position in regard to them? It can clearly either boycott the elections altogether, just as it did in the first instance, or permit different parties of whom it consists to run the elections on their own account. The first of these alternatives has already been tried and has failed.

OPINION

A new US-China order takes shape

Beijing is likely to press ahead with its aim of hollowing out the Indo-Pacific strategic construct



SHYAM SARAN
FORMER FOREIGN SECRETARY

ONE should assess the outcome of the recent summit meeting between US President Donald Trump and Chinese President Xi Jinping in Washington DC as the midpoint in a year-long continuum. It commenced with their meeting in Busan on October 30, 2025, and will conclude with their talks on the margins of the US-hosted G20 summit in Miami in mid-December. Another meeting has been proposed during the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation conference in Shenzhen (China) in mid-November.

The Busan summit was a truce with a finite validity. It set the stage for the May 2026 Beijing summit, which announced, for the first time, "a constructive relationship of strategic stability". Busan paved the way for a more bounded phase of US-China geopolitical rivalry.

The phrase "strategic stability" harks back to an earlier, though short-lived, commitment to reciprocal "strategic reassurance" in 2009 in the initial phase of the Barack Obama administration. China had then declared its red lines — Tibet, Xinjiang and Taiwan — and, for the first time, extended its "core interests" to include the South China Sea.

This was also the origin of the short-lived "G2" narrative, projecting the US and China as joint stakeholders in upholding the international order. The US appeared to have acknowledged Chinese interests in the South China Sea, but later announced its "pivot to Asia". This evolved into the Indo-Pacific strategy with India as a key component. We now see signs of the reduced salience of the Indo-Pacific in US strategy under Trump 2.0. The



CONTINUUM : Xi Jinping and Donald Trump are expected to meet in Shenzhen and Miami in the coming months. AP/PTI

Indo-Pacific Command has reverted to its previous name, the Pacific Command.

The Quad grouping of India, Australia, Japan and the US has been downgraded. Japan and South Korea, which are critical US allies in the region, face uncertainty and lack of credibility in US treaty assurances. Taiwan has an even more uncertain future because it is becoming increasingly likely that the US will not intervene in its defence in case of a Chinese military invasion.

There is a revival of the erstwhile G2 framing today, but in terms which carry greater traction than in 2009. The forthcoming summits in Shenzhen and Miami might indicate whether this time round, the geopolitical shift presaged in 2009 has become definitive.

I do not see the Washington summit as mostly pomp and ceremony with meagre substantive outcomes. There were ominous political developments during the visit which have further decreased the significance of the Indo-Pacific in the US strategic calculus. The most important relates specifically to Japan but will reverberate across the region, including India.

At the welcome ceremony for Xi on September 24, Trump said that

Navigating this complex landscape will test India's diplomatic skills like never before.

the two countries' common interests had "even made us allies in World War II. Look at the greatness that we had together fighting in World War II." Trump repeated this creative version of history at the banquet for Xi when he invoked the Flying Tigers or the American volunteer pilots who flew vital supplies in aid of the forces of the Republic of China (ROC) under President Chiang Kai-shek during the war.

The ally Trump spoke about were the forces under ROC and not under the Chinese Communist Party. ROC forces were battling the Japanese aggressors on one side and the Communist

forces on the other. What China has been doing in recent years is to project a fictional historical continuity between the ROC and the People's Republic of China (PRC).

It was on November 25, 2025, that Xi used this narrative in a phone conversation with Trump. He is reported to have said: "China and the US once fought side by side against fascism and militarism, and should now work together to safeguard the outcome of World War II." He further argued that Taiwan's return to China was a key part of the post-war order.

That Trump has acquiesced in this carefully calculated Chinese framing is politically significant and has implications for the Indo-Pacific.

China has succeeded in shifting the fundamental narrative of US-China relations from the post-Nixon transformation in 1972 to the post-World War II order of 1945. Their partnership derives from the shared custodianship of the post-1945 order, in which Japan's status is that of a defeated nation. The acute discomfort of one of the staunchest US allies is palpable.

In his remarks at the welcome banquet, Xi made this narrative explicit: "Chinese and American people stood shoulder to shoulder

der in a fight against Japanese militaristic aggression." He added, "Such a friendship, forged in blood and fire, will surely live on through generations."

Some analysts have dismissed the US acquiescence to this framing as rhetorical, designed to extract trade and other concessions from China. On the contrary, these semantic shifts portend a more consequential strategic shift in the US-China equation. A "co-victors" framing is the scaffolding for a possible grand bargain, but on Chinese terms. This is a bargain which puts Japan in the category of a historical adversary and the restitution of Taiwan as the unfinished agenda of the post-World War II arrangements among the victors.

One should expect China to press ahead with its aim of hollowing out the Indo-Pacific strategic construct, put Japan on the defensive and corrode the opposition to unification with the mainland in Taiwan by highlighting the lack of credibility of US security assurances to the island.

The US Fact Sheet on the Washington summit has tried to recover some of the ground lost to China by using this formulation: "Since World War II, the US forward military presence has preserved a free and open Indo-Pacific."

This may be a belated rear-guard action by some elements within the American administration. If the trend line is confirmed and carried forward in Shenzhen and Miami, then countries like India, Japan, South Korea, Indonesia and Australia further afield may need to acknowledge the altered geopolitical landscape and explore ways in which they can best safeguard their interests together.

This will require a mix of engagement and constraint in dealing with a more confident and assertive China. It will also involve leveraging the still formidable US power in the region, wherever and whenever possible. Navigating this complex landscape will test India's diplomatic skills like never before.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

China and the United States must act as responsible major countries. — Xi Jinping

Seeing is believing

ARUN KAMPANI

THE police uniform has been dusted and put away. The Oxford shoes have been dumped somewhere, and the cap remains a souvenir. There is no morning reporting to worry about. Finally, not addressing anyone as 'Sir' comes as a huge relief.

The other day, I chanced upon an old photograph of mine. Young, raw, wearing the ceremonial uniform, I was ready to leave the training academy for my first posting to Delhi. So here I was, in an alien city, a young ACP (Assistant Commissioner of Police).

I had worked hard to get there. The UPSC examination had been ruthless, and the training academy was no kinder. But Delhi seemed welcoming, and I rather enjoyed the importance people attached to being a cop. There was an office, a Mahindra jeep, a driver and an area under my jurisdiction. It was exciting.

The SHO (Station House Officer) was my subordinate, and that carried its own pressure. I was expected to know what was happening in my area, but had no sources except my seniors.

My boss was a smart, sharp man. Sensing my naiveté, he asked me to keep getting briefed by the SHO on the law-and-order situation. I did so. The SHO was always reassuring, telling me that all was well.

Whenever I reported back, my boss would say, "Keep your eyes open." And then, sometimes, as an afterthought, "Keep your ears open." I began listening to everyone.

Those were days of frequent bank robberies. I was advised to go on night patrol as often as possible. One night, I set out with my driver, asking him about the geography of my area.

We crossed an abandoned stretch where I noticed a police picket. "Why a picket here?" I asked. There was hardly anyone around. The driver paused. Then he almost whispered that the SHO Sahib had been waylaid by miscreants while driving through the area one night. They had taken away his watch and wallet.

Then came the mischievous smile. The SHO Sahib, he explained, had a fondness for travelling alone on certain nights. The driver didn't say much, but his eyes spoke volumes. I was young, a complete novice, but I understood.

Perhaps that is why every system needs someone to look again, to ask again, to see for oneself. Checks and balances can sometimes be as simple as a pair of alert eyes.

Urdu poet Jaun Elia said it well: *Kaun seekha hai sirf baaton se, Sabko ik haadsa zaroori hai* (Who learns merely from words? A personal experience is a must).

That was perhaps my first lesson in policing: a supervisory officer needs to see things for himself.

The academy gives you the uniform. The job gives you the designation. And then, quietly, an incident gives you the lesson.

The writer is a retired IPS officer

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Global consensus against violence

Apropos of 'Three years on, Israel has less leeway'; the third anniversary of the Oct 7 attacks on Israel serves as a stark reminder of the horrors of terrorism. However, the nature of international participation and strategic options have shifted significantly over time. Prolonged military actions without a clear diplomatic framework have diminished global leeway, underscoring that military strength alone cannot guarantee long-term security or eradicate violent extremism. To effectively combat terrorism, a robust global consensus against extremist violence is required, while simultaneously addressing the underlying geopolitical instability that fuels it. Only through collective international resolve, strategic moderation, and a commitment to peace can we curb terrorism and ensure lasting stability.

VANDANA, CHANDIGARH

Reinvent non-alignment

Refer to "Three years on, Israel has less leeway"; amid a newly emerging geopolitical order, no foreign policy appears to be ideal. Because no nation is an island unto itself, transactional relationships often eclipse cultural moorings. India's policy of non-alignment since Independence was a developmental necessity — and remains so today. In an era of unprecedented globalisation, India must reinvent its non-aligned status by forging a pragmatic policy that reconciles conflicting interests while placing national imperatives at the centre. Walking a tightrope is a diplomatic art of diplomacy, a delicate effort essential to our future needs. In the face of tougher challenges, India must not budge, stand firm and assert itself.

RAKESH MOHAN SHARMA, PATHANKOT

Promote public transport

Refer to 'Transport constraints'; India's first National Household Travel Survey has brought several revelations to the forefront regarding commuters' choice of mode of travel to the workplace. The stark reality is that only 15% of commuters use public transport and mass-transit systems, such as metros, and suburban rail serves just around 5% of urban workers nationally. These findings must serve as a guiding force

in formulating transport policies. There is an urgent need to strengthen public transport.

KRISHAN KANT SOOD, NANGAL

Light unlocks neuroscience

Refer to 'Brain breakthrough'; the Nobel-winning work on optogenetics marks a major stride in understanding the brain. Scientists found a light-sensitive protein in a tiny alga and adapted it to make nerve cells respond to light. Researchers can now switch neurons on or off to study their role in movement, memory, emotion and behaviour. This is a striking example of scientific serendipity, showing how research on a humble alga yielded an unexpected tool for neuroscience. Light has opened a new path to probe the brain, unravel its mysteries and expand possibilities.

CHANCHAL S MANN, UNA

Focus on sustainable growth

Refer to 'Economic karma is pointing south'; robust GDP growth alongside a weakening rupee, sluggish consumption, rising economic uncertainties and unemployment depicts a strange contradiction. Is the growth really inclusive and a manifestation of improvements in household welfare? In spite of positive economic indicators, there is economic unrest in the market. Sustainable growth is the need of the hour. Policymakers should go beyond headlining GDP only and concentrate on strengthening domestic demand, MSMEs and employment generation. India's challenge is not only to sustain high growth but also to ensure that growth becomes broad-based, employment intensive and inclusive.

SUNITA SIKRI, YAMUNANAGAR

Make officials accountable

With reference to 'HC raps Chief Secy over false DA case affidavit'; if an affidavit submitted by the state's highest-ranking bureaucrat comes under serious judicial scrutiny, what confidence can citizens have in lower-rung officials? Government officers have lost the fear of the law, choosing to blindly follow unethical directives rather than protecting public interest. Administrative accountability must become a living reality, not just a principle on paper.

VITULL K GUPTA, BATHINDA

India's election model loses its sheen



AS young Indians take to the streets to protest the alleged illegality of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and demand the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, the sound of "Gyanu you're done, bro" is surely being heard across the South Asian region and beyond. The management of the 'Great Indian Election' has long been an object of admiration worldwide and has been no less a source of India's soft power, especially in the neighbourhood.

Take, for example, Sri Lanka's former Election Commissioner Mahinda Deshapriya. In 2015, he won much praise for his impartial conduct in both the presidential and parliamentary elections. "His steely resolve brings to mind that redoubtable Indian Election Commissioner TNSeshan who regularly locked horns with India's politicians and vigorously campaigned against electoral corruption," a columnist in the Sri Lankan newspaper *The Sunday Times* wrote then.

The comparison with Seshan was not an exaggeration. Just five years earlier, his predecessor Dayananda Dis-

sanayake had broken down on TV while announcing President Mahinda Rajapaksa's re-election, accusing government institutions of misusing their powers to ensure a favourable result for the incumbent, such that he was unable to ensure the safety of even a single ballot box. Between tears, he requested his "immediate release" from the post.

The ECI and election commissioners (ECs) have long been held up in India's neighbourhood for their courage in standing up to politicians during election time. This is especially true of TN Seshan. In Pakistan, where election results have been fought over since 2013, Seshan is considered the gold standard for the conduct of free and fair elections. Many Pakistani commentators have made the case for Pakistan to stop appointing judges as ECs and emulate the Indian practice of selecting people with administrative experience.

In Bangladesh, where election results have been fiercely rejected by the losing side for decades, one commentator said there were "chief election commissions and election commissioners, but what the country needs is a change-maker" and that India's former Chief Election Commissioner fell in this category.

In Nepal, during the recent parliamentary committee hearings that preceded the appointment of an MP from the opposition Nepali Congress, Guruprasad Wagle, as the Chief Election Commissioner, it was stressed that those in charge of the Election Com-



REPUTATION : The comparison with TN Seshan (third from right) was not an exaggeration. PTI

mission should be as fearless and bold as Seshan.

In 2011, when SY Quraishi was India's Chief Election Commissioner, the ECI set up the India International Institute of Democracy and Election Management (IIDEM). Writing about the IIDEM in an article in 2021, Quraishi noted that it "was envisioned to be an advanced resource centre for learning, training, research and extension on participatory democracy and election management in South Asia and Africa."

He recalled that most of the commissioners from these regions who participated in the ECI's diamond jubilee celebration in January 2010 were of the view that India should share its experience and expertise internationally.

The next year, meeting in New Delhi, the heads of election commissions from SAARC countries established

The only recent election in the South Asian region perceived by voters to have been free and fair was the 2024 Sri Lankan polls.

a Forum of Election Management Bodies of South Asia (FEMBoSA). The IIDEM is now a key institution for FEM-BoSA, providing training and capacity-building programmes for election officials. All countries in the region, with the exception of Pakistan, and including pre-Taliban Afghanistan, have sent teams of election officials to the II-DEM. As recently as November 2025, a press note from the Indian High Commission in Colombo announced that a group of 40 Sri Lankan election officials had participated in a course at the IIDEM.

On the IIDEM page of the ECI site, India's current chairship of International IDEA, an intergovernmental body founded in 1995 to promote democracy, is announced with much fanfare: "With its vast electoral experience, strong democratic institutions, and global credibility, India is uniquely positioned

to lead International IDEA in 2026. India's chairship will show how democracy delivers, deepen collaboration with Election Management Bodies worldwide and amplify knowledge that supports emerging democracies, especially in the Global South."

A 74-page booklet, available on the site, outlines India's themes for its one-year leadership of the organisation as "Democracy for an inclusive, peaceful, resilient and sustainable world" and "thematic priorities" for the year. Among the "key deliverables" are the development of "model international electoral standards", including free media, voter registration and maintaining electoral rolls.

"Transparency in (voter) eligibility determination builds public confidence," it says, killing irony in the gap between preaching and practice. "When citizens understand the criteria, can verify their registration status, and have access to straightforward dispute resolution processes, they trust that the system operates fairly."

The rotating one-year chair of International IDEA is India's until December 2026. India was one of the 14 founding members of the organisation and has always been represented by the CEC. Today, India's face at the forum is Gyanesh Kumar, architect of the controversial SIR that has disenfranchised over 130 million voters.

Accusations of bias and constitutional violations against him have given rise to the ECI's most serious credibility crisis in memory. Word travels

fast in the region and around the world. An institution once admired for its autonomy and looked up to is at risk of losing its international reputation fast. With results of many elections in India already suspect in the eyes of many Indian voters for reasons ranging from the alleged EVM fraud to the SIR, it can be assumed in the light of the new revelations about the unsavoury goings-on in the ECI that results henceforth would be more fiercely contested, just as they are in Pakistan and Bangladesh.

It is noteworthy that the only recent election in the region perceived by voters to have been free, fair and impartially managed was the 2024 Sri Lankan polls, in which the JVP-led National People's Power won a majority in Parliament and its candidate Anura Kumara Dissanayake was elected President.

In 2006, the Pakistan Institute of Legislative Development and Transparency (PILDAT) praised India as a "mature democracy", which, unlike Pakistan and Bangladesh, did not require a "caretaker government" to ensure a free and fair election. "India is one good example of such democracies where the Election Commission becomes a virtual caretaker government during election time and no neutral caretaker government is inducted for the election," says a PILDAT study of the system of caretaker administrations in the region.

Two decades after these words were written, it should surprise no one if the demand for a caretaker administration is raised in India too.

Why it is not wise to rush into online testing



IT is no longer a secret that the task force for exam reforms is in place to push and effectuate the National Testing Agency's (NTA) transition to online exam format. The presence of Nandan Nilekani is to provide a respectable cover to the recommendations from a committee whose members are ideological associates or confirmed acolytes or are expected to be compliant with the diktats of the government.

There is almost an evangelical belief that technology can fix the problem of paper leaks, whose provenance lies elsewhere. The problems of leakage arise out of collusion, corruption and complicity embedded in the system. Against this backdrop, a switchover to online system will only be a leap of faith. Culled from the NTAs experience, the question that is explored here is what happens to the integrity of the exam when the trail of fraud disappears and who, in the process, stands to suffer unequally.

The government order constituting the task force is clear

about the objective of testing the system "anchored on maximum utilisation and leveraging of latest technologies." In para 5(f) of the Terms of Reference, the task force is mandated to recommend "the latest technologies that should be leveraged across all the dimensions of exam conduct, including AI, blockchain and other emerging technologies."

A few years ago, with the Radhakrishnan committee's report on shifting examinations from pen-and-paper method to the online mode, the drift was known. Now, several actors who were associated with the NTA and NEET exam have come out clearly that conducting the exam offline is the root cause of the leaks. The diagnosis is wrong.

The actors are viewing how the NTA can handle it rather than figuring out how the exam can be conducted in a secure, transparent and equitable fashion for students. The possibility that the integrity of the exam can be compromised with the disappearance of the trail of fraud does not appear to be on the radar. People will just not get to know and the government will do the gatekeeping.

Technology by itself could be a problem when many students are in "waithood" as they await digital empowerment. Being able to use a smartphone is not the same as using a computer or laptop. A substantial portion of the students



NOTION : The diagnosis that conducting the exam offline is the root cause of the leaks is wrong. PTI

fall in this category, particularly the ones from poor backgrounds who are first-generation learners.

Research shows that expanding digital access does not guarantee equitable participation by the poor and marginalised. Evidence suggests that expansion of digital infrastructure can reproduce and deepen pre-existing forms of exclusion and can develop new vulnerabilities.

It is a problem for SC, ST and women candidates, particularly for women belonging to these groups. For students of the deprived groups, online examination will be analogous to serving food in the fox's bowl in Aesop's fable, leaving the crane unable to eat. More importantly, if there is a covert objective, with technology, it can be

Online test is easy to hijack by miscreants and for the government to bury the truth.

achieved very well without any trace. In the end, detection becomes well-nigh impossible. Technology can exacerbate the problems within a collusive and gamed ecosystem.

In China's Gaokao exam for college-level entry test, 138 lakh candidates appeared for a pen-and-paper exam. This is not an online test despite China being technologically more advanced and prepared for the switchover. Our own UPSC conducts Civil Services (Preliminary) examinations for 15 lakh candidates on a single day. This exam is not online. The UPSC is ruthless about the cancellation of the whole exam even if leakages take place in a few centres.

Impersonation in online exam is facilitated by the non-availability of adequate nodes

(computer units) for an exam like NEET. A maximum of around 1 lakh nodes is available on a day because there are other online exams conducted by states and other agencies. Consequently, the exam is to be conducted over multiple sessions, depending on the number of candidates. This enables an imposter to appear in different sessions. Though it is possible to put an effective mechanism in place to control it, a corrective against collusion is awfully complicated.

Online exams are mostly conducted in private centres where invigilators are either poorly paid employees or outsourced personnel arranged by a private agency. Whereas, government teachers as invigilators in offline exam have a higher stake in their job and are less amenable to inducements, personnel in private centres can be lured to accept collusive arrangement.

There are solver gangs in operation, new disruptive technologies are being used in connivance with personnel at the centre. During the JEE (Main), 2021, conducted by the NTA, remote screens of candidates were created by attaching a device to the candidate nodes in collusion with some staff at the centres. Answers were keyed in from remote centres, which resulted in the cursor moving without the mouse being used.

In Sonapat, a candidate was

caught and the CBI inquired into the matter. It was successful in booking some of the accused, including a Russian national who was apparently the linchpin. New technology will surface from time to time and catching up will not be easy.

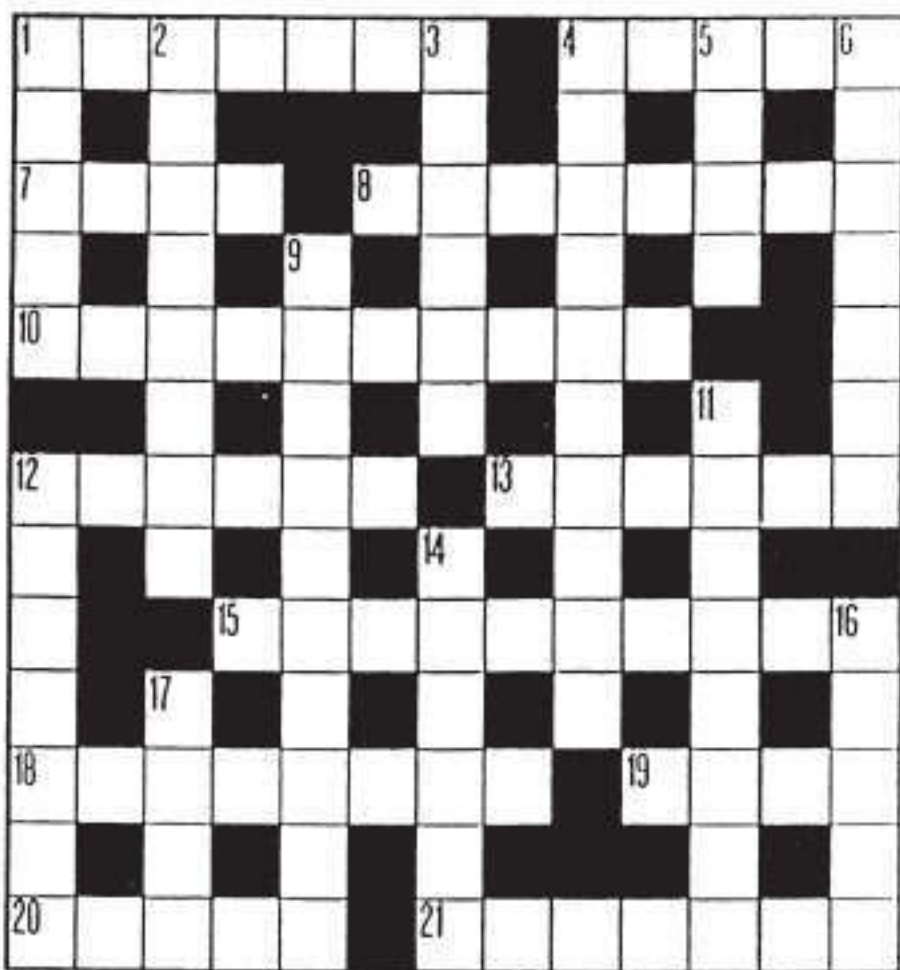
Single-centre cities like Itanagar, Aizawl, Leh, etc are preferred by many candidates as it is easier to orchestrate collusion there. These locations have attracted students from far-off locations and scoring for them has been very high. Particularly of interest are candidates appearing in multiple JEE(M) in a year, improving their scores from a low percentage of 20% to the extremely high of 99%, which is just not possible.

Governments deny malpractices, then create a narrative and control the truth. Online test is easy to hijack by miscreants and for the government to bury the truth. We could be having first-world ambitions, but our state capacity and robustness of systems are highly questionable.

Government actors are keen on online exams, regardless of preparedness and appropriateness, to do the chest-thumping on the one hand and to stave off outside scrutiny on the other. It is perhaps unwise to abandon the pen-and-paper test and rush into the online format without taking care of the basics. If we do, we may have to regret at leisure.

Views are personal

QUICK CROSSWORD



- ACROSS**
- 1 Humorous (7)
 - 4 A region's plants (5)
 - 7 Deceive (4)
 - 8 Fish, source of caviare (8)
 - 10 Inferior (6-4)
 - 12 Irritable (6)
 - 13 Subtle distinction (6)
 - 15 Cause great confusion (5,5)
 - 18 Kept busy (8)
 - 19 Become worn at the edge (4)
 - 20 Loops of a chain (5)
 - 21 To mirror (7)

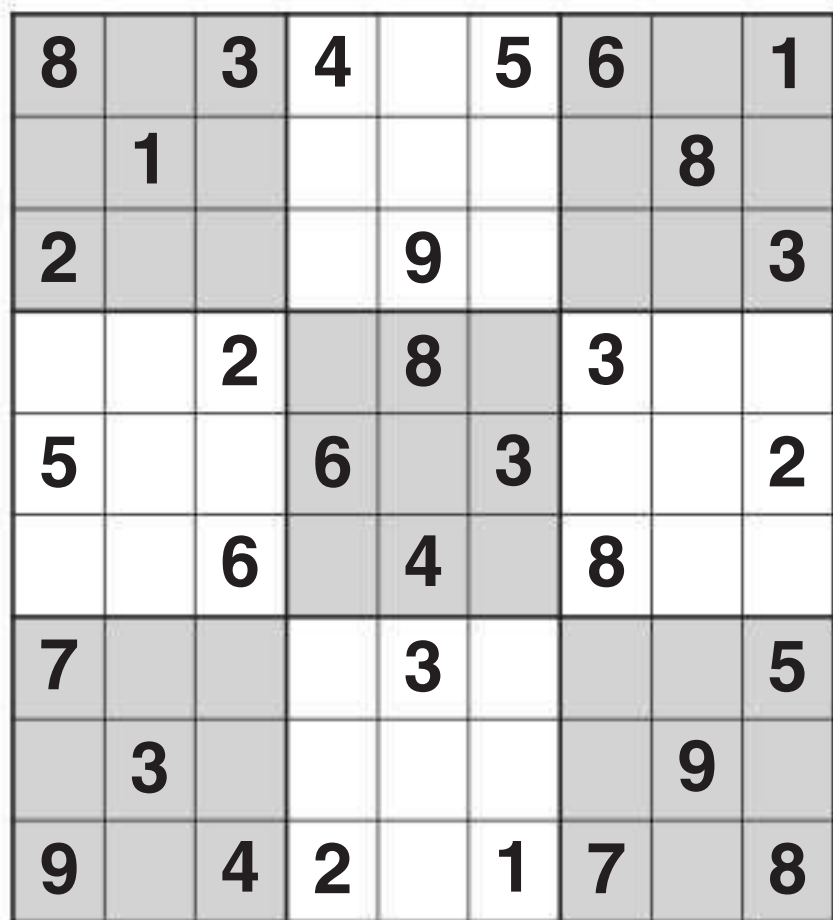
Yesterday's Solution

Across: 1 Aristocracy, 9 Upbraid, 10 Dubai, 11 Pile, 12 Gim-crack, 14 Emblem, 16 Allege, 18 Elegance, 19 Swap, 22 Raise, 23 Treason, 24 White horses.

Down: 2 Rebel, 3 Swan, 4 Ordain, 5 Ridicule, 6 Cabbage, 7 Purple Heart, 8 Ticked pink, 13 Decadent, 15 Blemish, 17 Scotch, 20 Waste, 21 Bear.

- DOWN**
- 1 Betrayer of a friend (5)
 - 2 Mental power (8)
 - 3 Quick witty reply (6)
 - 4 Premiere of play (5,5)
 - 5 Unenclosed (4)
 - 6 General pardon (7)
 - 9 Close to defeat (2,3,5)
 - 11 Wrong-headed (8)
 - 12 Very foolish (7)
 - 14 Rush headlong (6)
 - 16 Underground vault (5)
 - 17 Glance over quickly (4)

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FORECAST

CITY	THURSDAY FRIDAY		18:00 HRS 06:20 HRS	
	MAX	MIN	MAX	MIN
Chandigarh	32	24		
New Delhi	34	23		
Amritsar	34	24		
Bathinda	34	22		
Jalandhar	33	23		
Ludhiana	34	24		
Bhiwani	36	22		
Hisar	36	22		
Sirsa	34	23		
Dharamsala	23	16		
Manali	21	10		
Shimla	20	13		
Srinagar	25	12		
Jammu	32	21		
Kargil	23	04		
Leh	18	02		
Dehradun	31	20		
Mussoorie	21	12		

TEMPERATURE IN °C

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA		CORRIGENDUM			
Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/ CORP./AUTH.	OLD REFERENCE/NIT NO.	NATURE OF CORRIGENDUM	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/CORP./AUTH.	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/E-MAIL
1	HVPNL	NIT NO.33/CWD-2/VOL-XX/HVPN/2026-27 DATED 07.09.2026(ONLINE TENDER ID NO.2026_HBC_545812_1)	DATE OF OPENING BID 06.10.2026 (11:00 HRS) LAST DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION IS EXTENDED UP TO 13.10.2026 (13:00 HRS) (SOCIETIES & CONTRACTORS)	www.hvnpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN
2	HVPNL	QDP-1500(NIT NO.1380 DATED 15.12.2025)	THE LAST DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION IS EXTENDED UP TO 15.10.2026 UP TO 17:00 HRS	www.hvnpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT: www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in

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Three killed as 4-storey building collapses in Delhi’s Seemapuri

Pregnant woman, two children among deceased, 11 rescued

RAHUL GAHLAWAT
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7 Three persons — a pregnant woman (21), a 12-year-old girl and an 18 month-old child — were killed after a building collapsed in Delhi’s Seemapuri area on Wednesday, while 11 persons were rescued from the debris so far, officials said.

The deceased woman, identified as Gulafsa, was around four months pregnant. The identities of the two children have not been ascertained.

Eight of these rescued sustained injuries and were shifted to Rajiv Gandhi Super Speciality Hospital in Tahirpur. They were identified as Momnin Mirja (56), Abdaan (3), Abdul Rehman (28), Devruddin (28), Salma (50), Chote (34), Sakina (35) and Samad (30).

The incident came a month after a building in Satya Niketan, Delhi, came crashing down on September 6, leaving seven persons dead and 12 injured.

A multi-agency search and rescue operation is underway. The cause of the Wednesday building collapse



People gather at the site after a four-storey building collapsed in Seemapuri, New Delhi, on Wednesday. PTI

has not been established yet.

However, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) said residents reported that cracks had developed in the building after earthquake tremors were felt in Delhi on Tuesday. The owner was reportedly in the process of vacating the structure.

The Delhi Fire Services

received a call about the collapse around 3.30 pm and rushed fire tenders to the site. Walls of an adjoining building and the boundary wall of a nearby mosque also fell due to the impact. Teams from the Delhi Police, MCD, Delhi Disaster Management Authority, National Disaster Response Force and Delhi Urban Shelter

Improvement Board (DUSIB) joined the operation.

According to the police, the four-storey structure stood on a 225 sq feet plot. The MCD, however, described it as a three-storey building in a “jhuggi-jhopri” area spread over around 22 square yards (198 square feet) in the DUSIB area near Idgah Machhli Mandi.

Income Tax Dept raids Ramayana producer’s office

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7 The Income Tax (IT) Department on Wednesday reportedly conducted a raid at the premises of film producer Namit Malhotra’s Prime Focus Ltd in Mumbai, which has backed the upcoming film ‘Ramayana’.

The searches were reportedly linked to foreign remittances, although further details could not be ascertained. Prime Focus is a major media and entertainment company with interests spanning visual effects, animation, post-production and content production. Its DNEG arm is handling the visual effects for Ramayana, which is being mounted on a massive scale.

The reported raid came just weeks before the release of the multi-crore film, which is scheduled to release on Diwali next month. Ramayana has been one of the most closely watched Bollywood projects of 2026, with Ranbir Kapoor playing Lord Ram, Sai Pallavi as Sita and Yash as Ravan. Sunny Deol essays Hanuman, while Ravee Dubey plays Lakshman.

Prime Focus’ involvement extends beyond production, with DNEG bringing its international visual-effects expertise to the project. — TNS

Ukrainian drone attack sets oil tanker with 23 Indians ablaze off Black Sea coast

UJWAL JALALI
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7 A Ukrainian drone attack set the Liberian-flagged oil tanker Aframax Rio ablaze off Russia’s Black Sea coast near Sochi, with all 23 Indian crew members rescued.

India on Wednesday condemned a series of attacks on commercial vessels in the region and called for an immediate end to the targeting of merchant ships and seafarers.

The Aframax Rio came under attack on Tuesday evening, triggering a major fire on board. Russia’s Transport Ministry said the entire crew, comprising 23 Indian nationals, had been evacuated safely and that there were no reported casualties. The incident is part of a series of attacks on commercial vessels in the Black Sea that has raised concerns in New Delhi over the safety of Indian seafarers.

The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said at least four commercial vessels had come under attack in recent days, with Indians among the crew members of several of the ships. “We have seen a string of attacks targeting commercial vessels in the Black Sea region. We condemn such attacks that threaten commercial shipping and endanger the lives of our seafaring community,” MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said at his weekly media briefing.

Earlier, the Palau-flagged MV Able was hit in a drone attack. All 18 crew members, including seven Indians, were rescued. One Indian sustained injuries and remains under medical supervision, Jaiswal said. The MEA thanked the Bulgarian authorities for their timely assistance, while the Indian mission in Bulgaria is providing all possible help to the rescued Indian seafarers.

Another vessel, the Togo-flagged Alfa Watan, was attacked on Tuesday, with the fate of its crew still unknown, according to the MEA.

The fourth incident involved MV Royad Mammadov, which was attacked while sailing in the Black Sea with three Indian nationals on board. One of them was injured and has received medical treatment. The Indian Embassy in Romania is in touch with the Indian crew members to ensure their safety and welfare.

MEA: 69 Indians still serving in Russian army

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7 As many as 69 Indian nationals remain with the Russian armed forces, the Ministry of External Affairs said on Wednesday, as it once again urged Indians not to fall for offers to join the Russian army, warning that such recruitment was “fraught with grave danger to life”.

The MEA said 259 Indians were believed to have been recruited into the Russian army, of whom India had secured the early discharge of 139. It was continuing to seek information on the whereabouts of the remaining 69.

“We continue to follow up with the Russian side for the release of the remaining Indian nationals with the Russian army,” MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said.

The latest figures indicate that a sizeable number of Indians recruited into the Russian armed forces are yet to return home, despite sustained diplomatic efforts by New Delhi.

The government has repeatedly warned Indians against joining the Russian armed forces, but Jaiswal said reports of fresh recruitment continued to emerge. — TNS

IOC officer dies after being stabbed 7 times at pump he went to seal

NEW DELHI/CHHATRAPATI SAMBAHJINAGAR, OCTOBER 7 An Indian Oil Corporation (IOC) officer was fatally attacked with a sharp weapon while carrying out inspection at a petrol pump in Maharashtra’s Hingoli district, prompting Petroleum Minister Harddeep Singh Puri and the IOC on Wednesday to seek swift action from the state authorities.

Mahesh Shelke, Manager (Retail Sales), IndianOil, was part of a team carrying out the takeover of an IndianOil retail outlet when he was attacked. The incident recalls the 2005 killing of S Manjunath, a 27-year-old IOC sales officer who was shot dead in Lakhimpur Kheri, Uttar

Pradesh, after inspecting a petrol pump where irregularities had been detected.

Four persons, including a woman, were arrested on Wednesday in connection with Shelke’s murder, the police said. The accused are identified as Shravan Wakude, Rahul Dhajje, Umesh Pandvir, and Lata Pandvir, said an official.

The police have registered a case on a complaint by a senior IOC official under various BNS Sections for murder, unlawful assembly, rioting, and criminal intimidation. The incident occurred on Tuesday when Shelke and other members were carrying out the takeover of an IndianOil retail outlet. — PTI

No Hindi labelling of medicines at TN govt hospitals

COIMBATORE, OCTOBER 7 Officials at the government hospitals in Coimbatore and Karur moved swiftly to halt the distribution of trilingual medicine covers following a fresh controversy over Tamil Nadu’s language policy.

The row erupted after packaging bearing dosage instructions in Tamil, English, and Hindi reached patients at state-run medical facilities.

The issue escalated after DMK leader TRB Rajaa shared photographs online showing the medicine covers distributed at the Karur facility, accusing authorities of covertly enforcing a three-language policy in the public healthcare network. Health Minister KG Arunraj said a similar packaging was approved during the DMK regime too. — PTI

TMC flags 2,454 rape cases, 600 murders in Bengal in five months

RINKU BEHERA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7 The Trinamool Congress on Wednesday alleged a serious collapse of law and order in West Bengal under the BJP government.

The party has demanded an emergency session of the state Legislative Assembly after claiming that official data obtained under the Right to Information (RTI) Act reported 2,454 rape cases and 600 murders in the state between May and September.

Addressing the media, TMC leader Kunal Ghosh said West Bengal recorded 125 murders in May, 134 in June, 133 in July, 111 in August and 97 in September, taking the five-month total to 600. He also cited 2,454

registered rape cases during this period—349 in May, 389 in June, 776 in July, 459 in August and 481 in September.

According to Ghosh, the figures were obtained by former MP Saket Gokhale through an RTI application filed with the West Bengal Government. Adding that the information was supplied by the State Crime Records Bureau through the state information officer and included month-wise as well as police station-wise, district-wise and region-wise details.

Gokhale had also posted his RTI application on X. He said the data showed that 2,454 rape cases were registered between May and September, translating to an average of around 16 reported rape cases every day during the period.

Ghosh claimed that the RTI information further showed 13,114 cases of attempted murder and 32,341 cases involving grievous injuries in this period. “People are not being allowed to enter police stations to lodge complaints. We are clearly saying that there is jungle raj, police raj, a free zone for criminals, one-sided hooliganism and one-sided criminal activity,” Ghosh said.

He also questioned the Governor and the role of Lok Bhavan. “What is the Governor and Lok Bhavan doing,” he asked, urging the Governor to take action.

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A 1st, Colorado University to set up campus in H’bad

AKSHEEV THAKUR
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7 University of Colorado Denver (CU Denver) will establish its campus in Hyderabad after receiving the letter of intent from University Grants Commission (UGC). This will be the first American public university to set up a degree-granting location in India, and the first foreign university to set up campus in Telangana.

The Hyderabad location will offer courses in high-demand fields including business, computing, engineering, and analytics, while encouraging interdisciplinary thinking and problem-solving.

Kenneth T Christensen, Chancellor, CU Denver, said, “Expanding access to high-quality education has long been central to CU Denver’s vision and goals. Our plans in Hyderabad build on that commitment, as well as our long-standing connection with students from India who have been part of the CU Denver community for decades.”

Emeritus is the university’s strategic joint venture partner in India. The university will welcome the first cohort of students in August 2027. Additional programs will be proposed to the UGC for approval.

हरियाणा राज्य परिवहन, अम्बाला

नीलामी सूचना

सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि हरियाणा राज्य परिवहन, अम्बाला के अधीन बस स्टैंड अम्बाला शहर, अम्बाला छावनी, शहजादपुर में नवनिर्मित बस ब्यू शैल्टर मुलाना में दोनों तरफ 8X8 साइज चाय, कॉफी, कोल्ड-ड्रिंक, ब्रेड-पकोड़ा हेतु स्थान उपलब्ध करवाया जाएगा व शेष बची दुकानों/दिनांक 01.10.2026 से खाली होने उपरान्त कार पार्किंग, अम्बाला छावनी को दिनांक 01.11.2026 से 31.03.2028 तक की अवधि के लिए किराये पर देने की खुली नीलामी दिनांक 28.10.2026 को प्रातः 11:00 बजे बस स्टैंड, अम्बाला शहर (नजदीक कपड़ा मार्किट) में होनी सुनिश्चित हुई है। इच्छुक बोलीदाता निश्चित समय व स्थान पर पहुंचकर बोली में भाग ले सकते हैं। शतें विभागीय पोलिसी अनुसार होंगी। उक्त बोली के लिए विस्तृत निर्देश व हिदायतों की प्रति किसी भी कार्य दिवस में महाप्रबंधक, हरियाणा राज्य परिवहन, अंबाला शहर कपड़ा मार्किट, प्रथम तल, कम्प्यूटर शाखा से 500/- रु. के भुगतान तथा अपने स्थायी पते के दस्तावेजों की छाया प्रति कैशियर को देकर प्राप्त किये जा सकते हैं। नीलामी के दौरान आप द्वारा 500/- रु. भुगतान पर जो दस्तावेज प्राप्त किये गये हैं उनकी छाया प्रति हस्ताक्षर सहित संबंधित कर्मचारी को देनी होगी तथा धरोहर राशि कैशियर अंबाला शहर के पास जमा करवानी होगी जोकि असफल बोलीदाताओं को वापस कर दी जाएगी। अधिक जानकारी प्राप्त करने के लिए सुवेन्द कुमार, भवन लिपिक से दूरभाष संख्या-7056640006 पर संपर्क करें।

हस्ता./-

महाप्रबंधक,

हरियाणा राज्य परिवहन,

अम्बाला।

PRDH/1119/11/950/2027/49979/31/4

पी एम श्री जवाहर नवोदय विद्यालय, नाहन,

जिला सिरमौर (हि.प्र.)

वॉक इन इंटरव्यू

सत्र 2026-2027 के लिए अनुबंध के आधार पर पीजीटी गणित के पद के लिए वॉक इन इंटरव्यू 13.10.2026 को विद्यालय परिसर में प्रातः 9:00 बजे से दोपहर 01:00 बजे तक आयोजित किया जाएगा। इच्छुक और योग्य उम्मीदवार 02 पासपोर्ट साइज फोटो, सत्यापन के लिए योग्यता और अनुभव के मूल दस्तावेजों सहित सभी प्रमाणपत्रों की एक सेट स्व-सत्यापित फोटोकॉपी के साथ उपस्थित हो सकते हैं। आवेदन फॉर्म निम्नलिखित गूगल ड्राइव लिंक पर उपलब्ध रहेगा। इच्छुक आवेदक उपलब्ध लिंक के माध्यम से आवेदन फॉर्म सभी दस्तावेजों तथा प्रमाणपत्रों को संलग्न कर भर सकते हैं।
लिंक: <https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1-MBW7ccWyz7rCvgQlQAXia7lJdXqTyl1?usp=sharing>

आवश्यक योग्यता :-

a) Integrated Post Graduate Course from NCTE recognized institution, in the Mathematics with at least 50% marks in aggregate including B.Ed. component.

OR

Master Degree from a recognized institution with at least 50% marks in aggregate in the Mathematics.

AND

b) B.Ed. Degree from NCTE recognized institution with at least 50% marks OR

Three years integrated B.Ed.- M.Ed. from NCTE recognized institution with at least 50% marks

OR

Four years integrated degree with at least 50% marks from NCTE recognized institution including B.Ed. component.

साक्षात्कार की तिथि

13.10.2026

DI-17108

ह./- प्राचार्य।

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA

TENDER NOTICE

SR. NO.	NAME OF BOARD/ CORP/ AUTH.	NAME OF WORK/ NOTICE/TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT/ EMD (APPROX.) in Rupees
1.	DHBVN	HIRING OF VEHICLE ON OUTSOURCE BASIS I.E. JEEP ONLY MAKE AS PER STANDING DESIGNED & SPECIFICATIONS FOR O/O XEN OP DIVISION DHBVN DABWALI AGAINST NIT NO. 01/XEN/OP/DHBVN/DBL/2026-27	06.10.2026 27.10.2026	4.15 LACS PA

WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/CORP/AUTH.: www.dhbvn.org.in

NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/E-MAIL: 9812452800.xendabwali@dhbvn.org.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT: www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in

PRDH/13/2027/40/49991/1/31/4

SOCIAL JUSTICE, EMPOWERMENT, WELFARE OF SCs & BCs AND ANTYODAYA (SEWA) DEPARTMENT, HARYANA

S.C.O. No. 20-27, 3rd Floor, LIC Jeevandeep Building, Sector 17-A, Chandigarh, Pin – 160017

Date:

VACANCY CIRCULAR

The Social Justice, Empowerment, Welfare of Scheduled Castes and Backward Classes and Antyodaya (SEWA) Department, Government of Haryana, invites applications from eligible and suitably qualified candidates for appointment to the post of State Commissioner for Persons with Disabilities. The State Government is committed to safeguarding the rights, dignity and equal participation of persons with disabilities and to advancing an inclusive and accessible society through effective implementation of the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016 and the rules framed thereunder.

Name of the Post: State Commissioner for Persons with Disabilities, Haryana
Headquarters: Chandigarh
Honorarium: ₹ 50,000 per month, together with House Rent Allowance as admissible under the applicable rules of the State Government.
Age Limit: The applicant must not have attained the age of 65 years as on 1 January, 2026.
Educational Qualifications:
1. **Essential:** A bachelor's degree from a university recognised by law.
2. **Desirable:** Preference shall be accorded to candidates possessing a recognised degree or diploma in social work, law, management, human rights, rehabilitation, or education of persons with disabilities.
Experience: The applicant must possess a minimum of ten years' professional experience of which atleast three years in the recent past must have been in the field of rehabilitation and/or empowerment of persons with disabilities in the Central Government, a State Government, or a public sector organisation.
Term of Office:
The State Commissioner shall hold office for a term of three years from the date of assuming charge, subject to the applicable statutory provisions and rules.
Powers, Duties, and Functions: The State Commissioner shall exercise such powers and perform such duties and functions as prescribed under the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016 and the rules framed thereunder, as amended from time to time.
Application Procedure: Eligible candidates shall submit a duly signed application on plain paper, accompanied by self-attested copies of documents in support of age, educational qualifications, experience and other claims. The complete application must reach the Director, Social Justice, Empowerment, Welfare of Scheduled Castes and Backward Classes and Antyodaya (SEWA) Department, Haryana, S.C.O. No. 20-27, 3rd Floor, LIC Jeevandeep Building, Sector 17-A, Chandigarh – 160017, on or before 23 October 2026.
Dr. G. ANUPAMA IAS
Additional Chief Secretary to Government of Haryana
Social Justice & Empowerment, Welfare of SCs & BCs and Antyodaya (SEWA) Department

NOTE:
● Applications that are incomplete, unsupported by the requisite documents, or received after the prescribed closing date shall be rejected without further correspondence.
● Candidates who have already submitted an application for the post of State Commissioner for Persons with Disabilities in response to the earlier advertisement need not apply again.

PRDH/1104/11/432/2026/14

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA

TENDER NOTICE

SR. NO.	NAME OF BOARD/ CORP/ AUTH.	NAME OF WORK/NOTICE/ TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/ EMD (APPROX.) in Rupees
1	HSAMB ROHTAK	PROVIDING DIESEL GENERATOR SET, GRID CONNECTED ROOF TOP SOLAR PV PLANT, AIR CONDITIONERS AND GEYSERS IN KISAN BHAWAN, NARNALA HARYANA (CM ANNOUNCEMENT NO. 24638 DATED 10.01.2019)	06.10.2026 13.10.2026	43,38,439/-

WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/CORP/AUTH: <https://etenders.hry.nic.in>

NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/E-MAIL: 9812100311.xenelectrohtak2025.hsamb@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT: www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in

PRDH/13/2027/40/49992/1/31/4

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-Auction Notice

Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/PS, Northern Railway, Ambala Cantt, for and on behalf of President of India invites bids through E-auction on IREPS website for allotment of contracts at Railway Stations of Ambala Division of Northern Railway.

Auction Catalogue No.: UMB-MIX-42-2026 **Rate unit:** Annual License fee **Size:**10x6'ft.

S N	Lot No	Details	Auction Start Date & time	Auction close Date & time
1	Catg-UMB-DKT-GMU-213-26-1	Catering-General Minor Unit (GMU) Stall No.1 at PF No.1, for General category of Dhulkot (DKT) Railway Station.	14.10.2026 at 12.00 hrs	14.10.2026 at 12.30 hrs
2	Catg-UMB-KRLI-GMU-211-26-1	Catering-General Minor Unit (GMU) Stall No.1 at PF No.1, for General category of Kurali (KRLI) Railway Station.	14.10.2026 at 12.00 hrs	14.10.2026 at 12.40 hrs
3	Catg-UMB-KART-GMU-214-26-1	Catering-General Minor Unit (GMU) Stall No.1 at PF No.1, for General category of Kirtapur Sahib (KART) Railway Station.	14.10.2026 at 12.00 hrs	14.10.2026 at 13.00 hrs
4	Catg-UMB-BCU-GMU-215-26-1	Catering-General Minor Unit (GMU) Stall No.1 at PF No.1, for General category of Bhuchchu (BCU) Railway Station.	14.10.2026 at 12.00 hrs	14.10.2026 at 13.10 hrs
5	Catg-UMB-SOL-GMU-212-26-1	Catering-General Minor Unit (GMU) Stall No.2 in Circulating area for General category of Solan (SOL) Railway Station.	14.10.2026 at 12.00 hrs	14.10.2026 at 13.20 hrs
6	Catg-UMB-DUI-GMU-193-26-1	Catering-General Minor Unit (GMU) Stall No.4 at PF No.2/3, for General category of Dhuri (DUI) Railway Station.	14.10.2026 at 12.00 hrs	14.10.2026 at 13.30 hrs
7	Catg-UMB-MET-SMU-174-26-1	(Refreshment Room- Special Minor Unit (SMU) (Size 47.44 sqm, i.e 8x 5.93 sqm) for OBC women at Maierkotia (MET) Railway Station	14.10.2026 at 12.00 hrs	14.10.2026 at 13.40 hrs
8	Catg-UMB-UBC-SMU-189-26-1	Catering- Special Minor Unit (SMU) Stall No.4 at PF No.2, for Minority Women category of Ambala City (UBC) Railway Station.	14.10.2026 at 12.00 hrs	14.10.2026 at 13.50 hrs
9	Catg-UMB-PTA-SMU-190-26-1	Catering- Special Minor Unit (SMU) Stall No.12 at PF No.1, for Scheduled Caste (SC) category of Patiala (PTA) Railway Station.	14.10.2026 at 12.00 hrs	14.10.2026 at 14.00 hrs
10	Catg-UMB-BTI-SMU-175-25-1	Catering- Special Minor Unit (SMU) Stall (Size 2.51 x 3.42 sqm.) Stall No.01 in Circulating area for Scheduled Caste (SC) category at Bathinda (BTI) Railway Station.	14.10.2026 at 12.00 hrs	14.10.2026 at 14.10 hrs

Note: For participation in e-auction process or for any other information related to E-auction process prospective bidders are advised to visit www.ireps.gov.in

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

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GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA

TENDER NOTICE

SR. NO.	NAME OF BOARD/ CORP/ AUTH.	NAME OF WORK/NOTICE/ TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/ EMD (APPROX.) in Rupees
1	HARTRON	PROCUREMENT OF NEXT GENERATION FIREWALL (NGFW) FOR O/O CITIZEN RESOURCES INFORMATION DEPARTMENT (CRID), SECTOR-17, CHANDIGARH.	07.10.2026 19.10.2026	22 LACS

WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/CORP/AUTH: <https://etenders.hry.nic.in>

NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/E-MAIL: 01722923376.sandeepv.hartron-hry@gov.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT: www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in

PRDH/13/2027/40/49994/1/31/4

Advertisement

State Level Awards Year 2026-2027

The Government of Haryana has instituted various State Level Awards to honor women who have done outstanding work in various fields for their notable contributions and achievements and to encourage their contribution towards women empowerment and the development of society.

DETAILS OF AWARDS:-

Sr. No.	Name of Award	No. of Awards	Award Money
1.	Smt. Sushma Swaraj Award	1	Rs. 5 Lakh & a citation
2.	Indira Gandhi Mahila Shakti Award	1	Rs. 1.50 Lakh & a citation
3.	Kalpna Chawla Shaurya Award	1	Rs. 1.00 Lakh & a citation
4.	Bahin Shano Devi Panchayati Raj Award	1	Rs. 1.00 Lakh & a citation
5.	Life time achievers award	1	Rs. 51,000/- & a citation
6(I)	Government Employees	4	Rs. 21,000/- & a citation
6(II)	Social Workers	4	Rs. 21,000/- & a citation
6(III)	Women Entrepreneurs	2	Rs. 21,000/- & a citation

HOW TO APPLY & IMPORTANT INSTRUCTIONS:-

1. **Mode of Application:** Applications must be submitted strictly online only through the dedicated online award portal on WCD Haryana Website.

2. **Guidelines:** Eligibility criteria, guidelines/notification can be downloaded from the official departmental website: <https://wcdhry.gov.in>

3. **Rejection Criteria:** Applications sent via **Post, Courier, or any offline medium will NOT** be accepted. Incomplete applications or those submitted in an incorrect format will be summarily rejected.

Applications are open from 06 October to 05 November 2026

Scan QR to apply

PRDH/1128/11/714/2027/49981/31/4

On milestone event, Modi calls on Advani

ADITI TANDON
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7
In the ruling BJP circles, one story is a legend: that had it not been for LK Advani, Narendra Modi would not have been the Chief Minister of Gujarat, the political break to which he owes his electoral innings, first as CM and then the Prime Minister of India.

A brief spell of fraught ties between Advani and Modi apart, the guru and shishya (teacher and disciple) have a lot of positives to look back upon.

No wonder PM Narendra Modi called on Advani today as he completed 25 years first as Chief Minister of Gujarat (2001 to 2014) and then as Prime Minister of India (2014 to now).

Had it not been for Advani, Modi would not have taken oath as the CM of Gujarat on October 7, 2001. It was Advani who pushed the case of Modi, who, until then, was only a powerful general secretary of the party and a strategist. This even as Modi had come to be called a “super CM” during Gujarat Chief Minister Keshubhai Patel’s term after the BJP won the first full mandate in Gujarat in 1995.

Annoyed Modi critics led by Shankersinh Vaghela at the time managed to send him out of Gujarat but Advani again intervened to appoint Modi as the BJP general secretary, Haryana, Punjab, Himachal and Jammu and Kashmir; where the latter expanded saffron footprint. Later when Keshubhai Patel’s government faced a trust deficit in the midst of drought, Kutch earthquake and other disasters, Advani positioned Modi as Patel’s successor, elevating a backroom organiser to the pedestal of politics.



PM Narendra Modi with BJP veteran Lal Krishan Advani at his residence in New Delhi. PTI

India becoming ‘Vishwaguru’ under PM Modi, says Chouhan

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7
Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan on Wednesday hailed Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s 25 years in public office, saying Swami Vivekanand’s over 100-year-old dream of India becoming ‘Vishwaguru’ is coming true under the leadership of another Narendra.

Addressing the concluding ceremony of the ‘Seva Sankalp Yatra’ in Gujarat’s Vadnagar, held to mark PM Modi’s 25 years in public life, Chouhan said Opposition leaders could not compete with Modi’s connect with the people. “Prime Minister Modi’s message is ‘Nation First’, while for some people, family comes first,” Chouhan said, in a direct attack on the Opposition.

Calling upon the youth to put the nation first, the minister said Modi’s leadership was taking India towards

becoming a “prosperous, glorious, powerful, self-reliant and developed” country.

Chouhan said Modi’s journey from Gujarat Chief Minister to Prime Minister had been marked by continuous work for India’s development and people’s welfare.

BJP president Nitin Nabin described PM Modi’s 25-year journey as the head of government as an “unforgettable” and “historic” chapter, highlighting his struggle, dedication and commitment to public service.

“Modi’s journey began amid struggles and continued despite challenges, driven by penance, dedication and determination. He made public service the purpose of his life and treated political power as a means of serving the people and the nation... Modi became prime minister on the strength of a direct popular mandate, without a political legacy,” he said. — TNS

World leaders hail PM’s 25-yr political journey

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7
Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s completion of 25 years as head of government on Wednesday drew congratulatory messages from leaders across the world, including Japan, Nigeria, Bhutan, the Philippines, Belgium, Nepal and Botswana.

Japanese PM Sanae Takaichi said Modi’s political leadership since 2001 had accelerated India’s development and elevated the country’s prestige on the world stage. Bhutanese PM Tshering Tobgay recalled a 2019 meeting in New Delhi when he told the Indian leader that he regarded him as an elder brother and “an avatar of Vishnu”. — TNS

Clearance U-turn grounds first seaplane service before launch

SHEKHAR SINGH
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7

India’s first dedicated seaplane service was not halted by a failed trial, a safety objection or a regulatory rejection. Instead, it was derailed after official clearances granted for the project were subsequently withdrawn, even after preparations for launch had advanced.

The paper trail, accessed by *The Tribune*, behind the aborted SkyHop Aviation service in Lakshadweep reveals a striking reversal by the UT administration within weeks. In an August 2026 letter to SkyHop, the Lakshadweep administration conveyed its concurrence for commencement of seaplane operations after the conclusion of the monsoon, subject to weather conditions. Crucially, the same letter said the Airports Authority of India (AAI) would be the

aerodrome operator for all waterdromes.

By then, SkyHop had already spent months preparing for the launch, received its Air Operator Certificate (AOC) in April and conducted more than 40 trial flights across the islands.

The company had also invested in an aircraft, pilots, engineers and water-jetters on five islands, while keeping its operational team and aircraft available for the launch.

The administration’s August concurrence was followed by another key regulatory milestone. The Directorate General of Civil Aviation approved the waterdromes on September 7, paving the way for the proposed commercial operation.

Within days, however, the project hit an unexpected roadblock. On September 10, SkyHop was verbally informed that the administrator of Lakshadweep had

declined the service. The launch, which had been planned for September 15/16, was consequently called off.

What makes the episode particularly striking is what followed. In a communication issued on September 21, the Lakshadweep administration told the AAI that the UT did not have experience in the operation and management of waterdromes and seaplane operations and, therefore, would not be able to provide assistance for such operations.

The communication further said all previous communications on the subject could be treated as withdrawn. The key question is why the administration first conveyed concurrence for the service and identified the AAI as the waterdrome operator, only to later cite its lack of experience in seaplane operations while withdrawing its earlier communications.

By the time the project was stopped, the aircraft and crew were ready and the supporting infrastructure had been created. The episode also raises a broader question for the Centre’s regional connectivity programme: who bears the financial and operational risk when an operator fulfils regulatory, technical and infrastructure requirements but a local administration reverses its position just before commercial operations begin?

For SkyHop, the consequences extend beyond a delayed launch. The company has incurred aircraft lease and crew costs, built supporting infrastructure and kept personnel in readiness without generating commercial revenue.

The Ministry of Civil Aviation is now examining the reasons behind Lakshadweep’s last-minute denial of permission to SkyHop, according to sources.

Sudhakar likely to be next envoy to Nepal

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7

India has proposed the name of senior diplomat Sudhakar Dalela as its next Ambassador to Nepal, opting for an experienced career diplomat at a time when New Delhi and Kathmandu are seeking to deepen cooperation in connectivity, energy and trade.

According to The Kathmandu Post, New Delhi formally conveyed Dalela’s nomination to Nepal’s Ministry of Foreign Affairs on Tuesday, seeking its concurrence. His appointment will take effect once Kathmandu grants the required agreement. There was, however, no official confirmation from India’s Ministry of External Affairs (MEA).

A 1993-batch Indian Foreign Service officer, Dalela is currently serving as Secretary (Economic Relations) in the MEA, a post he assumed in September 2025. He also serves as

India’s Sherpa for BRICS, IBSA and I2U2. The move comes as the tenure of India’s Ambassador to Nepal, Naveen Srivastava, draws to a close. Srivastava, also a 1993-batch IFS officer, was appointed to Kathmandu in 2022.

Dalela brings extensive experience in India’s neighbourhood diplomacy. He has previously served in the MEA’s North Division, which handles relations with Nepal and Bhutan, and was India’s Ambassador to Bhutan from 2022 to 2025.

During Nepalese Foreign Minister Shisir Khanal’s visit to New Delhi in June, the two sides reviewed cooperation in development partnerships, connectivity, trade and transit, energy, and people-to-people exchanges.

Nepal remains a key partner in India’s Neighbourhood First policy, with the two countries sharing an open border and deep historical, cultural and people-to-people ties.



Day after FM’s remarks, govt says talks with US on to ink apt trade agreement

UJWAL JALALI
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7

India on Wednesday said negotiations with the United States for a bilateral trade agreement were continuing despite Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman’s assessment that the talks had reached a “plateau”, while making it clear that the country’s energy sourcing decisions would continue to be guided by national interest.

“We continue to remain in touch with the American authorities for conclusion of a mutually beneficial India-US bilateral trade agreement at the earliest,” Ministry of External

Stresses energy sourcing guided by national interest

Affairs spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said. Asked whether it would have an impact on India’s oil imports, particularly purchases from Russia, Jaiswal said India’s energy sourcing policy remained unchanged.

“Our energy sourcing policy is very well known to you. Our energy sourcing is dependent on a national interest,” he said.

India, he added, was seeking to meet the energy requirements of its 1.4 billion people at affordable prices through diversified sources. The comments came a day after

Sitharaman said the India-US trade negotiations had reached a “plateau”, beyond which further give-and-take could be “very, very difficult”. US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer had also recently said a deal was not imminent.

“The agreement negotiations are still ongoing, although we’d like to believe that both sides have reached a plateau beyond which giving or taking might be very, very difficult. But maybe if there is room to operate from, both sides would do it,” Sitharaman had said

She said the agreement was still being “hard and very rigorously negotiated”, while highlighting the trade imbalance as a key feature of India-US economic relations. The trade negotiations have acquired an added energy dimension following US legislation that gives President Donald Trump the authority to impose tariffs of up to 100 per cent on countries that continue significant purchases of Russian oil. India has maintained that its energy sourcing decisions are based on its national interest and the need to ensure energy security through diversified supplies.

Make movie, entertain people to rebuild image: SC to actor Rajpal

SATYA PRAKASH
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7

Embroiled in a dishonour of cheque case, actor Rajpal Yadav on Wednesday got an ‘advice’ from the Supreme Court which asked him to resume making films to rebuild his image.

“Make a good movie, entertain people again and rebuild your image,” a Bench led by CJI Surya Kant told Yadav as it took note of the Rs 1.15 crore payment made by the actor pursuant to its last order in a long-running series of cheque-bounce cases.

Yadav’s counsel told the Bench that a prospective buyer of his ancestral property has been found and the buyer was willing to deposit Rs 85 lakh by demand draft in the top court’s Registry by October 12.

Noting that it was not satisfied with Yadav’s conduct, the Bench said it was only giving him breathing time. It posted the matter for hearing next week. Piqued over Yadav’s failure to honour his undertaking to deposit money towards the dues of a private firm in a



Actor Rajpal Yadav outside the Supreme Court in New Delhi. PTI

long-running series of cheque-bounce cases, the Supreme Court had on October 5 come down heavily on him, saying his place was in jail.

Yadav, who was present in the court, on Wednesday told the Bench that he suffered financial losses over his film ‘Ata Pata Laapata’. “*Sir, pranam karta hoon*. I have worked on some 200 to 250 films. Over the last 13 years, I have also

incurred losses amounting to Rs 200-250 crore. I suffered a loss with ‘Ata Pata Laapata’. Rs 17 crore went down the drain... Send me wherever and whenever you wish; I am ready... I could not earn a rupee. A press conference was held against me. My film was stalled. It was supposed to be released in 1,200 theatres, yet it couldn’t be released in even a single one. The movie couldn’t be released in even one theatre,” said the actor known for his comic roles in a number of films.

“*Koi nayi movie aa rahi hai? Koi achi si movie banake logo ko dobara entertain karo. Apki image dobara ban jaegi. Humare yahan kuch advocate bhi ache actor hain, unko leke koi movie banao*. (Is there a new movie coming out? Make a good movie and entertain people again; that will help rebuild your image. We have some lawyers here who are also good actors-why not make a movie featuring them?)” the CJI asked. Upholding Yadav’s conviction in multiple cheque-bounce cases, the Delhi High Court on July 10 sentenced him to three-month imprisonment.

Speed up efforts to meet Paris climate deal goals: India

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7

At the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) Pre-COP31 meeting in Fiji on Wednesday, Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav called for expediting implementation of the Paris Agreement. Yadav said the long-term objectives and goals had already been established and focus should now be on accelerating global progress towards these targets. — TNS

PUNJAB STATE POWER CORPORATION LIMITED
(REGD. OFFICE: PSEB HEAD OFFICE, THE MALL, PATIALA)
CIN: U40109PB2010SGC033813, Website: www.pspcl.in
(Contact No. 96461-23955)

Tender Notice for	Shifting/Raising of 66 KV Pasiana - Sanour Line within the land of M/S Connaught Place Developers. (Between T.L. No. 250-252). (Electrical and Civil) Deposit Work.
Tender Enquiry No.	26/TL Div PTA/2026-27
Tender Cost	1180/- [As per PSPCL Work Regulation (amended upto date)]
Tender document Sale Start Date	06.10.2026, 06.00 p.m. Onwards
Last Date and Time of receipt of Bids	02.11.2026 till 11:00 a.m.
Date and Time for opening of Bids	02.11.2026 at 03:30 p.m.

Note: For detailed NIT & Tender specifications please refer to office of Sr. Xen/TL Division PSPCL Officer's Flat No. 24, Shakti Vihar, Patiala. During working hours on working days from the publication of this tender. For corrigendum and addendum, if any will only be available in the office Sr. Xen/TL Division PSPCL Officer's Flat No. 24, Shakti Vihar, Patiala. C958/26 DPR/Pb/1079/12/2026-27/15941

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY
RAILWAY RECRUITMENT CELL
RECRUITMENT AGAINST SCOUTS & GUIDES QUOTA FOR THE YEAR 2026-27
Employment Notice No. NER/RR/C/SG/2026-27 Dated: 06.10.2026;

Opening Date and Time of Online Application	07.10.2026 at 11:00 Hrs.
Closing Date and Time of Online Application	06.11.2026 at 18:00 Hrs.

Online applications are invited from eligible candidates for recruitment against Scouts & Guides Quota for the year 2026-27 for 03 Group 'C' posts in Level-2 (Grade Pay-1900) (N.E. Railway-02 posts & BLW/Varanasi-01 post) and 08 erstwhile Group 'D' posts in Level-1 (Grade Pay-1800) (02 posts, each in Izzatnagar, Lucknow and Varanasi Division of N. E. Railway & BLW/ Varanasi). For detailed information, please visit N. E. Railway's website www.ner.indianrailways.gov.in.

Chairman
CPRO/RR-C-01
Railway Recruitment Cell, Gorakhpur
DO NOT SMOKE BIDI/CIGARETTE IN TRAINS

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN TENDER NOTICE No. NIT-03-SnT-PROJ-UMB-2026-27 DATED 07.10.2026
By.CSTE/Project/UMB on behalf of president of India invited e-tenders from the willing contractors for following work up to 11:30 Hrs. on the date of closing, shown against the work and will be opened thereafter.

S. N.	Name of Work	Approx. Cost (Rs.)	Bid Security (Rs.)	Period of Completion	Date of closing & opening of tender	Tender validity
1.	"S&T work for Interlocking of 28 Nos Non-Interlocked LC gates having TVU >20000 and < 50000 over Firozpur Division". List of LC-Gates:- ASR-KEMK Section 1 LC Gate (C-13), ASR-PTK Section 3 LC Gate (C-15,C-16,C-21), LDH-FZR Section 14 LC Gates (A-21,B1- 30,A-41,B1-45, B2-49,B2-51,A-66,C-67,C-70,C-72,C-73,C-78,C-81,C-84), JUC-FZR 2 LC Gates (C-4,C-5), BTI-FZR Section 4 LC Gates (C-45,C-51,C-56,C-57), KKP-FKA Section 4 LC Gates (C-3,C-28,C-33,C-58).	106713854.82/-	2174300.00/-	12 months	Tender will be available on www.ireps.gov.in website from 08.10.26 to 11:30 hrs on 30.10.26 and will be opened on 30.10.26 after 11:30 hrs.	90 Days

NOTE: 1. Tenderers are required to upload scanned copies of all related eligibility documents including PAN/TIN /GST etc. as per conditions. 2. The Bid Security will be acceptable On-line payment through Net Banking/or Payment Gateway payment only well before of closing date & time of tender as per tender document. 3. Tenderers should have Class-III Digital Signature Certificate to participate in e-Tendering of works tenders. 4. For detail, Please log on IREPS website www.ireps.gov.in 3474/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. NO.	NAME OF BOARD/ CORP/ AUTH	NAME OF WORK/NOTICE/ TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/ EMD (APPROX.) in Rupees
1	UHBVN	ERECTION OF DOUBLE CIRCUIT INDEPENDENT FEEDER FOR RELEASING ELECTRICITY CONNECTION OF SHRI GURU TEGH BAHADUR SAHIB GOVERNMENT MEDICAL COLLEGE, PANJUPUR, YAMUNANAGAR UNDER THE JURISDICTIONS OF UHBVN	DATE OF CLOSING 27.10.2026 AT 1:00 PM	EMD 10.00 LACS

WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/CORP/AUTH: www.uhbvn.org.in
NIT No. 04/SE/OP/NR/2026-27 dated 06-10-2026.
NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/E-MAIL: 9315609711 xenopynr@uhbvn.org.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT:
www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.ctenders.hry.nic.in
PRDH/13/2027/40/50010/31/4

DIRECTORATE OF AYURVEDA, PUNJAB
SECTOR 11-D, CHANDIGARH - 160011
(Department of Health & Family Welfare, Punjab)
Tender Notice Reference No. Ayu-Pb/P1/2026/4849
Dated: 06/10/2026

The Directorate of Ayurveda, Punjab invites bids for the Procurement of Essential drugs and medicines required for implementation of the National AYUSH Mission that have to be procured from Essential Drug List of Ayurveda, Unani and Siddha published by Ministry of AYUSH, Govt. of India. For more details, refer to the tender document.

Documents Downloading Start Date : 09.10.2026 (11:00 AM)
Closing date & time : 29.10.2026 (5:00 PM)
For details login to: <http://eproc.punjab.gov.in> linked department Health & Family Welfare, Punjab.
Note: Any corrigendum (s)/addendum to the tender notice shall be published on the above website only.

DPR/Pb/3329/12/2026-27/15953 Sd/- Joint Director Ayurveda, Punjab

NORTHERN RAILWAY
E-Tender Notice
Sr.DEE/G/IFZ acting for and on behalf of The President of India invites E-Tenders (www.ireps.gov.in) against below titled Tenders. Bidders will be able to submit their original/revised bids up to closing date and time only.

Tender No. : 251-Elect-T-22-R3-2025-26

Name of work : Electrical work in c/w Augmentation/Upgradation of Transformer, HT, LT and APFC panels in existing substation and other associated works over Firozpur Division.

App. Cost (in Rs.) : Rs. 1,36,26,912.02/-

Earnest Money (in Rs.) : Rs. 2,72,500.00/-

Completion Period : 06 Months

Opening of tender : 29.10.2026 after 17:00 hrs.

Website Particulars : www.ireps.gov.in

No.: 251-Elect/T. Notice No. 24-R3-Elect/2025-26 Dated: 07.10.2026 3483/26

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE
Principal Chief Electrical Engineer/Project, Northern Railway Ambala Cantt.For & on behalf of the President of India invites **Open Tender** on the website www.ireps.gov.in for the following works. The tenderer may submit their original/revised offer up to the prescribed closing time & date. No tender will be accepted manually.

Tender No. : NR-Proj-UMB-293-Leftov-03

Tender title : Work of Modification of OHE, Construction of Panjkosi/SSP in Bathinda - Sriganganagar Section of Ambala Division and Additional/Modification work of Nakodar/TSS in Lohian Khas - Phillaur Section of Firozpur Division.

App. Cost (Rs.) : Rs. 1.70 Cr.

Bid Security (Rs.) : Rs. 3,39,200

Completion Period (Months) : 18 Months

Cost of Tender Document (Rs.) : Nil

Date of Closing : 10.11.2026, 15:30 Hrs.

Tender documents are available on Railway website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in and the same can be downloaded from there. Earnest Money deposit (EMD) and Tender document cost (TDC) in respect of e-tendering will only be accepted through net banking and payment gateway only. Details of bank account number and technical details have been provided for in the software (IREPS) to which prospective registered tenderers will have access at the time of tendering. **Note:-** Technical and Financial Eligibility and all other terms & conditions, may be seen in Tender document and downloaded from Railway website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

No.: NR/Proj/UMB/Adv/I/17 Dated: 05.10.2026 3485/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

IN BRIEF

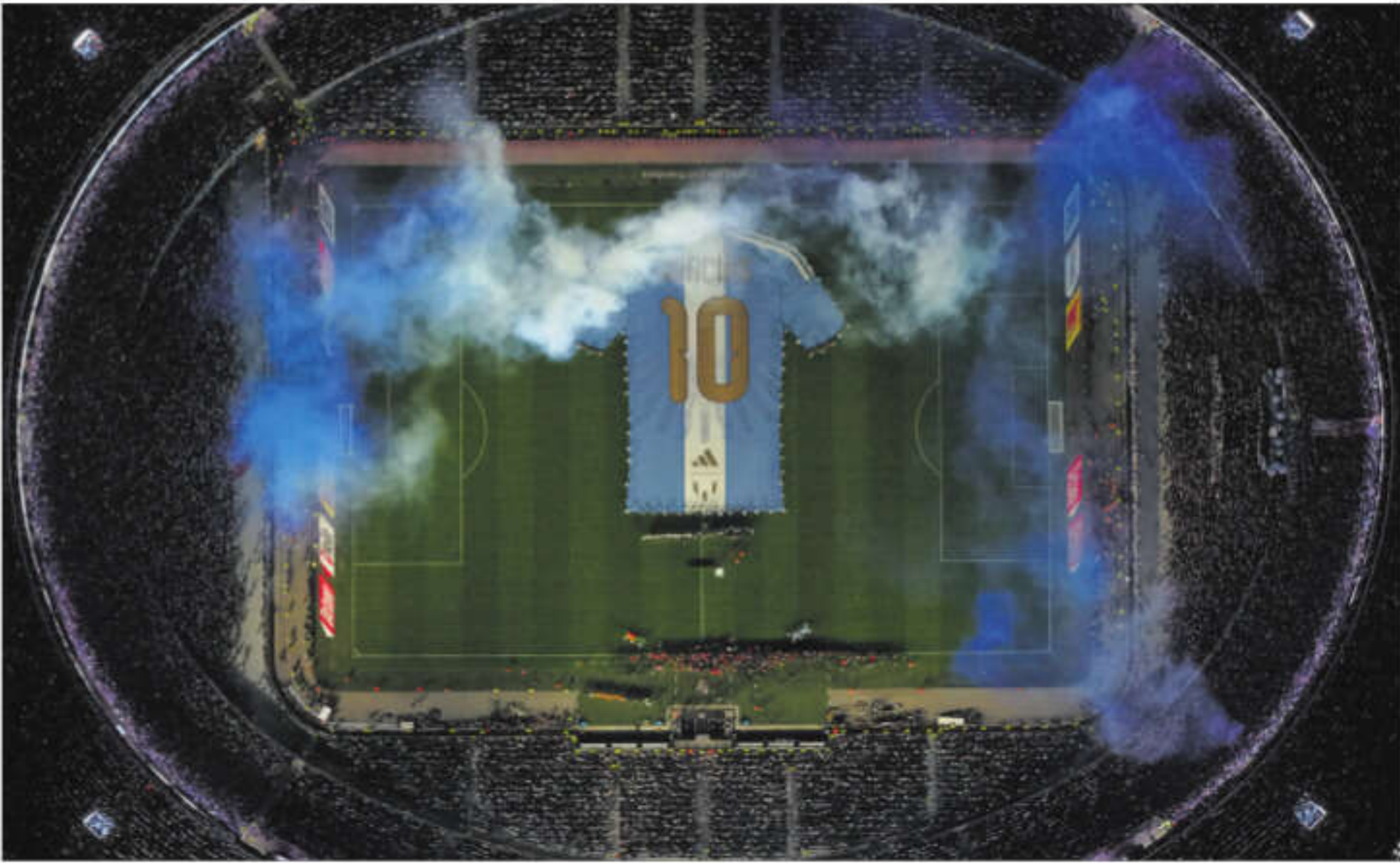
Pramod, Bhavina to lead India as flag bearers at Para Games
NEW DELHI: Paralympic champions Pramod Bhagat and Bhavina Patel will lead the Indian contingent as flag bearers at the Opening Ceremony of the Asian Para Games, scheduled to be held from October 18 to 24 in Nagoya, Japan. Bhagat, one of India's most decorated para badminton players, has won six Asian Para Games medals, including two gold and four bronze, from 2014 to 2023. Patel is a leading para table tennis player, who won two Asian Para Games medals between 2018 and 2023 – one silver and one bronze.

Nirbhay, sprinter Manikanta Hoblidhar aim to raise bar
NEW DELHI: Hammer thrower Nirbhay Choudhary will look to build on his national record, while sprinter Manikanta Hoblidhar will aim to make a strong return from injury as the 65th National Open Athletics Championships begins here on Thursday. Choudhary said his training went as expected after he set a national record at the Indian Athletics Final Series here in September. "The goal at the National Open Athletics will be to improve my personal best," said the Delhi-based thrower, who set a national record of 71.02m last month.

Shaurya Bhattacharya opens with a two-shot lead
GREATER NOIDA: Shaurya Bhattacharya opened with a sizzling six-under 66 to establish a two-shot lead after the first round of the Kapil Dev Invitational Tour Championship at the Jaypee Greens Golf & Spa Resort here on Wednesday. The 23-year-old Bhattacharya, a three-time winner on the DP World PGTI, made seven birdies and dropped his only shot of the day on the par-four eighth. Bhattacharya began the week ranked 14th in the Race to DP World India Championship. He has come close to adding another title this season, recording joint runner-up finishes at the DP World Players Championship in February and the Kolar Open in August.

Para-shooters allege corruption in Asiad selection
NEW DELHI: Para-shooters have sought an urgent independent inquiry into alleged financial corruption, extortion and manipulation in the selection process for the Para Asian Games, prompting the Paralympic Committee of India (PCI) to reject the charges and insist that the team was picked entirely on merit. In a representation to the Director General of the Sports Authority of India (SAI) on Wednesday, the shooters alleged "illicit monetary extortion", "brazen corruption" and violations of Sports Ministry's guidelines by PCI officials and its Shooting Technical Committee (STC) in selections for the Aichi-Nagoya Para Asian Games, scheduled from October 18 to 24. PCI president Devendra Jhajharia, however, rejected the allegations, maintaining that the selection process was transparent and based entirely on the prescribed criteria. AGENCIES

Tears, tributes and chants mark Lionel Messi's final appearance for Argentina
Goodbye, Captain Messi



A giant t-shirt with Lionel Messi's number 10 is displayed before an international friendly soccer match against Benin in Buenos Aires, Argentina. PTI

offers you some respite, some joy." For years, Argentines had debated when and how Messi should leave the world stage. His Aug 31 announcement that he'd be retiring from the national team, weeks after Argentina's loss to Spain in the World Cup final, prompted an outpouring of gratitude and grief – even as Messi will continue to light up Major League Soccer with Inter Miami.

"I don't know if there has ever been a love story between a player and a nation as great as the one you built," his teammate Rodrigo De Paul wrote on Instagram.

The Argentine soccer federation turned Tuesday's game - Messi's 208th - into a national farewell billed as "the last tango." More than 85,000 tickets to Buenos Aires' largest stadium sold out in 90 minutes, seats that were originally priced

around \$60-\$300 later fetching over \$2,500 on resale sites. Players from Argentina's 1978, 1986 and 2022 World Cup-winning squads returned to see him off. After the final whistle, Messi's eyes glistened as his teammates gathered around him, applauding. A rumbling chorus of "Ole, ole, ole, ole, Messi, Messi" rose from the stands as tens of thousands of fans jumped, sang and bowed toward him as if in worship. A banner at midfield proclaimed him the "Eternal Captain."

"The truth is, I'm talking more than I ever have. I don't want to leave here, I don't want to leave this field," Messi told the crowd, which roared as if he

had scored. "I just want to tell you that I love you, I'm going to miss you, and I'm grateful to God to be Argentine."

Winning over his own
During the 2000s and 2010s, Messi amassed trophies with his club and won diehard fans from Barcelona to Bangladesh. Yet a major championship for his own country eluded him. Where the world saw a supernatural talent, some at home saw an outsider who had never played professionally in Argentina and seemed to buckle under the weight of their expectations. Argentine crowds chanted "Diego, Diego," invoking Diego Maradona, the larger-than-life hero of Argentina's 1986 World Cup victory, and reminding Messi of a standard he had yet to meet. — PTI

Krishna-Pruthvi stun 5th seeds; Prannoy out

ARCTIC OPEN
VANTAA, OCTOBER 7
India's men's doubles pair of Krishna Prasad Garaga and Pruthvi Krishnamurthy Roy registered a stunning win over fifth seeds He Ji Ting and Ren Xiang Yu of China to enter the second round, but it was a dismal performance from the men's singles players at the Arctic Open Super 500 here on Wednesday. Krishna and Pruthvi, who won back-to-back titles at the Saint-Denis Reunion Open and VI Mexican International Challenge in May, saw off the fifth seeds He and Ren 10-21, 21-18, 22-20 to notch up one of the biggest wins of their careers. The Indian duo will face England's Oliver Butler and Samuel Jones next. However, HS Prannoy, Tharun Manne palli, and Rounak Chauhan were ousted in the opening round. The 34-year-old Prannoy, who was part of the Asian Games contingent, suffered a 10-21, 9-21 loss to fourth-seeded Dane Anders Antonsen to continue his wretched form this season. Later in the day, Chouhan lost 20-22, 22-20, 17-21

to China's Weng Hong Yang, while Manne palli suffered a 16-21, 14-21 defeat to Denmark's Magnus Johannesen. On Tuesday, Tanvi Sharma had defeated Taiwan's Chiu Pin Chian 21-15, 21-17 to enter the second round, but Isharani Baruah lost 10-21, 15-21 to top seed Ratchanok Intanon of Thailand. Kidambi Srikanth will take on Brain Yang of Canada later in the day. The result was particularly significant because He and Ren arrived in Finland as one of the higher-ranked pairs on the BWF World Tour and had recently been among the contenders at major international events. After being outplayed in the opening game, Krishna and Pruthvi showed remarkable composure to turn the contest around, matching the Chinese pair in the flat exchanges and handling the pressure well in the closing stages of the decider. The victory is expected to provide a major confidence boost to the Indian combination as they continue their push for bigger results on the world circuit. — PTI



Sports Ministry forms 7-member panel for hockey league revival

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7
The Sports Ministry has formally constituted a seven-member committee comprising representatives of Hockey India, HIL franchises and the ministry to work on the revival of the crisis-ridden Hockey India League. The development comes after Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya held a meeting in September with Hockey India officials and representatives of HIL franchises and was apprised of the concerns surrounding the competition. "The committee includes Sports Ministry joint secretary (Khelo India) Vineel Krishna, Hockey India President Dilip Tirkey, secretary general Bhola Nath Singh and treasurer Sekar J Manoharan," a ministry source told PTI. "The three franchise representatives on the panel are Alok

Sanghi, Mahesh Bhupathi and Divyanshu Singh." After last month's meeting, a panel comprising representatives from Hockey India and the franchises and a senior Sports Ministry official had also been proposed. The minister had directed the stakeholders to work on the governance model, financial structure and the league on a priority basis. The committee had been asked to present its report to the ministry in a time-bound manner. The latest order formally brings the stakeholders together under a seven-member committee, with the government having direct representation in the process. Indian women's hockey players, including captain Salima Tete and Savita Punia, made an emotional public appeal to save the Women's Hockey India League (WHIL)

from discontinuation amid severe financial distress during the World Cup in August, where the Indian team finished fifth, which was its best performance since 1974. The HIL's next season is facing uncertainty, with franchises seeking greater clarity on its governance and financial structure. The HIL was relaunched in 2024 after a seven-year hiatus and has since emerged as an important platform for providing domestic competition and exposure to Indian and overseas players. The latest move is also significant against the backdrop of the continuing power struggle within Hockey India, with president Tirkey and secretary general Bhola Nath Singh having differed publicly on several administrative issues in recent weeks, including the jersey row ahead of the World Cup. — PTI

Gauff falls to Mertens after 'draining' few days

CHINA OPEN
BEIJING, OCTOBER 7
Coco Gauff crashed out of the China Open in the last 16 on Wednesday, suffering a 6-3 6-3 defeat by Belgium's Elise Mertens in what the American third seed described as a "draining" few days. Gauff revealed after her victory over Chinese 16-year-old Sun Xinran on Monday that she had received an "insane" amount of racial abuse on social media following a match in which a replayed point sparked an online backlash. Asked what the previous 36 hours had been like, the 22-year-old told a news conference: "It has been kind of draining, I'm not going to lie. I just turn off my phone and move on. There's nothing you can do." Gauff beat Sun 7-5 6-1 to reach the fourth round, but was targeted online after stopping play during a key point in



Elise Mertens reacts during her match against Coco Gauff. PTI

the first set, raising her hand to complain about a flickering advertising board just as Sun was about to put away a winner. After a video review, the umpire ordered the point to be replayed. Gauff won the replayed point and held serve for 5-5 before going on to seal victory over Sun. Gauff later said she had received a barrage of abusive

messages on social media after the match. The WTA condemned the abuse. "There is no place for racism, discrimination, or abuse in tennis," the WTA told Reuters in a statement. "We are appalled by the racial abuse directed at Coco Gauff and are in contact with her to offer our full support. "As we do for all WTA players

experiencing online abuse, our Threat Matrix team is monitoring the abusive messages, working with the athlete's team to report them to the relevant platforms and seeking action on the content and the accounts responsible." The Threat Matrix service was launched in 2024 and uses AI and open-source data to help protect athletes from online abuse and harassment. The defeat against Mertens capped a difficult few days for the two-times Grand Slam champion, who had beaten the 30-year-old Mertens in all five of their previous meetings. The 13th seed reached her first Beijing quarter-final in her seventh appearance at the WTA 1000 tournament and will next face six-times Grand Slam champion Iga Swiatek. "My coach/boyfriend, it's his birthday tomorrow," Mertens said in her on-court interview. "So for me, this win is dedicated to him." — PTI

Smriti leads tributes to Harman after captaincy exit

MUMBAI, OCTOBER 7
The newly-appointed India women's cricket team captain Smriti Mandhana on Wednesday hailed her predecessor Harmanpreet Kaur's leadership stint as "fantastic" and hoped to continue the journey together for some more time. Harmanpreet stepped down as captain across formats on Tuesday, bringing curtains down on a decade-long captaincy tenure in which she led the team to its maiden ODI World Cup title in November 2025 and two Asian Games gold medals in 2023 and 2026. "It's been a pleasure playing with you for so many years," Mandhana wrote on her Instagram page. "Ten years of your leadership have been fantastic and together, we will strive to bring many more laurels for our nation," she added. Mandhana, now an all-format leader, will start her full-time captaincy job with the home T20I and ODI



“It's been a pleasure playing with you for so many years. Ten years of your leadership have been fantastic and together, we will strive to bring many more laurels for our nation. Smriti Mandhana

series against Zimbabwe later this month. India batter Jemimah Rodrigues, who is currently sidelined with a hamstring injury, thanked Harmanpreet for her leadership. "Congratulations on everything you've achieved. Thanks for the years of leadership and for everything you did for the team!," Jemimah wrote. India wicketkeeper-batter Richa Ghosh shared a picture on social media carrying Har-

manpreet on her back, and said the next phase is only the start of a new chapter. "Captaincy may be a chapter that ends today, but the impact of a leader never fades," Richa wrote. "Harry di, you've given so much to Indian cricket and to all of us who have had the privilege of playing alongside you. "Thank you for the belief, the guidance, the fight and all the memories. This isn't goodbye - it's simply a new chapter.

Keep doing what do you best, Harry di," she added. India spinner Shree Charani, who remained Harmanpreet's go-to bowler across formats and conditions while rising rapidly in her career since making debut, also expressed her gratitude. "Your leadership, dedication, and the way you've always supported and motivated the team have meant so much to all of us," she wrote. "It has been a privilege to be

a part of the team under your leadership. I'm truly grateful for all your support, encouragement, and guidance. It means a lot to me." India seamer Renuka Singh Thakur thanked Harmanpreet for inspiring others and paving the way. "Thank you, Harry di. It's been an honour to share the field with you and learn from you. Thank you for inspiring us and paving the way for many of us. Wishing you the very best for everything ahead," Renuka wrote on Tuesday. Former India all-rounder Suresh Raina also hailed Harmanpreet's stint as the captain. "What a journey, what a leader! Captaincy built on courage, character and countless unforgettable memories. More power to you, Harman!," Raina expressed. Harmanpreet will continue to be a part of the Indian side and was named in both the squads for the Zimbabwe series. — PTI

Gill retains top spot, Iyer 7th in T20I

DUBAI, OCTOBER 7
India T20 captain Shreyas Iyer on Wednesday climbed to a career-best seventh spot in the latest ICC rankings for the shortest format, while ODI skipper Shubman Gill retained the top position in the 50-over batting list. Iyer's unbeaten 102 from 43 deliveries that was studied with 10 fours and six sixes, propelled the T20 world champions to a commanding eight-wicket victory in the series-opener against the West Indies in Lucknow on Tuesday. The explosive innings has lifted Iyer 18 places, making him India's third-highest ranked batter in the format. Ishan Kishan and Abhishek Sharma continue to occupy the top two spots with Tilak Varma at 10th, giving India four batters in the top 10, stated an ICC release. Teen sensation Vaibhav Sooryavanshi has climbed



eight places to 46th. West Indies batter Sherfane Rutherford's brisk 56 has lifted him 10 places to 37th while Pakistan's Hasan Nawaz (up 62 places to 48th) has moved up the list following some strong performances in the Asian Games. Abrar Ahmed's figures of none for 29 and one for 29 in the semifinal and final at the Asian Games were not enough

for him to retain the No. 1 position among bowlers. Leg-spinner Rashid Khan is back for his eighth spell at the top, having already spent more than twice as long as anyone else as the No. 1. India's left-arm spinner Axar Patel grabbed two wickets each in three matches this past week to gain 16 spots and reach seventh position. Gill consolidated his position at the top of the ODI batting rankings after his 223 not out in the second match against the West Indies in Guwahati. His second double-century in the format, which was the highest score in an ODI run chase, has helped him add 25 rating points and equal his career-best 841 rating points. Former captain Virat Kohli has slipped from second to third. KL Rahul is back in the top 10 at 10th, jumping seven places after a swashbuckling hundred in the third ODI against the West Indies. — PTI

SC to examine recall plea on EC appointment law

SATYA PRAKASH
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7 The Supreme Court on Wednesday agreed to consider examining a plea seeking the recall of its recent order referring the law on the appointment of the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) and Election Commissioners (ECs) to a five-judge Constitution Bench for testing its validity, following a split verdict.

Chief Justice of India Surya Kant said he would look into the application seeking recall of the September 23 split verdict on petitions challenging the Chief Election Commissioner and Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023, after senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan mentioned the

Top court had referred case to five-judge Constitution Bench

matter for listing.

Sankaranarayanan clarified that it was an interlocutory application seeking recall of the September 23 verdict delivered by a Bench of Justice Dipankar Datta and Justice Satish Chandra Sharma. He added that another petitioner had filed a curative petition against the split verdict.

“We will examine it and then take a call (on listing the matter),” the CJI said, adding that he had read reports about a curative petition having been filed.

“But a curative petition has to be preceded by a review petition,” Sankaranarayanan said, reiterating that his matter concerned an interlocuto-

ry application.

The recall plea has been filed on the ground of an alleged conflict of interest involving Justice Satish Chandra Sharma.

“The petitioners state on record that the engagement of Justice Sharma’s son as standing counsel for the Election Commission before the Madhya Pradesh High Court was not disclosed to the parties by Justice Satish Chandra Sharma at any stage during the five hearings in the matter,” applicant Naman Sherstra submitted.

On September 23, a Bench of Justice Datta and Justice Sharma delivered a split verdict on the validity of the 2023 law, which excluded the CJI from the panel responsible for selecting the CEC and ECs, and referred the issue to a five-judge Constitution Bench for an authoritative pronouncement.

SP skips Kharge lunch meet, Cong plays it down

SHEKHAR SINGH
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7

The Samajwadi Party (SP), the second-largest constituent of the INDIA bloc in the Lok Sabha with 37 MPs, stayed away from the lunch hosted by Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge on Wednesday, citing a lack of timely communication from the Congress, as Opposition leaders met to discuss their next move on the “vote chori” issue.

The SP’s absence from the strategy lunch came even as several other Opposition parties attended the meeting at an eatery on the Janpath road, following Tuesday’s dramatic protest against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, which ended with the detention of several leaders and the registration of an FIR.

The Congress, however, sought to play down the development, saying the decision to host the lunch was taken only late on Tuesday night and invitations were sent around



Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge, LoP Rahul Gandhi, Priyanka Gandhi and other INDIA bloc MPs at an eatery in New Delhi on Wednesday. ANI

the same time, leaving little time for some parties to depute representatives.

Congress general secretary and Rajya Sabha MP Jairam Ramesh said all

INDIA bloc parties had been invited to the lunch, but the short notice made it difficult for some parties to send representatives.

He said the Opposition remained united on the issues of alleged “vote theft”, the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and delimitation, and dismissed attempts to read too much into the absence of some parties from the meeting.

The SP’s decision to skip the lunch is significant, as party chief Akhilesh Yadav had joined Tuesday’s march towards the Election Commission office and later participated in the protest after Opposition leaders were stopped by the police.

The party has been part of the INDIA bloc’s campaign against the Election Commission and its handling of the electoral-roll revision exercise. Akhilesh had also shared the stage with other Opposition leaders during Tuesday’s mobilisation.

No vote theft, Oppn lost its wisdom, says Chouhan

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7

Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan on Wednesday launched a sharp attack on the Opposition over allegations of “vote theft”, saying, “There was no vote theft; their wisdom has been stolen,” and accusing those making the claims of trying to create disorder in the country.

Addressing the ‘Seva Sankalp Yatra’ in Gujarat, Chouhan questioned why allegations of electoral malpractice were not raised when the Opposition was winning elections.

He said some political leaders were attempting to destabilise the country after suffering electoral defeats, while asserting that they could not match Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s connect with the people. “Prime Minister Modi’s message is ‘Nation First’, while for some people, family comes first,” Chouhan said. — TNS

Two win Nobel in chemistry for unravelling molecular asymmetry

STOCKHOLM, OCTOBER 7

Scientists Henri B Kagan and Kenso Soai won the 2026 Nobel Prize in Chemistry for solving a long-standing riddle involving asymmetric “mirror-image” molecules, a discovery of immense significance to pharmaceutical manufacturing, the award-giving body said on Wednesday.

“The medicines we have today would not be possible without this chemistry,” said Rigoberto Hernandez, president of the American Chemical Society.

Kagan (95) is affiliated with the Universite Paris-Sud in Orsay, France. Soai (76) is affiliated with the Tokyo University of Science.

“This is the most exciting day of my life. I am very glad to share this prize with Pro-



Japanese scientist Kenso Soai

fessor Kagan,” Soai said by phone during the Nobel Prize press conference, adding that he had been out shopping when he received the news.

French President Emmanuel Macron congratulated the laureates on X, calling it an immense honour for France. “A recognition



French scientist Henri B Kagan

worthy of a lifetime of research,” he said.

In fact, Kagan’s work has long been regarded as highly influential in the field. The then French research minister even complained to the Nobel Foundation in 2001 when Kagan was overlooked for that year’s award. — Reuters

Amid protests, Shah puts off Manipur visit

ANIMESH SINGH
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7

Amid ongoing protests by the Opposition INDIA bloc over alleged vote theft and against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, Union Home Minister Amit Shah’s proposed visit to Manipur, originally scheduled for Wednesday, is now likely to take place later this month.

Shah, meanwhile, attended a political function in Gurugram on Wednesday. Manipur Chief Minister Yumnam Khemchand Singh told reporters in Imphal on Tuesday that Shah was likely to visit the state later in October, though the exact dates are yet to be finalised.

On August 26, the Chief Minister posted on X that he had invited Shah to visit Manipur in the first week of October to lay the foundation

stone of the new Senapati Medical College and review other development projects.

A visit to the Naga-dominated Senapati district would come at a time when Nagas have increasingly become drawn into the ethnic conflict between the Kukis and Meiteis.

In the past four months, several Nagas have been killed in clashes in a fresh spate of violence in the state. Manipur witnessed 14 deaths in September alone. Since Khemchand Singh took over as the Chief Minister in February, following a year of President’s rule, incidents involving Nagas have added a new dimension to the conflict.

Shah’s proposed visit will be his third to the state ever since ethnic violence erupted on May 3, 2023. It also comes at a time when the Centre is yet to renew the annual Suspension of Operations agreement with militant organisations, despite the pact expiring in September.

Student groups rally support for Oct 10 protest, seek poll reforms

HARSH YADAV
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7

Alleging that nearly 13 crore voters have been removed from the electoral rolls, a coalition of student, youth and political organisations has announced a nationwide mobilisation on October 10, including a major protest at Jantar Mantar, against what it terms “vote chori” and an assault on democratic institutions.

The mobilisation is expected to bring together student groups, Opposition organisations and citizens demanding accountability from the Election Commission and reforms in the electoral system. The organisers said their demands went beyond the removal of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and included “systemic reforms” to safe-



CJP co-convenor Saurav Das

guard voting rights and ensure greater independence and accountability of the poll panel.

The Democratic Youth Federation of India, All India Youth Federation, Revolutionary Youth Association, Revolutionary Youth Front, All India Democratic Youth Organisa-

DHRUV RATHEE, PRAKASH RAJ TO JOIN STIR

Digital creator and activist Dhruv Rathee and actor-director Prakash Raj will join protests in Bengaluru and Delhi against alleged irregularities in electoral rolls, the CJP said on Wednesday. CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke announced that Rathee and Raj would participate in the protest in Bengaluru on October 8. The two are also expected to join the stir at Jantar Mantar on October 10

tion and All India Youth League said they would mobilise supporters in large numbers for the protest.

CJP co-convenor Saurav Das said the protest required the participation of young people, students and citizens from across the country.

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*Editor for purpose of PRP Act, 2023

Bitchat removed

New Delhi: Following an order from the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, Bluetooth-based messaging app Bitchat was removed from app stores over law-and-order concerns. — TNS

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER TRANSMISSION LINE MAINTENANCE DIVISION II SRINAGAR PAMPORE

Subject: Extension of e-NIT No. TLMD-II/ 04 of 2026-27 Dated: 05.09.2026.
No: TLMD II/2260-62 Dated: 06.10.2026

(EXTENSION-II)

Due to the poor response to the tender, the fresh dates for e-filling of e-NIT No. TLMD-II/ 04 of 2026-27; dt: 05.09.2026 for the work “**Insertion of Transmission towers at critical locations of 132KV D/C Mirbazar-Lisser Transmission line**” are hereby extended as detailed below:-

Last Date of online filling of e-bids	13.10.2026 up to 02:00 p.m.
Date of opening of e-bids	14.10.2026 at 02:00 p.m.

Sd/- Executive Engineer TLMD II Pampore.

DIPK-NB-1819/26

UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B) DIVISION GANDHI NAGAR JAMMU SHORT NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Short e-NIT No. DGN/87of 2026-27 Dated 06/10/2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works:-

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Name of Division	Advertised Cost (₹ in Lacs)	Cost of document (in ₹)	Earnest Money (in ₹)	Time Allowed for completion	Time and Date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1	Construction of 02 No. Additional Classrooms at Govt. Primary School, Kranti Nagar, Jammu (Under M.H-4202)	PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar	20.63	600	41260 (2% of the Advertised Cost)	02 Months	(1200 Hrs.) on or after 17.10.2026	"A", "B" & "C" Class

Position of AAA :- Accorded by Project Director Samagra Shiksha J&K No. 314-Chirag of 2025 dated 01.12.2025 amounting to ₹ 20.84 Lacs.
Position of TS :- Sanctioned by this office order No. 85/PWD Div. Gandhi Nagar/2026-27 dated 24.09.2026 amounting to ₹ 20.63 Lacs.
Project Authority :- Project Director Samagra Shiksha J&K.
Major Head of Account :- Under M.H-4202.

The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, Bill of Quantities (B.o.Q.), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen/downloaded from the departmental website <http://jktenders.gov.in> as per below schedule:

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	06-10-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 06-10-2026 to 16-10-2026, 1800 Hrs.
3	Date, Time and Place of pre-bid meeting	10-10-2026 at 1300 Hrs. in the Office of Executive Engineer, PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar Jammu
4	Bid Submission Start Date	06-10-2026
5	Bid Submission End Date	16-10-2026 up to 1800 Hrs.
6	Date & Time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	17-10-2026 on or after 1200 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer, PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar Jammu
7	Date & Time of opening of Financial Bids (Online)	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

DIPUJ-11923/26 Sd/- (Er. Karanjeet Singh) Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar

GOVERNMENT OF PUNJAB
MUNICIPAL CORPORATION AMRITSAR
Tender Reference No. E-Tender Notice No. 79, Date: 06.10.2026
The Department of : Municipal Corporation, Amritsar invite bids for various works Regarding Beautification of Roads.
Closing Date & Time : 17.10.2026 up to 02:00 p.m.
EMD : 2% of Estimate Amount
For Detail login to : <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>
Note : Any Corrigendum(s) to the Tender Notice shall be published on the above website only.
Sd/- Superintending Engineer(C)
Municipal Corporation, Amritsar.
DPR/Pb/1596/12/2026-27/15928

GOVERNMENT OF PUNJAB
MUNICIPAL CORPORATION LUDHIANA
NOTICE INVITING E-TENDERS (B&R WORKS)
NIT No. 567/SE(TIC), Dated 07.10.2026
The department of Municipal Corporation Ludhiana (B&R) invites online double bids for **24 nos. Works** (1st time) as per schedule given below: -
Closing date & time: For S. No. 01 to 18: 22.10.2026 up to 05:00 PM
For S. No. 19 to 24: 27.10.2026 up to 05:00 PM
For details login to: eproc.punjab.gov.in
Note: Detail of works, other terms & conditions and tender documents, any corrigendum/addendum to the tender notice shall be published on the above website only.
Sd/- Superintending Engineer (TIC)
Municipal Corporation Ludhiana
DPR/Pb/1692/12/2026-27/15930

PUNJAB INSTITUTE OF LIVER AND BILIARY SCIENCES (PILBS)
SECTOR 60 (PHASE 3B1), S.A.S. NAGAR (MOHALI)
PUBLIC NOTICE
No. PILBS/2026/8873 DATED: 06/10/26
Applications are invited for various posts of Faculty, Senior Residents and in various specialities in Punjab Institute of Liver and Biliary Sciences (PILBS), Mohali up to **13.10.2026**. The details of posts, educational qualifications, reservation, age, criteria for selection and instructions are at the website of the institute (<https://pilbs.punjab.gov.in>). The applications for the posts to be sent on email punjabilbs@gmail.com as per the given proforma. Interview for these posts will be held on **16.10.2026 from 01:00 p.m. onwards** at PILBS, S.A.S. Nagar, Mohali.
DPR/Pb/3502/12/2026-27/15506 Sd/- Director, PILBS, Mohali.

GOVERNMENT OF PUNJAB
TENDER NOTICE
No. 1037/w Date: 06.10.2026
The Municipal Corporation, Bathinda invites e-tenders on double bid system.

Sr. No.	Tender Reference No.	Item Description	Estimate
1.	E-tender No. MCB/2026-27/32	Design, Supply, Installation, Testing, Commissioning (SITC) of 100 TPD Construction and Demolition waste (C&D waste) processing plant and its operation and maintenance including collection & transportation of the C&D waste in Bathinda City.	To be quoted by the bidder
2.	E-tender No. MCB/2026-27/33	Underground Electrification of LT/HT & other related cable network in Dhoobi Bazaar Bathinda.	180.00 Lacs
3.	E-tender No. MCB/2026-27/34	Providing Main Sewer line in Dhoobiana Basti at Bathinda	190.47 Lacs
4.	E-tender No. MCB/2026-27/35	Providing Sewer line in streets of Dhoobiana Basti.	146.00 Lacs

Closing Date & Time: 23.10.2026, 11:00 a.m.
NOTE:- *Detailed Tender Notice along with T&C can be seen on www.eproc.punjab.gov.in.
**Any corrigendum(s) to the Tender Notice shall be published on www.eproc.punjab.gov.in website only.
Sd/- Corporation Engineer,
Municipal Corporation,
Bathinda.
DPR/Pb/1785/12/2026-27/14969

MUNICIPAL CORPORATION CHANDIGARH
E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Bid Submission Schedule (Online)	Opening Technical Bid (Online)
EXECUTIVE ENGINEER - SWM Division			
1.	Processing of balance mixed waste by segregation process at Mix Waste Segregation Plant at Dumping Ground Dadumajra, Chandigarh. - (Re-Invite) Approx. Amount : Rs. 62,55,000/- Time Period : 03 Months	Earnest Money : Rs. 1,25,100/- Tender Fee : Rs. 3,000/- 08.10.2026 at 9:00 A.M To 15.10.2026 at 11:00 A.M	15.10.2026 at 11:15 A.M
2.	Operation, Maintenance and watch & ward of public toilet blocks in various markets including maintenance of public health & electrical fixtures/ installations complete in all respects for the period of 12 months under EE SWM Division, Chandigarh (Ch. To Revenue Head). Approx. Amount : Rs. 90,76,380/- Time Period : 12 Months	Earnest Money : Rs. 1,81,528/- Tender Fee : Rs. 3,000/- 06.10.2026 at 04:00 P.M To 16.10.2026 at 01:00 P.M	16.10.2026 at 01:15 P.M
EXECUTIVE ENGINEER - M.C.P.H. Division No. 3			
3.	Annual rate contract for the work of Urgent strengthening, Repair and Maintenance of the severe damaged/ collapsed Sewerage and Storm water drainage system and other allied works under the jurisdiction of Public Health Division no.3, Municipal corporation Chandigarh for 12 Months (Ch. To : Revenue Head). Est. Cost : Rs. 70,17,780/- Time Limit : 12 Months	EMD : Rs. 1,40,356/- Tender Fee : Rs. 3,000/- 07-10-2026 To 15-10-2026 upto 11:00 AM	15-10-2026 at 11:30 AM
4.	Upgradation of storm water drainage system by construction of road gullies and Machine holes for smooth disposal of rain water at various locations in Bapudham colony, Sector-26, Chandigarh (Ch To: Capital Head – SWD system) (Re-Invite) Est. Cost : Rs. 42,48,788/- Time Limit : 6 Months	EMD : Rs. 84,976/- Tender Fee : Rs. 3,000/- 08-10-2026 To 14-10-2026 upto 11:00 A.M.	14-10-2026 at 11:30 A.M.
5.	RFP for Design, Construction, Installations, Commissioning, Operation and maintenance of an In-Situ Wastewater treatment system for Faidan Drain, Chandigarh Est. Cost : To be quoted by bidders Time Limit : 39 Months	EMD : Rs. 50,000/- Tender Fee: Rs. 3,000/- 08-10-2026 To 22-10-2026 upto 11:00 A.M.	22-10-2026 at 11:30 A.M.
EXECUTIVE ENGINEER - M.C.P.H. Division No. 1			
6.	Urgent strengthening, repair and maintenance of the severe damaged/ collapsed sewerage & storm water drainage system and other allied works under the jurisdiction of Public Health Division No. 1, Municipal Corporation Chandigarh for 12 Months. (Re-invite) Amount : Rs. 70,17,780/- Time Limit : 12 Months	EMD : Rs. 1,40,356/- 06.10.2026 To 13.10.2026 at 01:00 PM	13.10.2026 at 01:30 PM
EXECUTIVE ENGINEER - Roads Division No. 3			
7.	Repair of Damaged paver Blocks adjoining neighbourhood parks in Sector 22 A & B, Chandigarh. Capital Head Improvement of Road, Parking Places & Infrastructure Facilities. Est. Cost : Rs. 65.87 Lacs Time Limit : 04 Months	Earnest Money : Rs. 1,31,745/- 06.10.2026 To 13.10.2026 upto 12.00 noon	13.10.2026 at 13.00 PM
8.	Special repair/renovation of Fire Station Building & Residential Quarters in Sector 17, Chandigarh. Capital Head- Civic Work Est. Cost : Rs. 49.54 Lacs Time Limit : 06 Months	Earnest Money : Rs. 99,080/- 06.10.2026 To 13.10.2026 upto 12.00 noon	13.10.2026 at 13.00 PM
9.	Special repair of Dhoobi Ghat in Sector-20, Chandigarh. Capital Head- Civic Work Est. Cost : Rs. 56.34 Lacs Time Limit : 06 Months	Earnest Money : Rs. 1,12,675/- 07.10.2026 To 14.10.2026 upto 12.00 noon	14.10.2026 at 13.00 PM
10.	Upgradation of flooring at front side or back side of market/showrooms Sector 22 D, Chandigarh. Capital Head- Imp. of Road/Parking Places and Infrastructure Facilities Est. Cost : Rs. 38.02 Lacs Time Limit : 04 Months	Earnest Money : Rs. 76,050/- 07.10.2026 To 14.10.2026 upto 12.00 noon	14.10.2026 at 13.00 PM
11.	Special Repair / Maintenance of Community Centre at Indira Colony, Manimajra, Chandigarh. Capital Head - NRB. Est. Cost : Rs. 52.39 Lacs Time Limit : 04 Months	Earnest Money : Rs. 1,04,774/- 07.10.2026 To 14.10.2026 upto 12.00 noon	14.10.2026 at 13.00 PM

Note :- 1) Tender Notice alongwith detailed terms and conditions is available/uploaded on website at www.chandigarh.gov.in or etenders.chd.nic.in

EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
SWM Division, Room No. 612, 6th Floor, New Deluxe Building, MC Sector-17, Chandigarh email id : mcc.swm2020@gmail.com,
M.C.P.H. Divn.No.3, Chandigarh,
M.C.P.H. Division No. 1, Near Karuna Sadan, Sector 11, Chandigarh and
Roads Division No.3, Room No.311, M.C. Chandigarh. Ph. 0172-5021482 xenroad3.mcc@chd.nic.in

FAKE CURRENCY RACKET BUSTED, 4 ARRESTED

The Delhi Police have busted an alleged fake currency syndicate with the arrest of four persons. **P2»**



2,000 SOCIAL MEDIA ACCOUNTS SCRUTINISED

Social Media Cell of the Gurugram police has scrutinised around 2,000 social media accounts. **P3»**



AYUSHMANN KHURRANA — THE FORGETFUL PAK SPY

Memory loss, mistaken loyalties: Ayushmann, Sara Ali Khan-starrer *Udta Teer* has plenty of noise. **P4»**



FORECAST

PARTLY CLOUDY

TEMPERATURE

DELHI

MAX: 34°C MIN: 23°C

GURUGRAM

MAX: 34°C MIN: 23°C

FARIDABAD

MAX: 35°C MIN: 24°C

NOIDA

MAX: 34°C MIN: 23°C

SUNSET

THURSDAY 5:59 PM

SUNRISE

FRIDAY 6:19 AM

AIR QUALITY INDEX	
DELHI	136
GURUGRAM	174
FARIDABAD	92
GREATER NOIDA	89
GHAZIABAD	145
NOIDA	129
401-500	SEVERE
301-400	VERY POOR
201-300	POOR
101-200	MODERATE
51-100	SATISFACTORY
0-50	GOOD

‘Mere eyewash’: Court slams police on report in MCOCA case

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7 A Delhi court criticised the city police for submitting an “absolutely perfunctory and mere eyewash” report in an organised-crime case, observing that two accused allegedly continued to commit serious offences, including murder, for years after the stringent Maharashtra Control of Organised Crime Act (MCOCA) was invoked against them, but were arrested only in 2026.

Special Judge Gaurav Rao directed that a copy of his October 5 order be sent to the Delhi Police Commissioner, observing that the matter “calls for a detailed inquiry and appropriate action against all erring officials/investigating officers”.

The case stems from an FIR registered in September 2020, in which MCOCA was invoked against accused Mukesh, alias Punit, and Pardeep, alias Guri.

The court noted that Mukesh was involved in around 20 FIRs, including two murder cases and one case of attempt to murder, when MCOCA was invoked against him. He was subsequently named in eight more FIRs between 2021 and 2024, including cases of murder, attempt to murder, robbery and kidnapping.

Despite this, Mukesh was arrested only on February 9, 2026, by Assistant Commissioner of Police Rakesh Kumar, after the investigation was assigned to him on September 25, 2025.

“Hence, before ACP Rakesh Kumar, none of the IOs made any efforts to arrest the said accused,” the court observed.

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HELPLINE
Emergency response: 112
Women Helpline: 1091
Special cell (Northeast): 1093
Missing person: 1094
Vigilance: 1064
Senior citizens: 1291

WHAT’S ON
DELHI
Dance: LalitArpan Festival 2026. Tradition, Transition, Transmission: India Habitat Centre: 7 pm
Talk: Police Reforms - The Road Ahead: India Habitat Centre: 7 pm
Discussions: Dialogues On Health & Wellness: India International Centre: 10 am
Book Discussion: Arguments with Gandhi: India International Centre: 6 pm
Discussion: Art Matters CXII: India International Centre: 6:30 pm

Quake cracks ‘behind’ New Seemapuri building collapse

Was being vacated after tremors, claim neighbours

RAHUL GAHLAWAT
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7 Delhi’s grim run of building collapses continued on Wednesday as a structure in a densely populated jhuggi settlement in northeast Delhi’s New Seemapuri came crashing down, killing three persons, including a four-month pregnant woman, and leaving eight others injured.

Neighbours claimed the building had developed cracks after Tuesday night’s earthquake tremors and was being vacated, although the authorities have not yet established any link between the quake and the collapse.

Residents near the mishap site said the building stood inside a narrow lane and was L-shaped. They claimed it did not have pillars and that additional floors had been constructed around one-and-a-half years ago. A large number of persons were present in the building when it collapsed. These structural



A rescue operation underway after a building collapsed at New Seemapuri in New Delhi on Wednesday.

details could not be independently verified.

Gulafshaan, a deceased woman, lived in D Block and had gone to meet her mother in E Block. Her mother’s house was adjacent to the collapsed building. Locals said she was sitting beneath the structure when it came down and was subsequently found dead under the debris. Her husband is undergoing treatment at a de-addiction centre, they said.

The Delhi Fire Services received the call around 3.30

pm. Teams from the Delhi Police, Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) and Delhi Disaster Management Authority reached the site within 15-20 minutes and launched rescue operations.

CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

NDMC makes birth, death registration fully online

ANSHITA MEHRA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7 The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) on Wednesday launched fully online and paperless birth and death registration services, an online pet services platform at its government veterinary hospital and an initiative to have 346 public toilets adopted by senior officers and council members for regular monitoring.

NDMC chairman Manoj Kumar Dwivedi and vice-chairman Kuljeet Singh Chahal launched the three initiatives at Palika Kendra in the presence of council members DP Singh, Sarita Tomar and Anil Valmiki along with senior officials.

Under the new birth and death registration system, residents will be able to apply online for corrections in certificates, inclusion of a child’s name, registration of home births and deaths and delayed registration. The system will also enable hospitals to electronically transmit birth and death-related information to the civic body, removing the need for physical submission of forms.

Launches portal for pet services, to adopt 346 public toilets

Dwivedi said the end-to-end online service would reduce paperwork, physical visits and waiting time while making the process more transparent and efficient.

The civic body said the system builds on its existing online facility for adding a child’s name to a birth certificate and expands it into an integrated digital service. Citizens with the required documents will be able to apply for and receive certificates from their homes.

The NDMC also launched what it described as a comprehensive online pet services platform through its government veterinary hospital. The platform will allow pet owners to register their animals, book OPD and vaccination appointments, receive automated vaccination reminders, access digital vaccination certificates and health certificates, make digital payments and maintain digital pet and veterinary records.

CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

INDIA bloc leaders march to EC office, seek rollback of SIR

ANSHITA MEHRA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7 Delhi leaders of the INDIA bloc on Wednesday staged a protest march from Kashmiri Gate to the Election Commission (EC) office and submitted a memorandum to the Delhi Chief Electoral Officer, demanding immediate cancellation of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and restoration of names of eligible voters excluded from the draft rolls.

Representatives of the Congress, CPI, CPI(M), CPI(ML), RJD, RSP, AIFB and TMC participated in the protest, which was held amid heavy security and barricading.

The memorandum sought restoration of names of all eligible voters excluded from the electoral rolls, withdrawal of notices issued to citizens, resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and a return to ballot-paper voting.

Delhi Pradesh Congress Committee (DPCC) leader and former Delhi minister Haroon Yusuf said the bloc would continue its agitation over the issue.

“In democracy, what do we have? Agitation, satyagraha, all these things. We have been doing it for the last several years,” Yusuf said, alleging that the electoral exercise was depriving eligible citizens of their right to vote.

CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Want restoration of names of eligible voters excluded from draft rolls



Cops detain Delhi Congress president Devender Yadav and other INDIA bloc leaders in New Delhi on Wednesday. TRIBUNE PHOTO

DELHI CONG CHIEF, OTHER LEADERS DETAINED

- The police detained Delhi Congress president Devender Yadav and several INDIA bloc leaders on Wednesday during a protest at Jantar Mantar demanding the resignation and arrest of CEC Gyanesh Kumar.
- Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, along with other INDIA bloc MPs, also participated in the protest.

er al years,” Yusuf said, alleging that the electoral exercise was depriving eligible citizens of their right to vote.

CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

BARAPULLAH-III MESS

PWD Minister blames AAP for flawed design, planning

Announces immediate traffic mgmt measures



Vehicles struck in a traffic jam on Barapullah Phase-III flyover. FILE

AAP DEMANDS CBI PROBE

- “The BJP government itself admits that Barapulla Phase-III has serious issues of planning, design and traffic integration. It must answer why it sanctioned Rs 1,635 crore without a proper technical assessment. The CBI must investigate the matter,” the party said.
- The AAP also questioned the basis on which Rs 1,635 crore was sanctioned and said the BJP should explain the technical assessment undertaken before the project was approved.
- The party accused the government of attempting to shift responsibility to the previous administration instead of explaining the technical basis for the expenditure.

the earlier period. Today, the shortcomings are visible on the ground. Our responsibility is to identify them honestly and correct them,” he said.

The minister attributed the planning and major execution

CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

DDA begins feasibility study for in-situ rehabilitation of JJ clusters

MANIKANT MISHRA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7 The Delhi Development Authority (DDA) has begun the process of in-situ rehabilitation of slum clusters across the national capital under the Master Plan-2047, potentially opening the way for better housing and basic amenities for thousands of families.

As the first step, the DDA will prepare feasibility reports for 15 projects covering 45 Jhuggi-Jhopri (JJ) clusters across Delhi.

The authority has invited proposals to appoint three consultants to undertake the studies. The agencies will assess the rehabilitation needs of the clusters, development potential of available land, infrastructure requirements, financial viability of the projects and the most suitable implementation models.

21,229 families to be covered

The 45 JJ clusters are home to around 21,229 families and are spread across approximately 135.74

Invites proposals to appoint 3 consultants to undertake studies

acres. According to the DDA, the proposed projects are likely to benefit more than one lakh people.

In-situ rehabilitation involves providing residents with improved and dignified housing at or near their existing location, reducing the need for displacement.

Master Plan targets over 650 clusters

The Master Plan-2047 envisages the rehabilitation of residents living in more than 650 JJ clusters across Delhi, covering around 1.7 million people. The feasibility studies for the initial 45 clusters are, therefore, being viewed as an important step towards implementing the wider rehabilitation programme.

The exercise could also facilitate more planned and efficient use of land in these areas. According to the DDA, the projects could create opportunities

CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Ahead of Oct 10 protest, cops revisit CJP’s helping hands

RAHUL GAHLAWAT
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7 The Delhi Police have launched a citywide surveillance exercise ahead of the Cockroach Janta Party’s proposed October 10 protest, tracking around 2,800 people with alleged criminal antecedents identified through facial recognition systems and keeping tabs on those who arranged buses and other logistics for the outfit’s previous agitation, officials said on Wednesday.

Station house officers across the city have been asked to identify such people in their areas and ascertain whether they are moving towards the New Delhi district for the proposed demonstration.

Police have also been directed to check whether bus operators and other logistics providers associated with the CJP’s July protest have been contacted again.

The police have not granted permission for the October 10 protest so far.

“SHOs have been asked to identify and keep track of such people in their respective areas, particularly those who may have a history of serious offences. The idea is to know who is moving towards the protest site and from where,” an officer said.

Police are checking local bus bookings to determine who is hiring vehicles, how many people are being transported and their destinations. Any organised

COPS REACH OUT TO EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTIONS, PGS

The police have also reached out to educational institutions and PG accommodation owners in major student hubs. Officers have been asked to request university and college heads to ensure that students do not participate in the protest and advise PG owners to discourage their residents from joining the demonstration.

movement of groups towards Delhi, particularly the New Delhi district, is being closely monitored.

“If there is organised movement of people towards New Delhi, local police should be aware of it and take necessary action,” the officer said.

The police have also reached out to educational institutions and PG accommodation owners in major student hubs. Officers have been asked to request university and college heads to ensure that students do not participate in the protest and advise PG owners to discourage their residents from joining the demonstration.

Entry routes into the Capital are also under heightened surveillance, particularly the eastern and Shahdara borders with Uttar Pradesh and routes in southwest Delhi used by vehicles coming from Rajasthan.

“Barricades will be installed at entry points,” an officer said.

The police are also preparing

for the possibility of protesters gathering at locations other than the proposed venue if they are stopped from reaching it. Personnel have been instructed to prevent protesters from occupying roads or staging demonstrations in the New Delhi district.

“The leaders are putting on social media that if protesters are stopped anywhere, they should sit where they are stopped. We have to ensure that doesn’t happen,” another officer said.

The proposed protest follows the CJP-led agitation in July over the alleged NEET-UG paper leak.

STUDENT, YOUTH GROUPS TO HOLD PROTEST AT JANTAR MANTAR PAGE 2

Decide on SOPs for police body cameras in 6 months: HC to Centre

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7 The Delhi High Court on Wednesday directed the Centre to treat a petition seeking mandatory use of body-worn cameras (BWCs) by police personnel as a representation and decide the issue within six months.

The court declined to issue directions making the use of body cameras mandatory, but asked the authorities to consider framing Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) governing their use.

The PIL, filed by Chahat

Raghav, sought the mandatory use of BWCs by Delhi Police and Rapid Action Force (RAF) personnel deployed during protests and crowd-control situations. It also sought a comprehensive framework for the storage, retention, integrity and evidentiary use of footage recorded through the cameras.

Senior advocate Akhil Sibal, appearing for the petitioner, submitted that body-worn cameras could enhance transparency and accountability during protests, particularly in cases where allegations of police

CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

DRISHTI project to give fresh push to PM-UDAY scheme

ANSHITA MEHRA
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7
The implementation of the PM-UDAY scheme for granting property rights to residents of Delhi's unauthorised colonies is set to get a fresh push with the Centre approving a Rs 65-crore geospatial mapping project, under which dedicated cells will be established in all 13 districts.

The project, 'DRISHTI' (Delhi Revenue and Imaging Survey, Spatial Technology Initiative), will create a GIS-based survey and mapping system to make the identification, survey and documentation of properties under the PM-UDAY scheme more systematic and time-bound.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the technology-driven initiative would make the survey and mapping process more transparent and help eligible residents secure



CM Rekha Gupta

Dedicated cells to be established in all 13 districts

80% GRANT FOR URBAN DEVELOPMENT FUND

- Of the ₹65-crore project cost, Rs 52 crore, or 80 per cent, will be provided as a grant from the Urban Development Fund (UDF) of the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs, while the remaining ₹ 13 crore will be contributed by the Delhi Government's Revenue Department, which will implement the project.
- The PM-UDAY scheme seeks to provide ownership rights to residents of Delhi's notified unauthorised colonies. Its implementation involves the Delhi Development Authority (DDA), Delhi Government's Revenue Department and the Municipal Corporation of Delhi.

property-related rights without unnecessary delays.

Of the Rs 65-crore project cost, Rs 52 crore, or 80 per cent, will be provided as a grant from the Urban Development Fund (UDF) of the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs, while the remaining Rs 13 crore will be contributed by the Delhi Government's Revenue Department, which will implement the project.

Under the initiative, PM-

Development Authority (DDA), Delhi Government's Revenue Department and the Municipal Corporation of Delhi.

The Centre's Rs 52-crore grant will be released in four instalments. However, if procurement is carried out through the Government e-Marketplace (GeM), the entire approved amount may be released in a single instalment, subject to prescribed conditions.

Development Authority (DDA), Delhi Government's Revenue Department and the Municipal Corporation of Delhi.

The Centre's Rs 52-crore grant will be released in four instalments. However, if procurement is carried out through the Government e-Marketplace (GeM), the entire approved amount may be released in a single instalment, subject to prescribed conditions.

Govt eases approval norms for metrology test centres

HARSH YADAV
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7
The Delhi Government has eased approval norms for government-approved test centres (GATCs) dealing with weights and measuring instruments, replacing the existing annual renewal requirement with perpetual approval and reducing the prescribed approval fee from Rs 2.5 lakh to Rs 2 lakh for each equipment category.

The changes were notified by the Weights and Measures Department through a gazette notification, amending the Delhi Legal Metrology (Government Approved Test Centre) Rules, 2026. The Delhi Legal Metrology (GATC) Amendment Rules, 2026, will come into force from the date of their publication in the official gazette.

Under the amended rules, approval granted to a government-approved test centre will remain valid perpetually unless suspended or revoked by the controller. However,

centres will have to pay an annual fee of Rs 10,000 for each equipment category during the first month of every calendar year.

The amendment also introduces self-certification for the reverification of weights and measures. It allows the user or owner responsible for reverification to declare that the weight or measure conforms to the requirements of the Legal Metrology Act, relevant rules and prescribed standards or specifications.

The revised rules also introduce a risk-based classification of weights and measuring instruments, based on factors, including the complexity of instruments, their susceptibility to wear or fraudulent use and their potential impact on consumers and trade.

The new Sixth Schedule divides instruments into three categories. The high-risk category includes high-accuracy weighing instruments, totalling machines, volumetric measuring instruments, flow and bulk meters,

automatic rail weighbridges, CNG and auto LPG equipment, electricity meters, blood pressure measuring instruments and gas meters, among others.

The medium-risk category covers bullion and carat weights, beam scales, clinical thermometers, load cells and vehicle speed meters, among other specified instruments.

The low-risk category includes ordinary weights, counter machines, water meters, survey chains, tubular balances, industrial weighing scales, domestic weights and measures, kitchen and bathroom scales, person and child weighing machines, storage tanks, linear measuring instruments and belt weighing instruments.

The amendment also omits Rule 6 of the principal rules and makes corresponding changes to the Second and Fourth Schedules. The "valid up to" provision has also been removed from the certificate of government-approved test centre.

Student, youth organisations to protest at Jantar Mantar on Oct 10

HARSH YADAV
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7
Student and youth organisations, along with political groups and citizens, will hold a protest at Jantar Mantar on October 10 against the Election Commission over alleged deletion of voters from electoral rolls and what they described as an attack on democratic rights.

The organisers claimed that nearly 13 crore names had been removed from electoral rolls and said the Delhi mobilisation would seek accountability from the Election Commission and demand reforms in the electoral process.

The protest will see participation from several student and youth organisations. The Democratic Youth Federation of India (DYFI), All-India Youth Federation (AIYF), Revolutionary Youth Association (RYA), Revolutionary Youth Front (RYF), All-India Democratic Youth Organisation (AIDYO) and All-India Youth League (AIYL) said they would mobilise their members in large numbers for the Jantar Mantar protest.

Customs destroys 165-kg narcotics worth ₹515 cr

HARSH YADAV
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7
Delhi Customs on Wednesday destroyed around 165 kg of seized narcotic substances, collectively valued at approximately Rs 515 crore, as part of its ongoing action against drug trafficking.

The high-level Drug Disposal Committee of Delhi Customs carried out the destruction of the seized contraband in accordance with the prescribed statutory procedures and safeguards. The consignment included around 140 kg of hydroponic weed, valued at approximately Rs 140 crore, and 25 kg of cocaine, valued at around Rs 375 crore.

The disposal was carried out under the supervision of Arvind Saran, Commissioner of Customs (Airport & General). The committee was chaired by Shankar Prasad Sharma, Additional Commissioner of Customs (Disposal), in the presence of committee members

and other officers concerned. Joint Commissioner Neetish Verma was also present.

The seizure and disposal action comes amid sustained enforcement by Delhi Customs at the Indira Gandhi International Airport. Between April and September 2025, the agency recorded 89 drug seizure cases, resulting in the seizure of around 611 kg of narcotics, including hydroponic weed, heroin and cocaine. As many as 109 alleged traffickers were arrested during the period.

Delhi Customs said the disposal of seized narcotics was being undertaken in accordance with the prescribed legal process, while enforcement agencies continued to target trafficking networks operating through the airport.

The department said it remained committed to sustained enforcement and timely disposal of seized narcotic substances as part of the Government of India's efforts against drug trafficking.

Sadar Bazar traders protest proposed UPI charges

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7
Traders in Sadar Bazar on Wednesday staged a protest against the proposed Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on eligible UPI transactions above Rs 2,000, saying the move would add to the financial burden on small and medium-sized businesses.

The protest was organised by the Sadar Bazar Bari Market Trades Association under the leadership of its president, Paramjeet Singh Pamma. Traders raised slogans demanding that digital payments remain free of additional charges.

Pamma said under the proposed arrangement, a 0.4 per cent MDR would be levied on eligible Person-to-Merchant (P2M) UPI transactions above Rs 2,000, subject to a maximum charge of Rs 300 per transaction. He said while the charge would not be directly collected from cus-



Sadar Bazar traders during a protest against the proposed Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) charges on UPI transactions. TRIBUNE PHOTO: MUKESH AGGARWAL

tomers, traders would ultimately bear the cost.

Giving examples, Pamma said a 0.4 per cent charge on a Rs 5,000 transaction would amount to Rs 20, while transactions of Rs 10,000, Rs 20,000 and Rs 50,000 would attract charges of Rs 40, Rs 80 and Rs 200, respectively.

He claimed that middle-class traders could face an additional monthly burden of around Rs 2,000 to Rs 5,000, depending on their transaction volumes.

"The government should promote digital payments instead of imposing charges on them and putting an additional burden on

DU placement fair draws over 7,000 students

HARSH YADAV
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7
Over 7,000 students turned up at Delhi University's (DU) internship and placement fair on Wednesday, as 69 companies offered 1,830 job and internship opportunities across sectors.

Organised by the Central Placement Cell under the aegis of the Office of the Dean of Student Welfare, 'Avasar 2.0' was held for providing students an opportunity to interact directly with recruiters and explore employment and internship options. The fair saw participation from companies representing diverse professional domains, with students getting an opportunity to discuss vacancies, eligibility criteria, job profiles, recruitment procedures and skills expected by employers.

Fake currency racket busted, 4 arrested

TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7
The Delhi Police have busted an alleged fake currency syndicate with the arrest of four persons and recovered suspected counterfeit Indian currency notes with a face value of around Rs 10.5 lakh,

officials said on Wednesday.

The accused have been identified as Pushkar Raj Purbia, alias "Doctor" (56), a property dealer from Jaipur; Gosai Ram (22) from Barmer; Sahil Kharb (28) from Sonapat; and Narendra Kumar (31) from Churu district in Rajasthan.

Special camps to enrol left-out eligible electors on Oct 9, 11

HARSH YADAV
TRIBUNE NEWS SERVICE

NEW DELHI, OCTOBER 7
The Delhi Election Department will organise special camps at all polling station locations across the Capital on October 9 and 11 to enrol eligible voters who have been left out of the electoral roll as part of the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR).

The Chief Electoral Officer (CEO), Delhi, on Wednesday reviewed the progress of the disposal of notices, claims and objections with all district election officers, electoral registration officers and assistant electoral registration officers.

The CEO office said the exercise was aimed at ensuring that no eligible voter is left out of the electoral roll. "Every eligible elector is added and no ineligible entries remain in the electoral roll," it said.

Special enrolment camps were also held at colleges and universities across Delhi on Wednesday and will continue on Thursday, with a focus on maximising enrolment of young voters. Booth-level officers (BLOs) assisted students in filling forms, collected applications and addressed their queries related to the SIR.

As part of the special drive ordered by the Election Com-

PWD Minister blames ...

dharth Extension direct access to the old Barapalata approach towards Lajpat Nagar, INA and AIIMS.

"We can examine what went wrong in the past, but Delhi's people need a solution today. That is why we are working on both immediate traffic-management measures and long-term structural solutions," Verma said.

The government will appoint a traffic and structural design consultant for a comprehensive assessment and recommendations on short and long-term interventions. The PWD is also coordinating on route mapping on Google Maps following the change in traffic patterns after the corridor's opening.

Decide on SOPs for ...

excesses are followed by counter-allegations of stone-pelting or violence by protesters.

A bench headed by Acting Chief Justice Nitin Sambhre observed that any direction on the use of BWCs would have wider implications as the issue concerns policing generally and is not limited to the Delhi Police.

Additional Solicitor General Chetan Sharma, appearing for the respondents, submitted that under the Delhi High Court's PIL rules, a petitioner is required to first approach the authorities concerned through a representation. He suggested that the petition could be treated as such a representation.

Sharma also submitted

dharth Extension direct access to the old Barapalata approach towards Lajpat Nagar, INA and AIIMS.

"We can examine what went wrong in the past, but Delhi's people need a solution today. That is why we are working on both immediate traffic-management measures and long-term structural solutions," Verma said.

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The project was approved in 2014 and construction began in April 2015, with an original completion target of 2017. Verma said delays due to land acquisition, tree permissions, utility shifting and other execution-related issues kept it pending for several years before the present government completed the remaining work.

He also questioned the financial and contractual decisions related to the project, saying around Rs 640 crore was paid to the contractor through arbitration. He said the delay, cost escalation and arbitration payments needed to be examined together.

The minister said the PWD and the Delhi Traffic Police had jointly assessed the corridor and identified the merger point as a key area requiring intervention. Immediate measures would include better lane channelisation, improved utilisation of road space and smoother movement between Sarai Kale Khan, Ring Road and ITO.

The PWD is also examining a dedicated U-turn on Ring Road near the gurdwara to provide residents of Sid-

agency personnel in removing bricks and rubble by hand to reach those trapped underneath. Excavators were later deployed to clear heavier debris.

Joint teams of the NDRF, MCD, Delhi Fire Services, Delhi Police and DDMA continued search-and-rescue operations at the site, clearing the debris and checking for anyone who may still be trapped.

INDIA bloc leaders...

"The way the Election Commission is behaving, it is as if there is no democracy. You cannot say that he is homeless so he will not vote," he said.

Yusuf alleged that the bloc had raised concerns over the exclusion of voters and said the agitation would continue. "People have woken up now. This agitation will continue. We will fight it out," he said.

CPI leader Prof Dinesh C Varshney demanded that the SIR be scrapped and alleged large-scale deletion of names from Delhi's electoral rolls.

"SIR has to be scrapped. It should be scrapped," Varshney said, claiming that 47 lakh voters had been deleted and 33 lakh people had received notices. He alleged that deletions had affected several constituencies and reiterated the demand for elections through ballot papers.

'Mere eyewash': Court ...

The court said Pardeep, alias Guri, was also involved in several criminal cases and, according to the chargesheet, allegedly committed a number of heinous offences in 2020 after MCOCA had been invoked against him. He was also named in two FIRs registered in 2024, but was arrested only on April 16, 2026.

Three other accused — Vinod, alias Sonu, alias Praveen, alias Khalifa; Pardeep, alias, Anil, alias Salamuddin; and Vikas, alias Vicky, alias Pankaj, — remain absconding, with the investigation against them still incomplete despite the passage of more than six years, the court noted.

DDA begins feasibility ..

for developing commercial spaces alongside new residential stock.

Feasibility reports to guide projects

The process, initiated on the directions of Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu, will see the feasibility reports serve as the basis for determining the technical and financial structure of the proposed projects.

The DDA said the exercise would help ensure that the rehabilitation projects are implemented in a systematic, transparent and sustainable manner.

PUBLIC NOTICE I, Anupam Koundal S/o Late Sh. Parkash Chand Koundal S/o Late Sh. Rawail Singh R/o House No. 204 Jharsa Road, Near Karik Dairy Sector 15 Part-I Gurugram, Haryana-122001, hereby declare that my Father Late Sh. Parkash Chand Koundal was expired on 02-09-2026 & leaving behind the following legal heirs:- (1) Nisha Kundi (Wife), (2) Anupam Koundal (Son), (3) Pankush Koundal (Son), (4) Priya Koundal (Daughter), (5) Preeti Koundal (Daughter) There are no other legal heirs of the deceased except the above mentioned. If anyone having any objection regarding this, he/she can raise objection within 30 days from the date of the publication in the office of Tehsildar, Wazirabad, Gurugram, Haryana.	PUBLIC NOTICE I, Prashant Gulati S/o Sh. Raj Kumar Gulati R/o H.No. 4-3513, D.F. Phase-1, Gurgaon, Haryana do hereby solemnly affirm and declare as under: 1. That I got married to Ms Pooja daughter of Mr. K.K. Arora presently residing at C-758, Sushant Lok-I, Gurugram CN 18-06-1998 and have Two children namely Madhav Gulati (son) and Deeksha Gulati (Daughter) from the wedlock. 2. That my wife Ms. Pooja Gulati for an disclosed reasons left my house in 2018 and started living separately. 3. That on death of my father Sh. Rajkumar Gulati, she did not visit our house to mourn the death. 4. That I despite of my all efforts she has not agreed to live with me. 5. That in view of above I disown & disinherit her from all my movable and immovable assets and she will have no right, claim, lien whatsoever as a legal heir on any of assets in any manner. Depositor (Prashant Gulati)- 9811305689
Public Notice I, Mahesh Kumar S/o Late Sh. Bhagwan Singh, R/o House No. 1278, Durga Mandir, Durga Colony, Jharsa, Gurgaon, Haryana-122003, hereby declare that my father Late Sh. Bhagwan Singh S/o Late Sh. Bihari Lal Bania, passed away on 05.05.2013. He left behind the following legal heirs: 1. Rukmani Devi - Wife, 2. Sunita - Daughter, 3. Babil - Daughter, 4. Veermati - Daughter, 5. Mahesh Kumar - Son, 6. Mukesh Saini - Son, 7. Shivcharan - Son. There are no other legal heirs of the deceased except the above mentioned. If anyone having any objection regarding this, he/she can raise objection within 30 days from the date of the publication in the office of Tehsildar, Wazirabad, Gurugram, Haryana.	Public Notice I, MR. JAGDISH S/O LATE SH. LAXMAN DAS, resident of H. No. 5207, Jacobpura, Gurugram, Haryana-122001, hereby declare that my mother Late Smt. Anaro Devi W/o Late Sh. Laxman Das passed away on 17.09.2015 and my father Late Sh. Laxman Das S/o Late Sh. Tulla Ram passed away on 08.05.2018. They left behind the following legal heirs: 1. Mr. Subhash Chand - Son, Mrs. Santosh - Daughter, 3. Mrs. Madhu - Daughter, Mr. Jagdish - Son There are no other legal heirs of the deceased except the above-mentioned persons. Any person having any objection regarding the above declaration may raise the same before the Tehsildar, Gurugram, Haryana, within 30 days from the date of publication of this notice.
PUBLIC NOTICE I, MR. MANAN BATRA S/O LATE SH. MOHAN LAL BATRA, resident of A-562E/3F, Sushant Lok-1, Sector-28, Gurugram, Haryana-122001, hereby declare that my father Late Sh. Mohan Lal Batra S/o Late Sh. Bihari Lal Bania, passed away on 19.01.2023 and left behind the following legal heirs: 1. Mrs. Ranjana Batra - Wife, 2. Mrs. Charu Gupta - Daughter, 3. Mrs. Shipra Ahluwalia - Daughter, 4. Mrs. Mansi Balia - Daughter, 5. Mr. Manan Batra - Son There are no other legal heirs of the deceased except the above-mentioned persons and there are no disputes among the legal heirs. Any person having any objection regarding the above declaration may raise the same before the Tehsildar, Wazirabad, Gurugram, Haryana, within 30 days from the date of publication of this notice.	PUBLIC NOTICE I, Rajat Aggarwal S/o Sh. Ravi Aggarwal R/o H.No. C-810, Sushant Lok Phase-1, GURUGRAM, HARYANA, hereby declare that my mother Late Smt. Madhubala Aggarwal W/o Sh. Ravi Aggarwal, passed away on dated 16.12.2024 and she has left behind the following legal heirs:- 1. Rajat Aggarwal (Son) 2. Priya Aggarwal (Daughter) There are no other legal heirs of the deceased except the above mentioned. If anyone having any objection regarding this, he/she can raise objection within 30 days from the date of the publication in the office of Tehsildar, Wazirabad, Gurugram, Haryana.

2,000 social media accounts scrutinised under Op Ankush

GURUGRAM, OCTOBER 7
With the objective of curbing the growing trend of displaying weapons on social media and posting reels/videos promoting criminal tendencies, the Gurugram Police launched “Operation Ankush”.

Under this campaign, the Social Media Cell of the Gurugram Police has been maintaining continuous surveillance over various social media platforms and has scrutinised around 2,000 social media accounts.

According to the police, during the scrutiny of these social media accounts, the police team identified 42 accounts related to the display of weapons and 17 accounts promoting criminal tendencies/behaviour. The operators of these accounts had posted reels/videos displaying weapons and content related to criminal activities, often accompanied by songs glorifying hooliganism and criminal behaviour.



“Cops took immediate action against the individuals operating such social media accounts. They were detained, and the objectionable reels/videos posted by them on social media were deleted. The individuals concerned were advised that posting such content on social media not only sends a negative message to society but may also have an adverse influence on young people,” said Sibash Kabiraj, commissioner of police, Gurugram.

During the action, illegal weapons displayed in some social media videos/reels were seized. Upon the seizure of illegal weapons, criminal cas-

es were registered against the individuals as per the law. At the same time, in cases where licensed/legal weapons were shown in videos/reels and had been provided to other individuals for making photographs/videos, the process for the cancellation of the concerned weapon licenses was initiated.

A senior police officer said along with taking legal action, the Gurugram Police also conducted counselling of the individuals and sensitised them to refrain from displaying weapons, creating or posting reels/videos promoting criminal tendencies, or engaging in such activities on social media.—OC

2 more of cyber fraud gang land in F’bad police net

SANJAY YADAV

FARIDABAD, OCTOBER 7
The Faridabad police have arrested two more accused, including the mastermind of an interstate gang that committed a cyber-fraud of over Rs 5 lakh by sending an APK file under the pretext of paying an Adani Gas bill. Five gang members were arrested by the police earlier, who have already been sent to jail.

Data belonging to approximately 20,000 Adani Gas consumers and 1,000 UCO Bank customers was seized from the accused, who had also sent APK files to 116 individuals. Six mobile phones, SIM cards, credit cards, and other electronic devices used in the fraud were also seized from the accused.



The accused in custody of the Faridabad police.

According to the police, an elderly resident of Sector 37, filed a complaint that on September 1, he had received a message on his mobile phone, asking him to pay his Adani Gas bill. The message warned that the gas

connection would be disconnected if the bill was not paid on time and a mobile number was also provided for contact purposes. When he contacted the number provided in the message, the cyber fraudsters sent him an

APK file. After this, the fraudsters used the file to compromise his mobile phone and siphoned off Rs 5,12,334 from his account.

An FIR was registered at the cyber central police station, Faridabad and the police arrested five accused earlier in the case who were identified as Ashwin Bhai, Khunt Dhaval, Manish Bhai, Deep Vitthalbhai, Pithabhai Bhaya Bhai, residents of Surat, Gujarat.

While investigating, the police arrested two more accused now including the mastermind of the gang. The arrested accused were identified as gang mastermind Deepak Kumar Mandal, resident of Giridih district, Jharkhand and Anil Kumar Mandal, a resident of

Deoghar, Jharkhand.

“Both accused are on four days’ of police remand. During interrogation, they revealed that the ringleader of the gang Deepak Kumar Mandal used to purchase data belonging to people, specifically related to the RTO and Adani Gas and APK files via Telegram. Victims were called and intimidated based on this data, and were induced to download APK files. Once the file was downloaded, Deepak gained full access to the phone. Deepak used the proceeds from the fraud to pay off outstanding credit card bills. We are questioning the accused,” said Inspector Basant Kumar, SHO of Cyber Police Station (Central), Faridabad.

3 POs arrested in dowry death case

GURUGRAM, OCTOBER 7

The Palwal police arrested three proclaimed offenders (POs), including a woman, who had been at large for nearly 18 years in a dowry death case. Palwal SP Deepti Garg said the police here would continue to act tough against criminals and fugitives.

According to the police, following the complaint of Mohan Lal, a resident of Non-era in district Bharatpur, Rajasthan, an FIR was registered at the Camp police station, Palwal, in 2008.

The complainant alleged that after her marriage, his daughter Veervati was harassed by

her in-laws over demands for dowry and subsequently she died under suspicious circumstances. An accused in the case, identified as Ram Khiladi, was arrested earlier who was sentenced to 10 years’ of imprisonment by the court, but three named accused were absconding. — OC



The accused in custody of the Palwal police.

HEALTH & WELLNESS



DOCTORSPEAK
DR SUMET SINGH

THE brain controls our ability to think, remember, speak, move and make decisions. Yet, many pay attention to brain health only when a serious problem occurs.

Many daily choices can impact brain health in the long run, raising the risk of stroke, cognitive decline and other neurological problems.

Arvind’s (68) family sought medical help because of his increasing forgetfulness. He had increasingly become socially inactive, rarely exercised and had spent years with poorly controlled blood pressure and diabetes. Arvind was diagnosed with early Alzheimer’s disease. He was advised appropriate medical management along with cognitive stimulation, regular exercise, social engagement, and controlling risk factors such as blood pressure and diabetes.

Baljeet Singh, in his early sixties, had for years lived with high BP and cholesterol, did no exercise and had no diet control. He suddenly developed weakness on one side and had difficulty in speaking. He had experienced a stroke. In his case, there were several risk factors like uncontrolled high BP, high cholesterol and unhealthy lifestyle, which if modified could have prevented the stroke.

Some of the major, modifiable risk factors for cognitive decline include high BP, high blood sugar, high cholesterol (especially elevated LDL), obesity, sleep disorders, anxiety, untreated hearing loss, and vision changes like cataracts.

Uncontrolled high BP is a major risk: One of the most important steps in protecting brain health is controlling BP. High BP can damage blood vessels over



PROTECTING BRAIN HEALTH

Simple daily habits can reduce the risk of cognitive decline and stroke, and help preserve brain health

time and is a major risk factor for stroke. It may also contribute to damage involving the small blood vessels of the brain.

Regular BP monitoring, physical activity and taking prescribed medicines on time can majorly avert stroke risk. High BP usually has no symptoms. The best remedy is continuous monitoring, especially for those with a family history, poor lifestyle choices and poor sleep.

Exercise is good for brain: Regular exercise improves both heart and brain health. Walking, cycling, swimming — any physical activity should be part of daily life. For most adults, especially the elderly, at least 150 minutes of moderate and consistency activity every week, along with 2-3 sessions of muscle-strengthening activities, are must. Consistency matters more than intensity.

Sleep is essential: Adequate daily sleep of seven to nine hours is essential for good concentration and memory and overall health. Irregular sleep and untreated

sleep disorders affect sleep quality. Persistent loud snoring, pauses in breathing during sleep and excessive daytime sleepiness should not be ignored.

Healthy diet, healthy brain: A healthy diet is good for heart and brain health. Eat a balanced diet of vegetables, fruits, whole grains, pulses, nuts and healthy fats daily. Avoid or limit excessive salt and sugar, processed foods, sugary drinks and fried foods. Keep diabetes, high cholesterol and weight in check as uncontrolled diabetes and cholesterol, and obesity can affect vascular health and raise stroke risk.

Keep the brain active: Reading, learning new skills or languages, social interaction, solving puzzles, Sudoku, crosswords, etc, can check cognitive decline. Good brain health is a combination of various factors, including exercise, healthy diet, sleep, BP and diabetes control, and social bonding. Persistent problems with memory, concentration or daily functioning warrant immediate medical assessment.

Stroke a major threat: Stroke is a major disruptor of brain health. If you experience the following symptoms or a sudden severe headache, seek immediate medical aid.

BE FAST

- **B – Balance:** Sudden trouble in walking or coordination.
- **E – Eyes:** Sudden blurred or double vision, or loss of sight in one or both eyes.
- **F – Face drooping:** One side of the face droops or feels numb; lopsided smile.
- **A – Arm weakness:** One arm is weak or numb; ask the person to raise both arms to see if one drifts downward.
- **S – Speech** is slurred or garbled.
- **T – Time** — Don’t waste time, call emergency service.

Do not wait for symptoms to improve. Note the time the symptoms began and get to hospital/emergency fast. The first 60 minutes, called the Golden Hour, are crucial. Getting treatment in this window can minimise permanent brain tissue damage.

Don’t dismiss unusual headaches: Most headaches are not a symptom of any serious or dangerous medical condition. However, certain warning signs need prompt medical attention. A sudden, extremely severe headache, a headache associated with weakness or speech difficulty, headache with fever and neck stiffness, or a progressive headache accompanied by neurological symptoms should be evaluated urgently.

For a healthy brain, especially in old age, we should begin early with these simple measures: Control blood pressure. Exercise. Sleep adequately. Eat well. Avoid tobacco. Manage diabetes and cholesterol. Stay mentally and socially active. Recognise stroke warning signs. These simple measures can make a huge difference. Healthy habits cannot guarantee against dementia or stroke, but they can influence factors that determine how well our brain ages. The best time to protect your brain is before a serious neurological problem occurs.

— The writer is Director, Neurosurgery, Park Hospital, Panchkula

Irregular periods can be due to PMOS, thyroid, not just perimenopause



I had a regular cycle of 32-36 days and normal bleeding lasting 4 days, but for the past 6-7 months my periods have become scanty, of short duration (2.5 days) and irregular (between 26 and 35 days). I also experience mood swings and have sleep disturbances. My sister, who is three years older, had faced similar problems around same age though my mother had regular periods and menopause at 52. Could these changes indicate early perimenopause?

— Neera Sharma (37), Faridabad

All these symptoms can occur during perimenopause, but at 37, these signs should not automatically be attributed to it. Other causes such as thyroid disorder, PMOS, stress or hormonal changes could also be the reason. It is advisable to consult a gynaecologist, who may recommend tests such as thyroid function, prolactin, hormone tests and ultrasound. Your family history is relevant, but does not confirm early perimenopause.

Dr Pooja C Thukral, Gynaecologist, Cloudnine Hospitals, Faridabad

I had my second surgery for umbilical hernia over a year ago. The first one was in 2008. During the recent surgery, a mesh was put inside my abdomen. I sometimes feel a sharp though bearable pain in the area. Is it because a foreign body has been inserted in the body? Any solutions? I have high BP.

— Prachi Kumar (58), Solan
Mesh rarely causes lasting pain. Usually, the body accepts mesh within months. The pain after a year may be

due to a small recurrent hernia, scar tissue, or nerve irritation. An abdominal ultrasound, and/or a CT scan, can help confirm the cause. Avoid heavy lifting or straining. Control body weight. Promptly treat constipation or cough. Eat foods high in fibre, drink lots of water and keep salt intake low to control BP.

Dr Ashish Sharma, Gastrointestinal Surgeon, Fortis Hospital, Jalandhar

My 8-year-old niece has been wearing numbered glasses for three years. Her number has remained constant. During regular check-up, an optometrist said there is no permanent solution for getting rid of her glasses. But after she turns 18, she may opt for lasik surgery, which can make her eyesight 6/6. Once a person starts wearing specs, do they have to wear them forever if they do not undergo surgery?

— Kulwant Kaur, Amritsar

For a child having refractive error, she must wear glasses if she has been prescribed. There is no medicine or exercise to reverse it. Refractive surgery is the only permanent option to get rid of glasses. It is not done till 18 years because the eyes can undergo changes till 18, causing change in the refractive error. Some experts even wait up to 21 years. Lasik is one option of refractive surgery. Your doctor will help you decide the best one for you. The objective is to reduce dependence on glasses. It can’t guarantee 6/6 vision. However, most people do achieve excellent results. Surgery or using numbered glasses/contact lenses remains a personal choice.

Dr Ashu Agarwal, Senior Ophthalmologist, Indraprastha Apollo Hospital, Delhi.

DEAR READERS

Please mail your general queries on health and wellness at healthandwellness@tribunemail.com.

BrahMos and Akash, India’s strategic missile exports, find new markets

AJAY BANERJEE

INDIA’S missile export business is now along two tracks. One is a maritime strike option of BrahMos, which has been opted by Southeast Asian countries. The other is the Akash air-defence system, sold to three buyers, one in the Caucasus and two in Central Asia.

BrahMos missile is a product of a joint venture between India’s DRDO and Russia’s NPO Mashinostroyeniya, formed in 1998. It has found eager customers in a cluster of countries around the South China

Sea: Indonesia, the Philippines, and Vietnam. All three have opted for the anti-ship variant of the missile launched from coast. The BrahMos has a variant that is fired from a ship onto a land target, which has not been exported so far. The Philippines and Vietnam are locked in a running maritime territorial dispute with China in the hydro-carbon rich South China Sea. Indonesia also has small coast on the same sea, but is not part of the dispute.

The export of “fire-and-forget” BrahMos to ASEAN nations — especially those with overlapping maritime

claims in the South China Sea — highlights a major shift.

The Philippines was the first to start the procurement from India and signed a \$375 million contract signed in 2022 and deliveries commenced in 2024. Last month, it even carried out joint exercise with the US forces on ‘tracking warships’ for BrahMos anti-ship missile strike.

Indonesia and India signed an MoU in July this year, seeking coast-based batteries of the BrahMos missile with abilities to hit target 290 km at sea. A battery includes launchers, radars and the missiles. It was the third mis-



INSIDE THE CAPITAL

sile contract New Delhi has in the region what China perceives as its own ‘backyard’. Earlier Vietnam had inked a deal for \$620 million. It includes the supply of

mobile coastal defence missile batteries, comprehensive operator training for Vietnamese personnel, and long-term logistics and maintenance support.

Indonesia sits astride four major straits — the Mallacca, Lombok, Sunda and Ombai-Wetar — which connect the Indian Ocean and the Pacific Ocean. All the four are major shipping arteries — all important for China.

Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh, last week said: “BrahMos is a kind of benchmark for our export story. We’ve got contracts or agreements to sell from The Philippines, and

Indonesia and Vietnam”.

SUCCESS OF AKASH

Akash is the country’s most significant indigenous defence export. It is a layered air-defence system, not a single missile. It includes launchers, radars, command-and-control and support infrastructure.

Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh said “Armenia was the first customer, which has taken multiple batteries. Thereafter, we’ve also exported it to Tajikistan and Turkmenistan.” While the missile has additional orders from Indian armed forces but Defence Ministry is confident

of getting orders from other countries.

India and Armenia, a country that shares a border with Türkiye, have discussed expanding their defence partnership in August this year.

India is already a supplier of rockets, weapons and air defence systems to Armenia. Akash is not merely an export of individual missiles, but represents a larger indigenous air-defence system involving launchers, radars, command-and-control elements and associated support infrastructure.

The original Akash system reaches roughly 25-30 km, while the Akash-NG is

designed for up to 50 km. BDL builds the missiles and BEL supplies electronics, which shows a broad domestic industrial base behind the system.

INDIA’S EXPORT STRATEGY

BrahMos carries more geopolitical weight and higher contract values. Akash arguably shows more about the health of India’s industrial base. India is selling to partners who face maritime or aerial threats, bundle training and support, and offer technology transfer to deepen ties. India exported military equipment to 80 countries and it was worth Rs 38,424 crore.

SOHA'S TRIBUTES TO ARCHER



Soha Ali Khan remembered British author Jeffrey Archer following his death, recalling his long-standing friendship with her father and former Indian cricket captain Mansoor Ali Khan Pataudi. Archer died on October 5.

Tribune Life Style

DELHI | THURSDAY | 8 OCTOBER 2026

Long journey

Reflecting on 10 years since her debut with *Mirza*, Saiyami Kher looks back at the experiences that shaped her journey, from being dismissed as a newcomer to finding her voice as an actor.



EMMA STONE

ANA DE ARMAS



The French connection

Ana de Armas joined Jennifer Connelly, Emma Stone, Zendaya and Rhea Seehorn on the front row as Nicolas Ghesquière unveiled Louis Vuitton's Spring/Summer 2027 collection during Paris Fashion Week on Tuesday. The show brought together a star-studded audience for The collection played with contrasts, blending futuristic details with refined tailoring and fluid silhouettes, while balancing Louis Vuitton's signature craftsmanship with a distinctly modern, confident edge. — TNS



ZENDAYA



SOPHIE TURNER

Ayushmann, the forgetful spy in the city

PHOTO: RAVI KUMAR

Memory loss, mistaken loyalties and a soundtrack with local roots: Ayushmann Khurrana, Sara Ali Khan-starrer *Udta Teer* arrives with plenty of noise

ANANYA VERMA

UDTA *Teer*, in which Ayushmann Khurrana plays a Pakistani spy who loses his memory and becomes convinced he is Indian, will now release on October 23. It was earlier slated for October 9. The cast brought the film to New Chandigarh on Tuesday for a promotional event.

Sara Ali Khan plays his wife. The film is a spy comedy that runs on mistaken identity: the hero remembers his patriotism perfectly well, just not which country it belongs to. Akash A Kaushik makes his directorial debut with it. Ayushmann and Sara last shared the screen in *Pati Patni Aur Woh* Do.

Talking about her character, Sara mentioned, "She is a feminist and definitely a patriot. She's

bold, but there is a soft vibe to her as well." Asked about the city, she spoke about her Punjabiyaat, which comes from her mother. "I am most connected to Punjab through food. My loyalties are specific: white makhana and sarson da saag," she said.

Ayushmann, meanwhile, was asked why his roles vary so much. Earlier, he played a vampire in *Thamma*. Now, he is a spy who has forgotten his own address. "I like diversifying. I focus on the script. If the script is good, I go ahead with it," he said. It is a simple rule, and so far it has kept him hard to predict.

The film also leans on music for local flavour, with both Kaka and Emiway Bantai singing in it, along with a song by Arijit Singh. "We wanted the film to have a local flavour, so we got Kaka and Emiway on board. One is from Punjab, the other from Mumbai. Arijit is half-Bengali and half-Punjabi too," Ayushmann said.

Whether *Udta Teer* works will depend on how well its chaos holds together. But the cast looks relaxed and the songs have range. The spy has a new date to remember: October 23, if his memory holds!



Kiara, Sidharth expecting second child



Bollywood couple Kiara Advani and Sidharth Malhotra are expecting their second child. The couple shared the news on October 7, with a social media post expressing their happiness and gratitude.

Kiara and Sidharth shared a picture on Instagram that showed the couple holding hands, along with the message, "Blessed once again with the greatest gift of all. Our hearts are so full of love and gratitude."

The announcement was soon flooded with congratulatory messages from fans and members of the film industry. Sidharth's mentor and filmmaker Karan Johar was among the first to react to the post, writing, "Love love you," along with multiple red heart emojis.

Athiya Shetty and Bhumi Pednekar, along with designer Manish Malhotra, also reacted to the couple's announcement.

Kiara and Sidharth tied the knot in an intimate ceremony in Rajasthan in February 2023. The couple's relationship began while they were working together on the 2021 war drama *Sher-shaah*, in which Sidharth played the role of Captain Vikram Batra, and Kiara portrayed Dimple Cheema.

The couple welcomed their first child, daughter Saraayah, in 2025. — ANI

On Air Force Day, we look at actors who took flight as Air Force personnel

Courage in the cockpit

INDIAN cinema has often brought stories of courage, ambition and service to the big screen through characters from the Indian Air Force. Over the years, several actors have stepped into the roles of pilots and Air Force personnel, bringing their own interpretations to characters who take to the skies while navigating challenges on the ground.

From Deepika Padukone's Minal Rathore in *Fighter* to Janhvi Kapoor's Gunjan Saxena, here are some actors who took flight as Air Force characters on screen.

DEEPIKA PADUKONE – FIGHTER
In Siddharth Anand's *Fighter*, Deepika Padukone stepped into the role of Squadron Leader Minal Rathore, known by her call sign Minni. As part of the Indian Air Force's Air Dragons unit, her character is placed alongside a team of elite fighter pilots. Deepika brought a mix of confidence, action and emotional depth to the role, while also becoming part of one of Bollywood's most ambitious aerial action films.

JANHVI KAPOOR – GUNJAN SAXENA: THE KARGIL GIRL
Janhvi Kapoor portrayed Indian Air

Force officer Gunjan Saxena in *Gunjan Saxena: The Kargil Girl*. Based on the real-life officer's journey, the film follows Gunjan's determination to become a pilot and her experiences during the Kargil War. Janhvi's performance focused on the character's ambition and perseverance as she navigated a traditionally male-dominated environment.

AKSHAY KUMAR – SKY FORCE
Akshay Kumar's *Sky Force* sees the actor step into the role of an Indian Air Force officer, bringing to life a story inspired by the 1965 Indo-Pak war. The film highlights the courage, sacri-

fice and determination of the men in uniform, while showcasing the risks and responsibilities that come with serving the country in the air.

HRITHIK ROSHAN – FIGHTER
Hrithik Roshan took on the role of Squadron Leader Shamsher Pathania, aka Patty, in *Fighter*. As one of the central members of the Air Dragons, his character is a skilled fighter pilot whose journey combines aerial combat, camaraderie and personal loss. Hrithik's performance brought an action-heavy dimension to the film while

grounding the character in the emotional stakes of the story.

SHAHID KAPOOR – MAUSAM
Shahid Kapoor played an Indian Air Force pilot in *Mausam*, portraying Squadron Leader Harinder Singh, aka Harry. The film spans several years of his life and explores his relationship with Aayat, played by Sonam Kapoor, against the backdrop of changing times and his career in the Air Force. The role allowed Shahid to combine romance with the discipline and responsibilities associated with his character's profession.



(L-R) SHAHID KAPOOR, DEEPIKA PADUKONE, AKSHAY KUMAR & JANHVI KAPOOR
epaper.tribuneindia.com

WHAT'S HOT

eat NAVRATRI FEAST

DURING the auspicious festival of Navratri, Oberoi Sukhvilas presents a specially curated dining experience at Anant Mahal, celebrating the season with traditional flavours. October 11 onwards.



play GOING LIVE

LIVE event Le Voyage de Rézé will take place on October 8 at 11 am at Chitkara International School, Chandigarh. The event will feature a vibrant French live performance and is being presented with the support of the French Embassy, Institut Français and Alliance Française.



love MONTHLY BAITHAK

THE 324th Monthly Baithak Programme by Pracheen Kala Kendra will be held on October 11 at 6:30 pm at the M L Koser Auditorium, Pracheen Kala Kendra, Sector 35-B. The evening will feature a Kathak performance by Chetan Kumar Javda, accompanied by Bhawdeep Javda and Parameshwar Lal Kathak.



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